

Every facade, Stone Age to near future.

Every grammar the kit has, in chronological order, photographed from three angles on the same shell within its size class. The eight eras the kit had no answer for were written for this sheet — and most of them were unbuildable until a facade could tell the shell to hand over the wall plane, because almost none of them have glazing.

THREE-QUARTER

The honest single frame: entrance face and one flank at once, so ornament applied only to the front cannot hide.

WHO OWNS THE WALL

A grammar now declares it. **keep** — the shell glazes as always, and its real furnished rooms show through. **frame** — punched masonry openings to set piers and arches around. **own** — solid wall, no glazing, and the culture's own openings, or none at all.

FROM THE PAVEMENT

Where a player actually meets the building. Judges the door, the reach, and whether it still reads from underneath.

REAR THREE-QUARTER

The cheat detector: a facade that spent everything on the door elevation looks fine in the other two frames and empty here. On tower plates this frame is the crown instead — a tower wraps all four faces by construction, and what it lives on is how it ends.



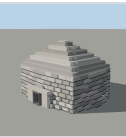
The ladder

Ordered by era, oldest first; numbers run straight through the ladder, so “I want 4, 9, 17 and 22” means the same four buildings next week. Each grammar is photographed on the subject its size class uses — houses at 15×11 m, blocks at 22×16 m, towers at 34×28 m over 40 storeys — so a bungalow is never compared against a supertall. Full plate for each on the pages that follow.

STONE AGE

3

1



Dry-Stone Broch
drystone

2



Neolithic Longhouse
longhouse

3



Wattle Roundhouse
wattle

BRONZE AGE

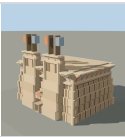
3

4



Mudbrick Ziggurat
urziggurat

5



Mastaba & Pylon
mastaba

6



Minoan Palace
minoan

CLASSICAL ANTIQUITY

1

7



Roman Villa
romanvilla

INDIGENOUS AMERICAS

4

8



Pueblo Adobe
adobe

9



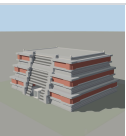
Maya Temple-Pyramid
mayatemple

10



Puuc Palace
puuc

11

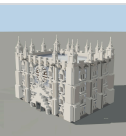


Talud-Tablero Platform
talud

MEDIEVAL EUROPE

4

12



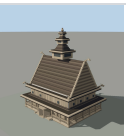
Gothic Revival
gothic

13



English Manor
manor

14



Stave Church
stave

15



Russian Izba
izba

ISLAMIC WORLD & SILK ROAD

2



Grand Mosque
mosque



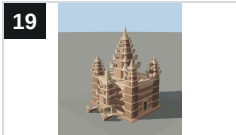
Caravanserai
caravanserai

SOUTH & SOUTHEAST ASIA

3



Nagara Temple
shikhara



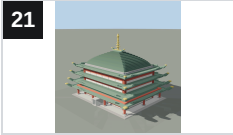
Khmer Prasat
prasat



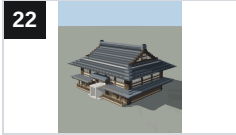
Stupa & Pyatthat
stupa

EAST ASIA

2



Tiered Eaves
pagoda



Japanese Residence
machiya

AFRICA

3



Sahelian Mudbrick
sahelian



Great Zimbabwe Dry-Stone
zimbabwe



Swahili Coral-Stone
swahili

RENAISSANCE & BAROQUE

3



Florentine Palazzo
palazzo



Baroque Church Front
baroque



Palladian Villa
palladian

COLONIAL & EARLY AMERICAN

4



Greek Revival Mansion
greekrev



Antebellum Plantation House
plantation



Brick Colonial House
brickhouse



Spanish Colonial Mansion
spanish

INDUSTRIAL 19TH CENTURY

33



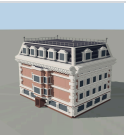
Chicago Loft
brick

34



Ashlar Bank
stone

35



Second Empire
victorian

36



Queen Anne Painted Lady
queenanne

EARLY 20TH CENTURY

37



Seagram Curtain Wall
intl

38



Zoning Setback Tower
ziggurat

39



Radiator Crown
sunburst

40



Cathedral of Commerce
neogothic

41



Deco Tower
artdeco

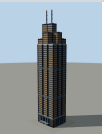
LATE 20TH CENTURY

42



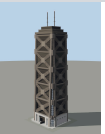
Tapered Spire
pyramid

43



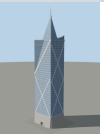
Bundled Tube
bundled

44



Braced Tube
megabrace

45



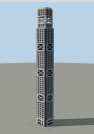
Faceted Prism
faceted

46



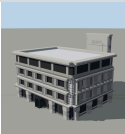
Broken Pediment
postmodern

47



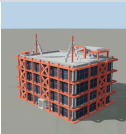
Supertall Slim
pencil

48



Beton Brut
brutalist

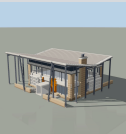
49



Exostructure
hightech

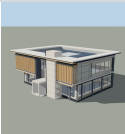
CONTEMPORARY

50



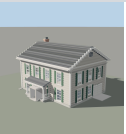
Desert Modern House
desertmod

51



Modern Tech House
techhouse

52



Plain House
ranch

NEAR FUTURE

53



Arcology Terrace
arcology

54



Printed Shell
printed

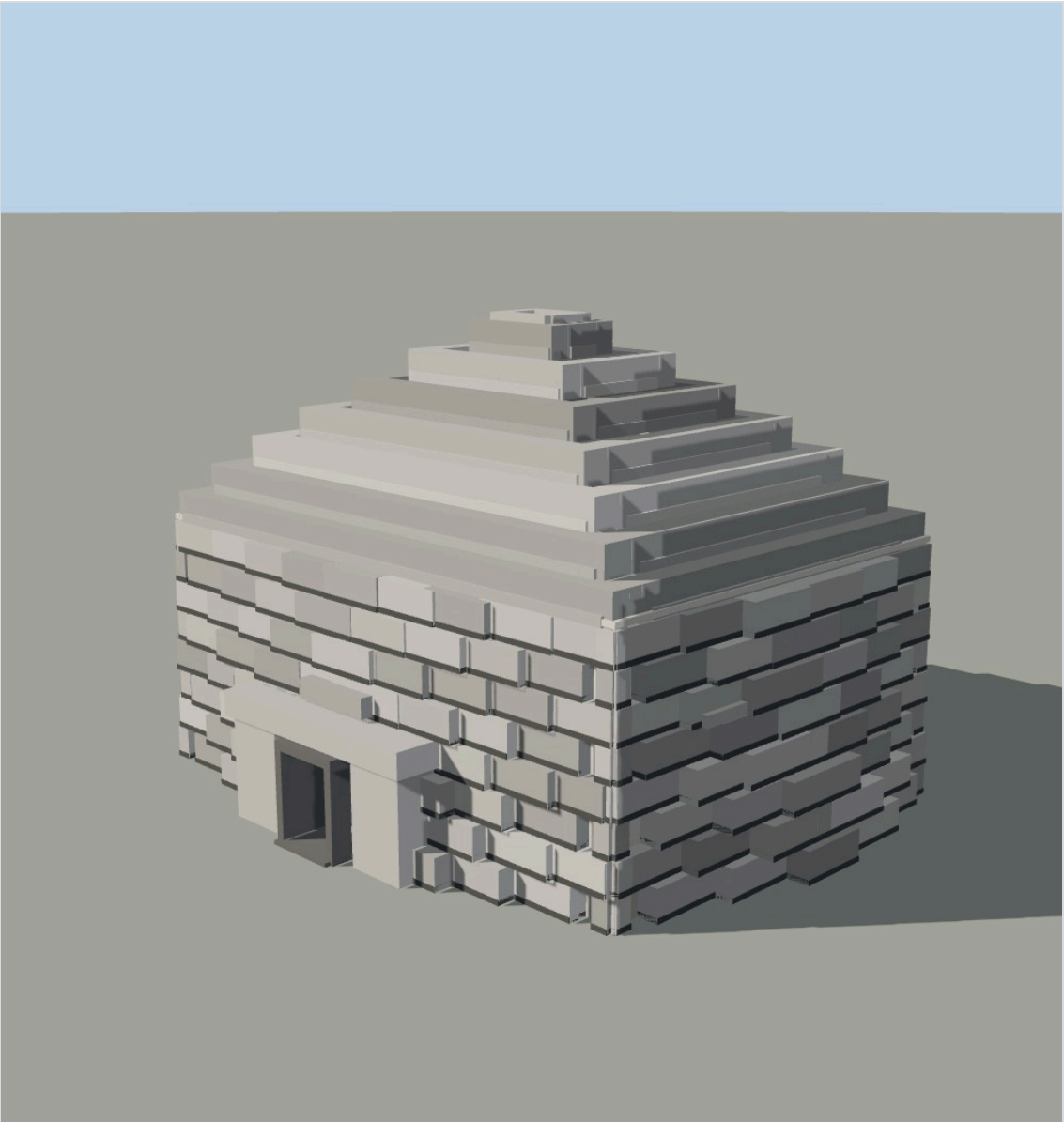
55



Mass Timber Tower
masstimber

1 Dry-Stone Broch

STONE AGE · HOUSE · drystone · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



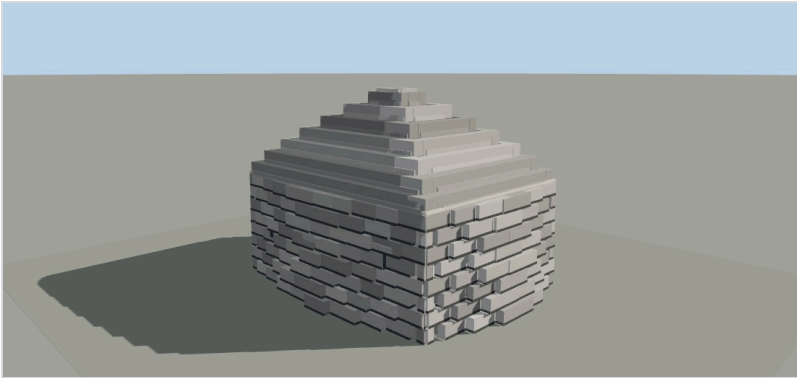
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Skara Brae / broch. Coursed unmortared rubble battering inward, a corbelled roof closing to a smoke hole, a creep entrance under one massive lintel. No windows.

AS A CITY: A Neolithic settlement — huts, a passage tomb, a stone circle, a souterrain. The oldest thing a city can be.



From the pavement — the entrance

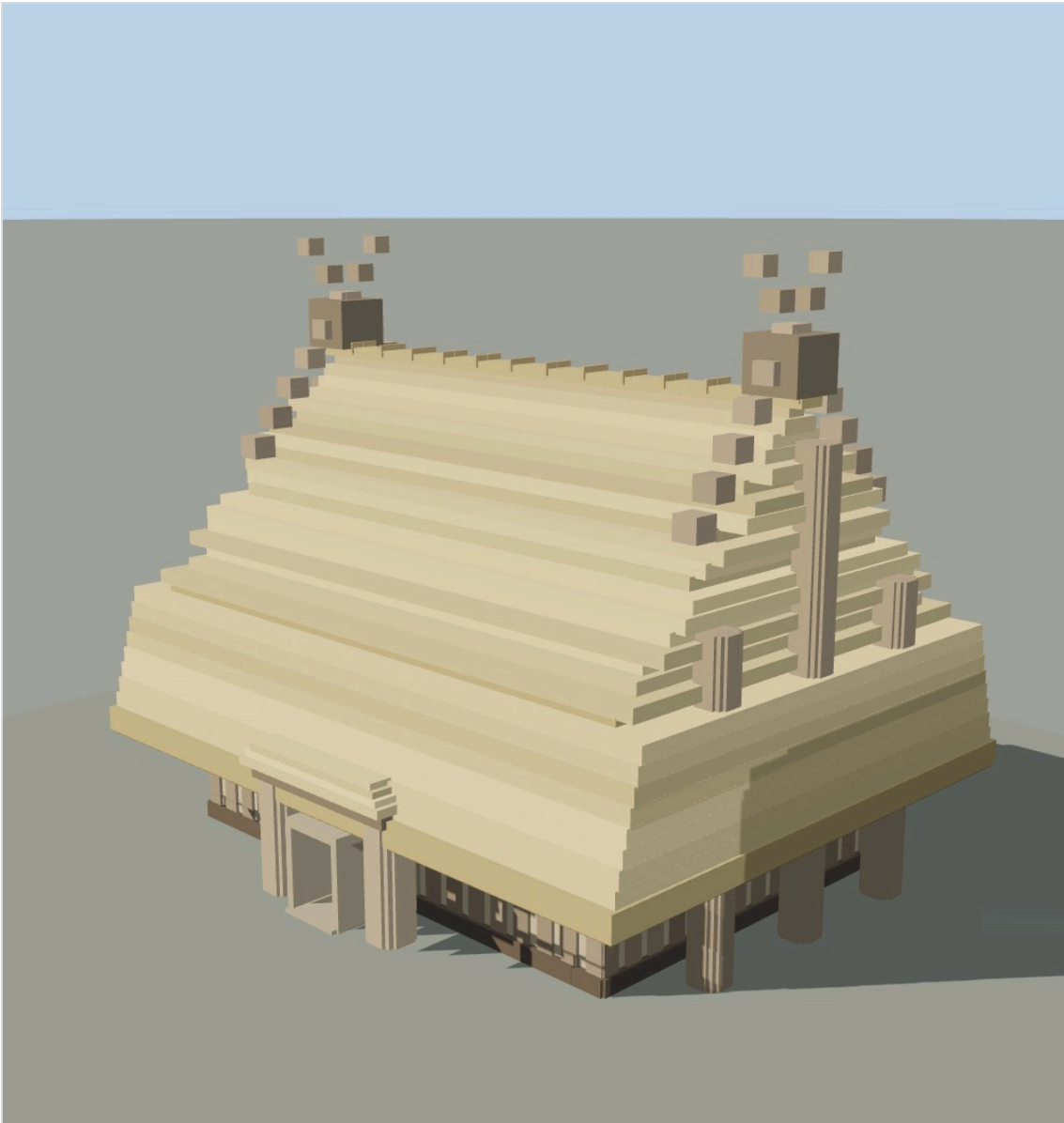


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+5.6 m	Tallest point	12 m
Things breaking the roofline	18	Triangles	8,172
Merged deco boxes (free)	681	Minted meshes (not)	0

2 Neolithic Longhouse

STONE AGE · HOUSE · longhouse · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



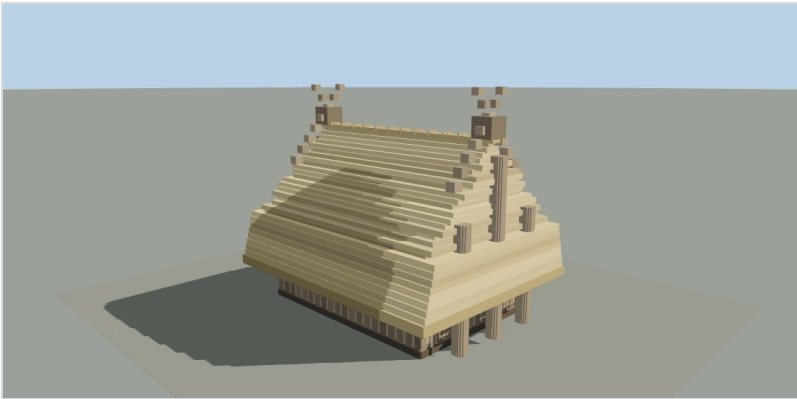
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

The roof IS the building: enormous thatch sweeping nearly to the ground, crossed ridge poles, heavy gable posts, one door, no windows.

AS A CITY: A forest-clearing village of longhouses, a palisade, a granary on posts.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+10.1 m	Tallest point	16.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	34	Triangles	3,636
Merged deco boxes (free)	303	Minted meshes (not)	0

3 Wattle Roundhouse

STONE AGE · HOUSE · wattle · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Conical thatch over daub walls showing the stake-and-weave beneath, a ring of posts, a two-post porch. Made to read round on a rectangular plan.

AS A CITY: An Iron Age roundhouse cluster inside a ditch and bank.



From the pavement — the entrance

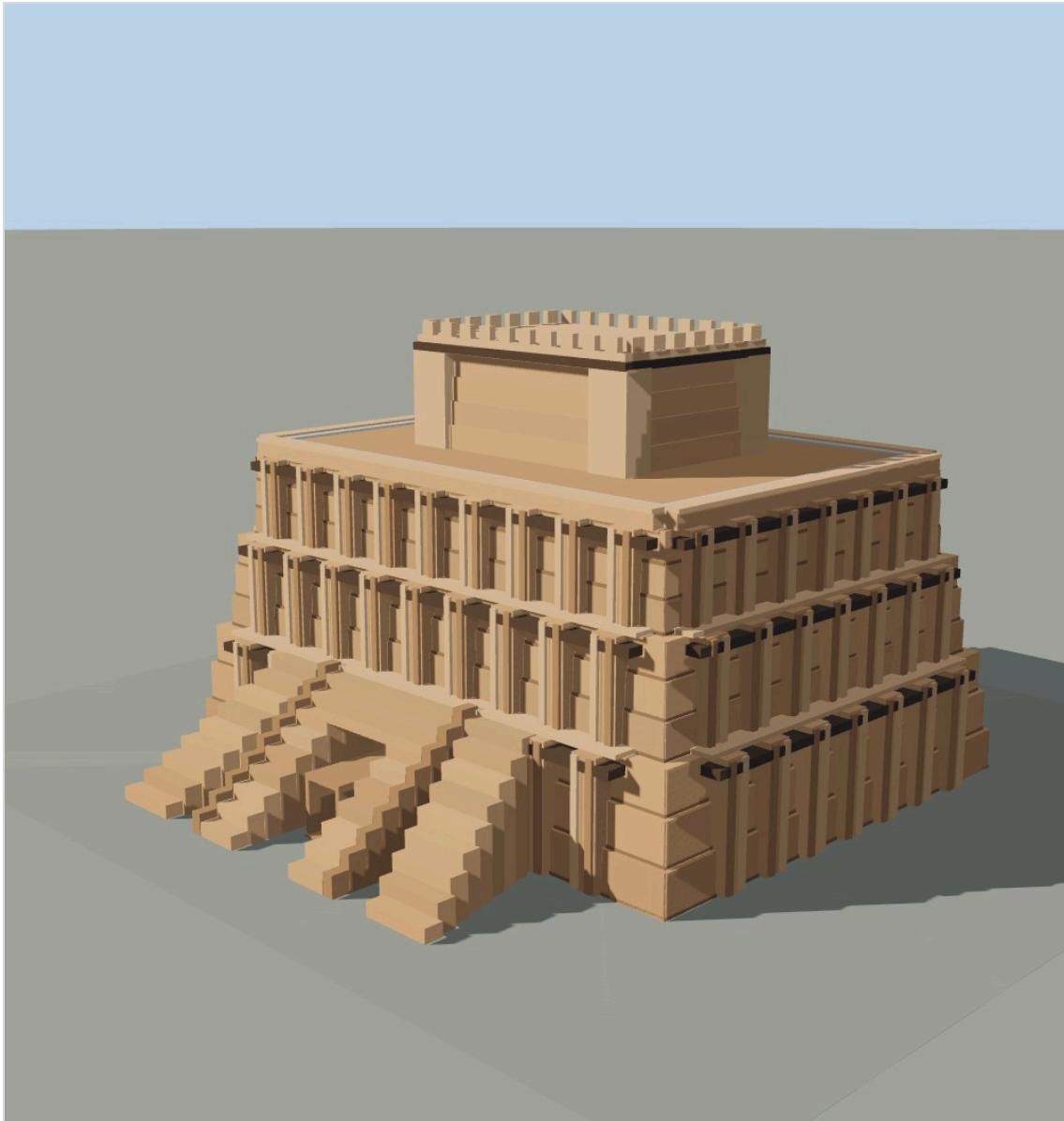


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+13.6 m	Tallest point	20 m
Things breaking the roofline	13	Triangles	4,836
Merged deco boxes (free)	382	Minted meshes (not)	6

4 Mudbrick Ziggurat

BRONZE AGE · MID-RISE BLOCK · urziggurat · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



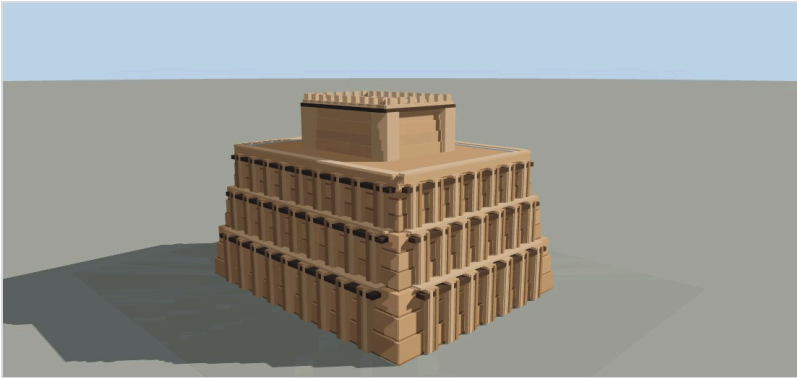
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Ur. Three receding battered terraces, a monumental triple stair, reeded pilaster-and-buttress rhythm on every face, a shrine on the summit. Not to be confused with the 1916 zoning tower that shares the word.

AS A CITY: A Mesopotamian temple-city: ziggurat, mudbrick courtyard houses, a walled precinct, a gate of glazed brick.



From the pavement — the entrance

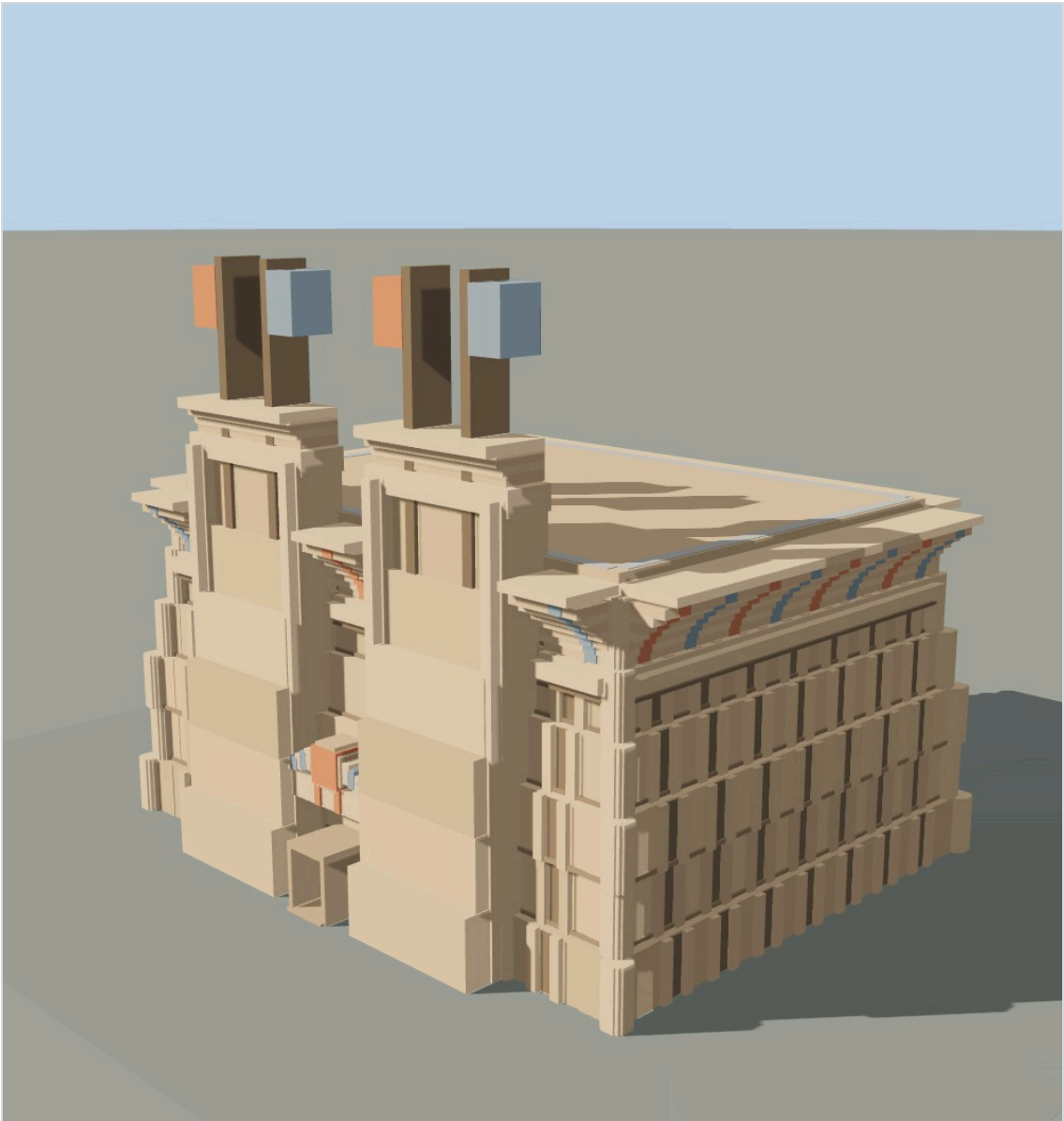


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+5.7 m	Tallest point	18.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	12	Triangles	6,828
Merged deco boxes (free)	569	Minted meshes (not)	0

5 Mastaba & Pylon

BRONZE AGE · MID-RISE BLOCK · mastaba · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



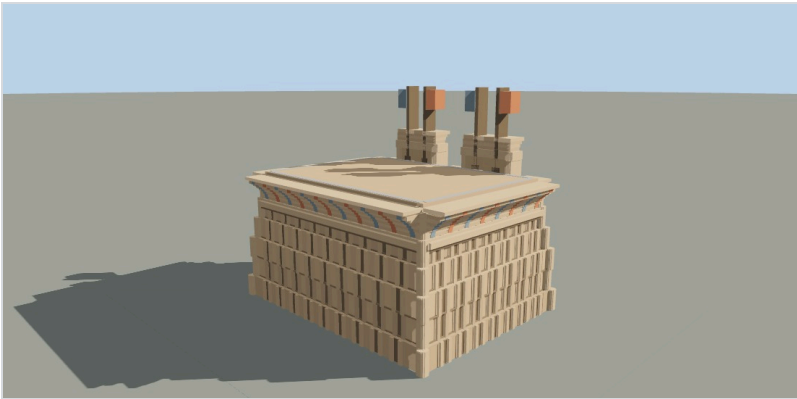
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Egyptian. Walls battering inward, a torus roll up every corner, a cavetto cornice flaring at the top, a pylon gate with flagstaff niches.

AS A CITY: A Nile temple precinct — pylon, hypostyle hall, mastaba tombs, an avenue of sphinxes.



From the pavement — the entrance

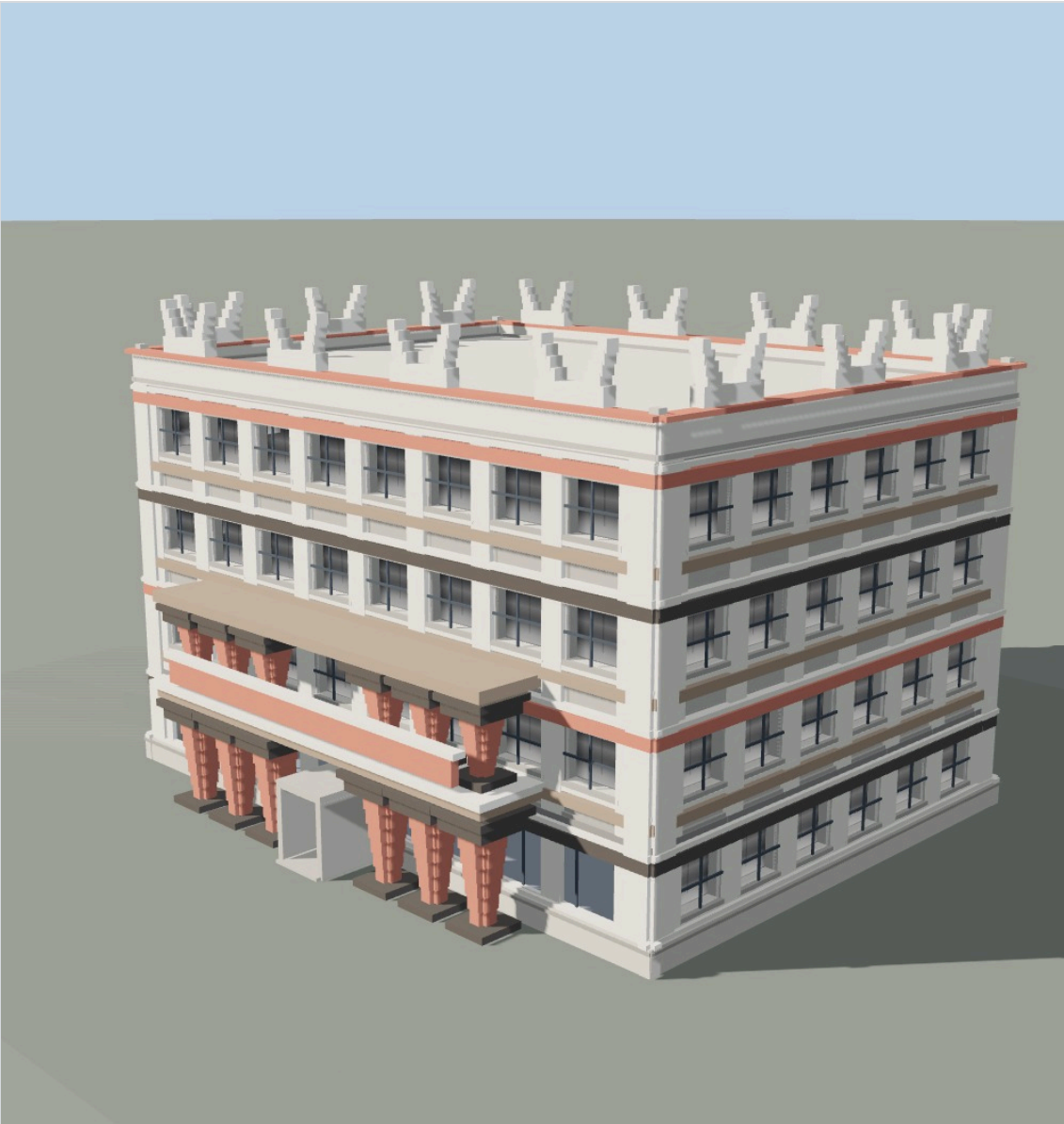


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+9.2 m	Tallest point	22 m
Things breaking the roofline	13	Triangles	13,080
Merged deco boxes (free)	1090	Minted meshes (not)	0

6 Minoan Palace

BRONZE AGE · MID-RISE BLOCK · minoan · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



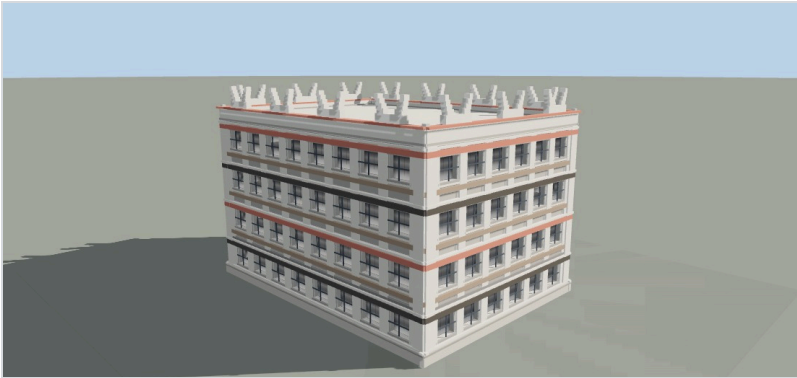
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Knossos. The downward-tapering column — wider at the top, the opposite of every other column in the kit — red and black banding, a colonnaded light-well, horns of consecration on the parapet.

AS A CITY: An Aegean palace town: the palace, storerooms, a theatral area, terraced houses down to a harbour.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+2.7 m	Tallest point	15.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	8	Triangles	23,336
Merged deco boxes (free)	1944	Minted meshes (not)	4

7 Roman Villa

CLASSICAL ANTIQUITY · HOUSE · romanvilla · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



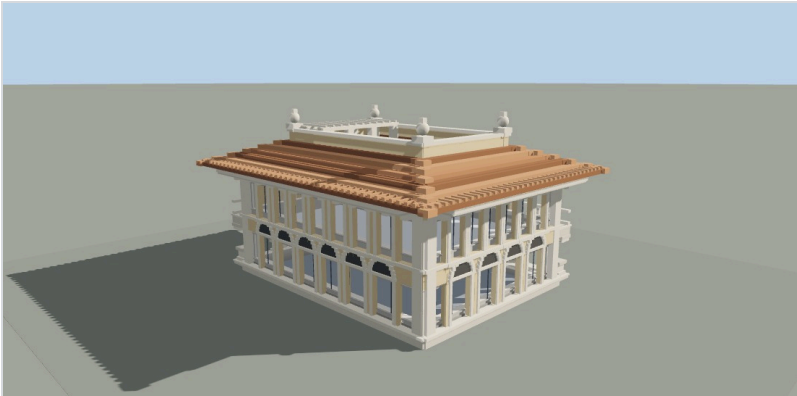
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Roman villa: a low tile roof, a colonnaded peristyle, stuccoed masonry, a courtyard the building wraps.

AS A CITY: A Mediterranean antique quarter — villa, baths, forum stoa, insula.



From the pavement — the entrance

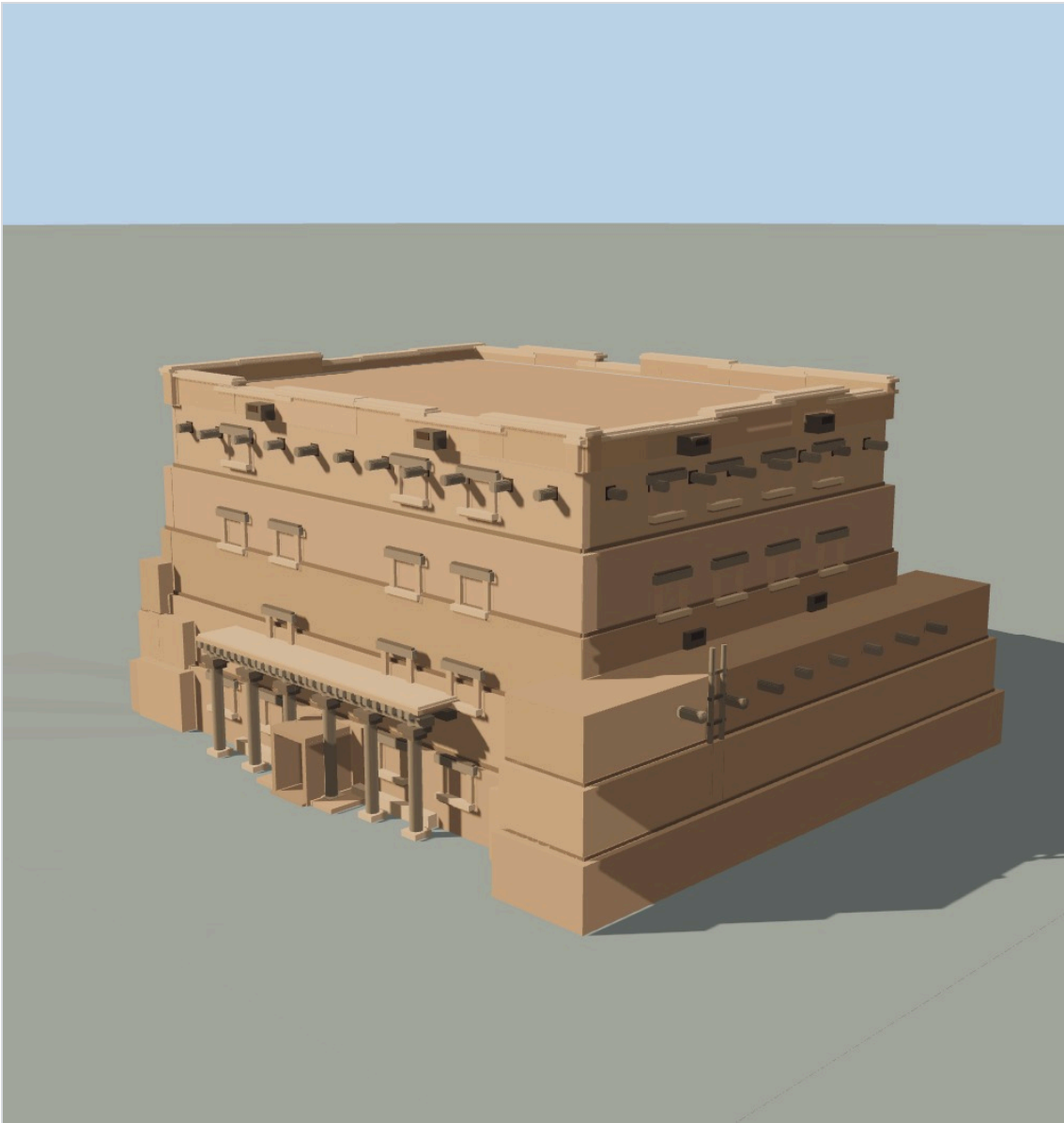


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+3.9 m	Tallest point	10.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	14	Triangles	18,420
Merged deco boxes (free)	1495	Minted meshes (not)	4

8 Pueblo Adobe

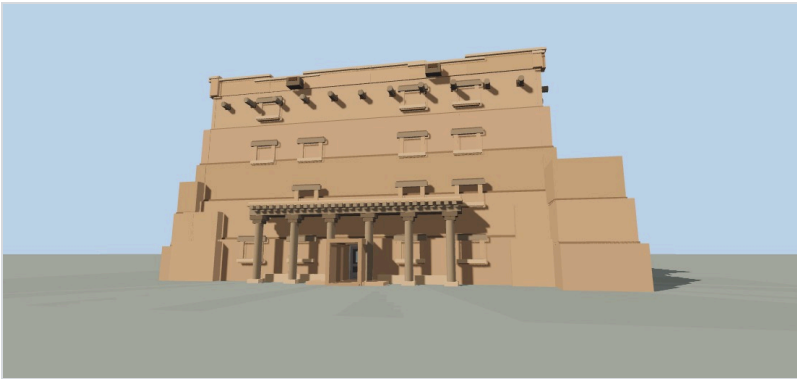
INDIGENOUS AMERICAS · MID-RISE BLOCK · adobe · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



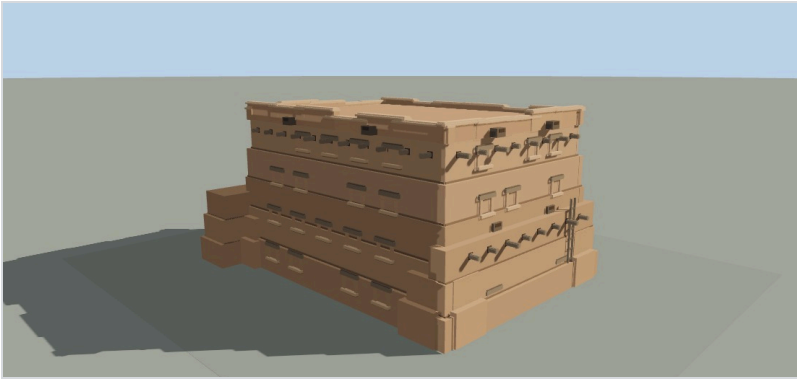
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Earthen mass: battered walls thickening to the base, projecting vigas, stepped massing, small deep-set windows, a latilla porch. Irregularity IS the style.

AS A CITY: A pueblo/Saltlands town — mission church, trading post, stacked terraced dwellings.



From the pavement — the entrance

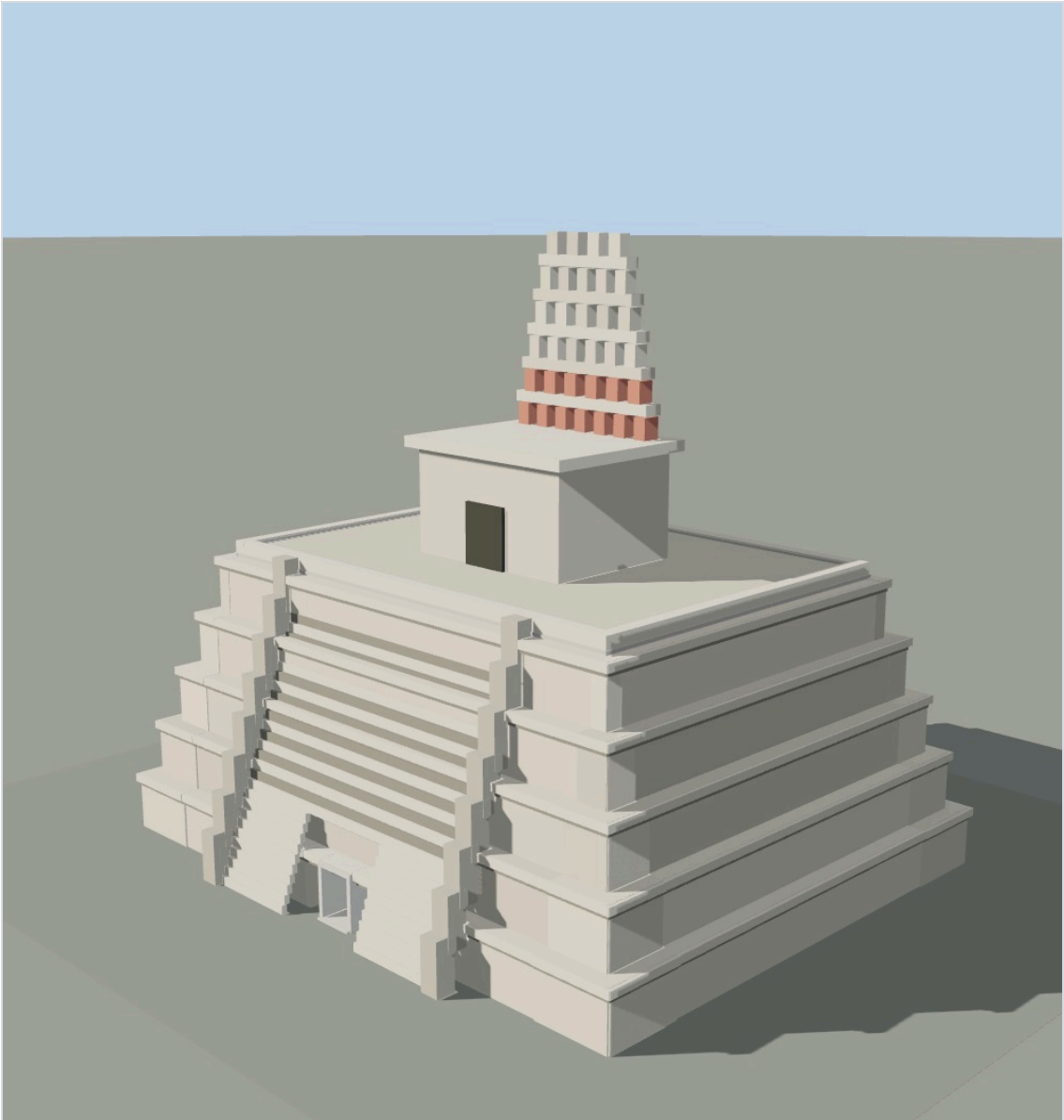


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+1.7 m	Tallest point	14.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	24	Triangles	16,912
Merged deco boxes (free)	1382	Minted meshes (not)	10

9 Maya Temple-Pyramid

INDIGENOUS AMERICAS · MID-RISE BLOCK · mayatemple · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



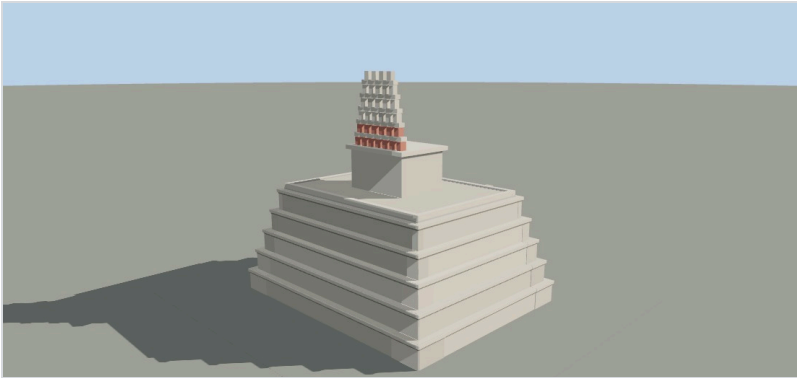
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Tikal. A far steeper stepped pyramid than a ziggurat, a small cella on the summit, and a roof comb standing above it taller than the cella itself. The comb is the silhouette.

AS A CITY: A Maya city — temple pyramids, a palace range, a ballcourt, stelae in a plaza.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+14.2 m	Tallest point	27 m
Things breaking the roofline	23	Triangles	2,940
Merged deco boxes (free)	245	Minted meshes (not)	0

10 Puuc Palace

INDIGENOUS AMERICAS · MID-RISE BLOCK · puuc · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



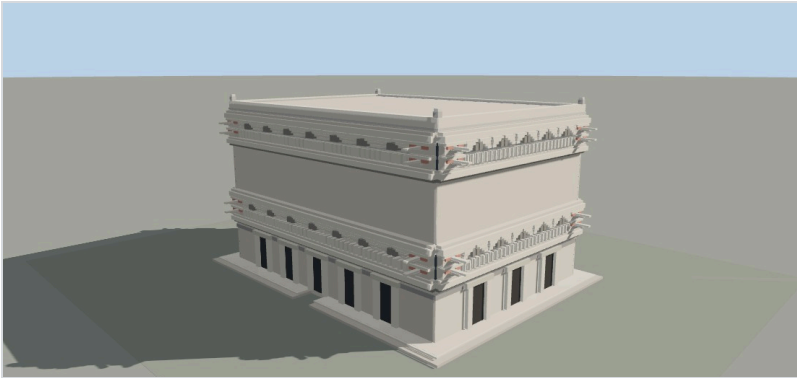
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Uxmal. A plain lower wall and, above a medial moulding, an encrusted upper frieze of stone mosaic: colonnettes, stepped fret, stacked long-nosed masks at the corners.

AS A CITY: A Puuc hill town: palace, nunnery quadrangle, arch gateway, chultun cisterns.



From the pavement — the entrance

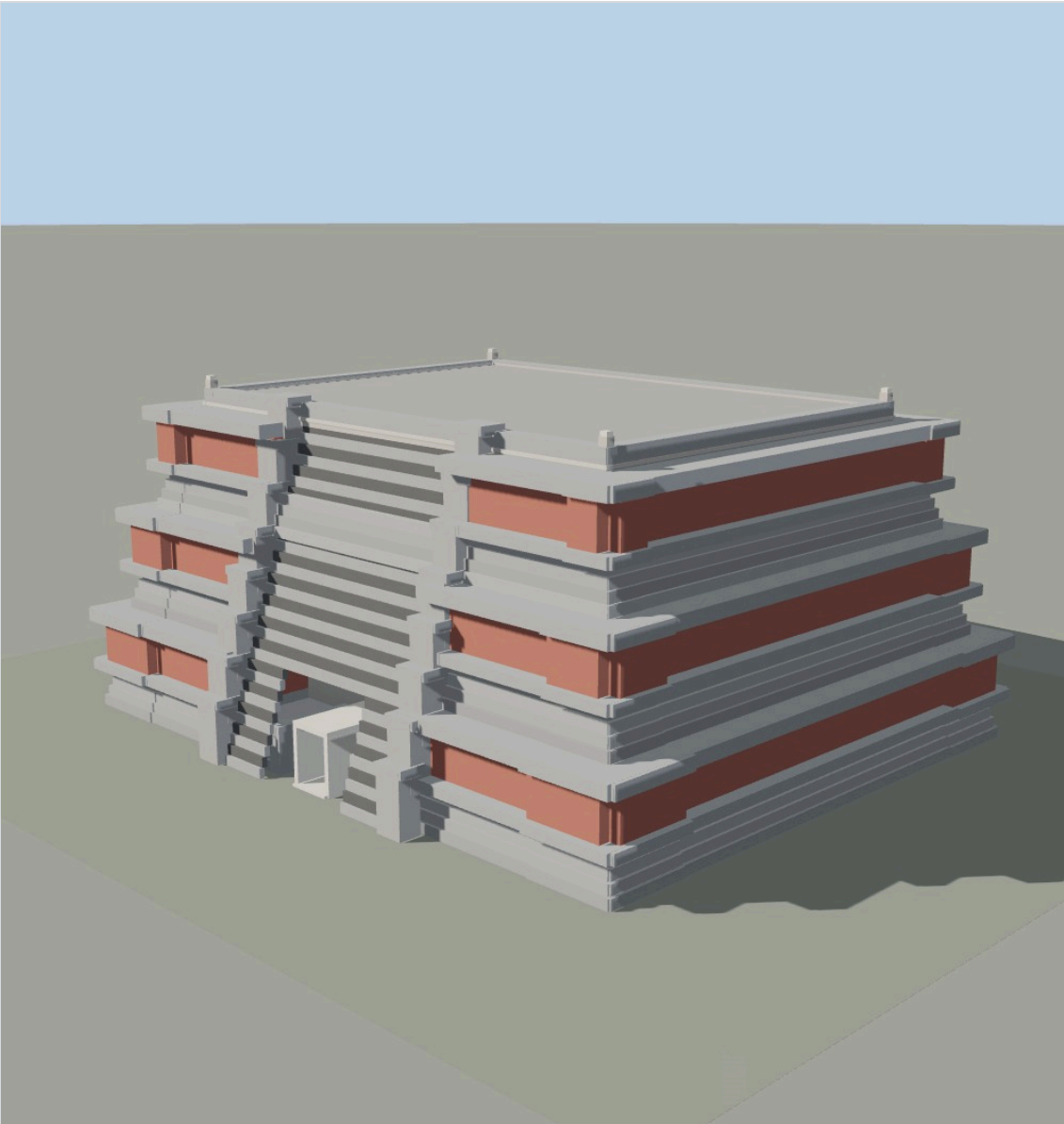


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+1.2 m	Tallest point	14 m
Things breaking the roofline	7	Triangles	17,508
Merged deco boxes (free)	1459	Minted meshes (not)	0

11 Talud-Tablero Platform

INDIGENOUS AMERICAS · MID-RISE BLOCK · talud · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



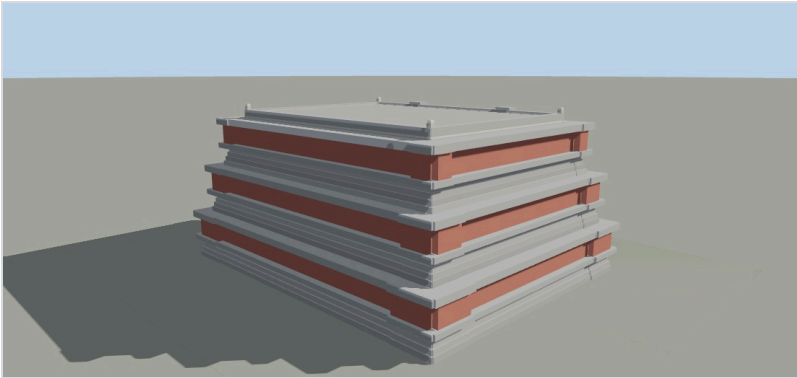
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Teotihuacan. A repeating unit stacked up the elevation — sloping talud, then a framed vertical tablero that oversails it. The projecting frame throws the shadow that makes the profile.

AS A CITY: The Avenue of the Dead: platforms, apartment compounds, a painted precinct.



From the pavement — the entrance

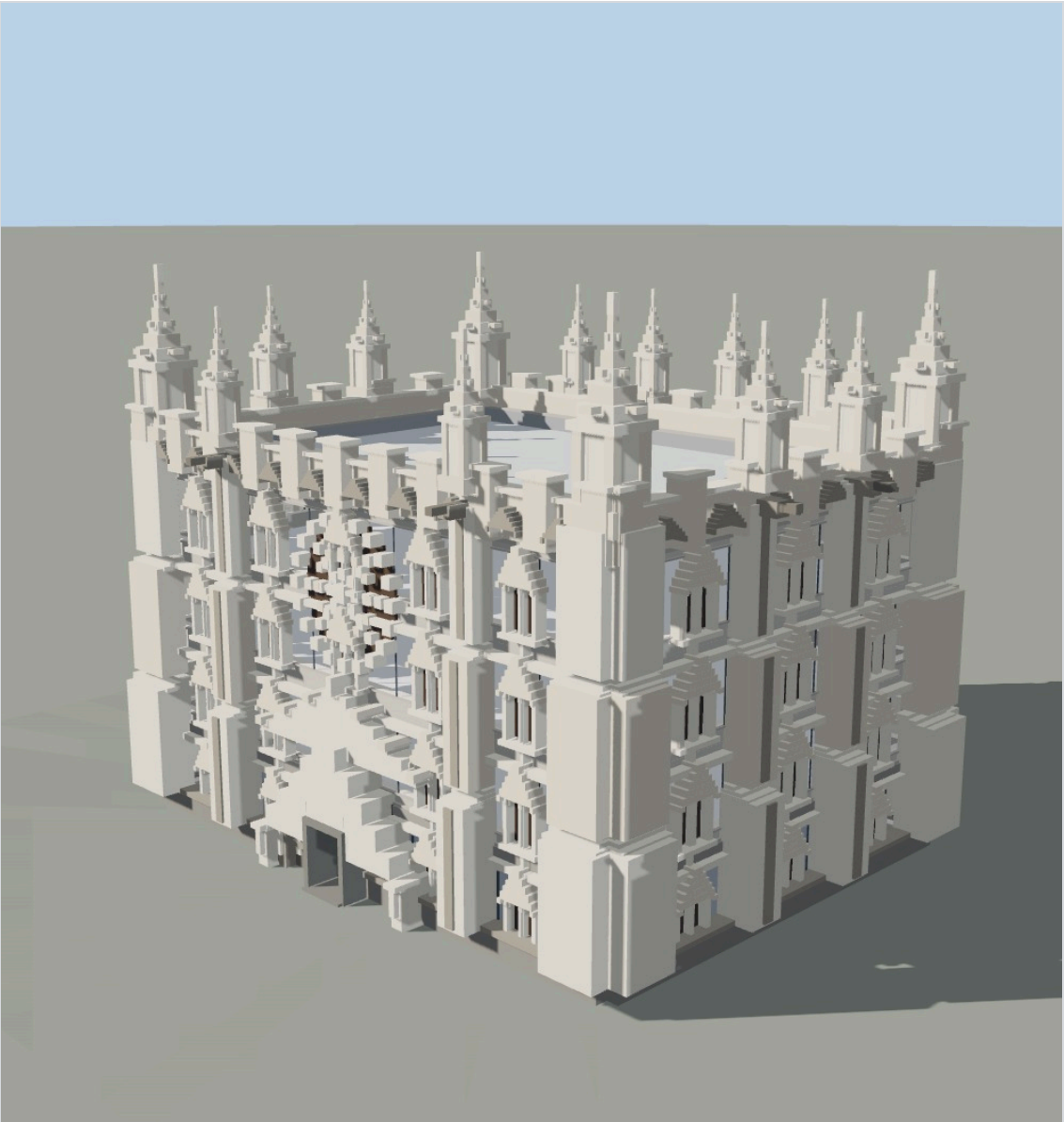


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+1.2 m	Tallest point	14 m
Things breaking the roofline	8	Triangles	3,120
Merged deco boxes (free)	260	Minted meshes (not)	0

12 Gothic Revival

MEDIEVAL EUROPE · MID-RISE BLOCK · gothic · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



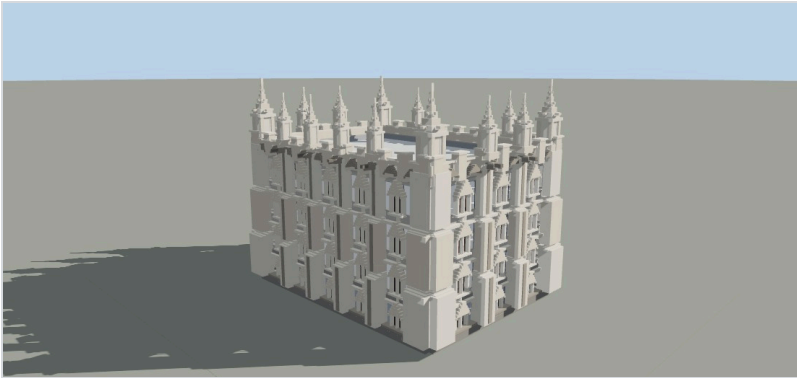
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Gothic Revival civic front: buttresses stepping back as they rise, pinnacles breaking the roofline, tracery, a rose window over a deep portal. Everything ends in a point.

AS A CITY: An old-world cathedral town — the hall, the guild, the college quad, the parish church.



From the pavement — the entrance

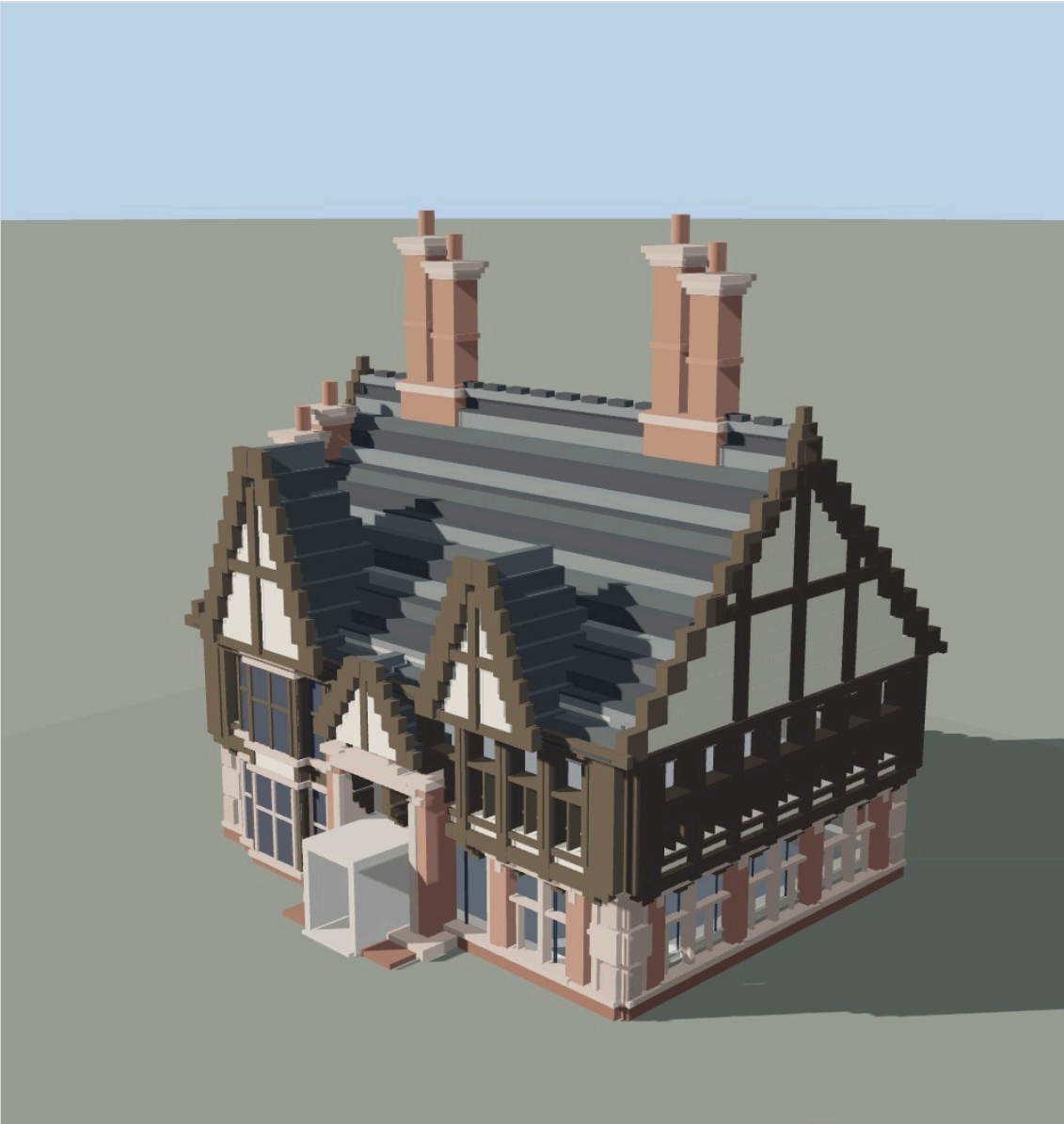


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+7 m	Tallest point	19.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	9	Triangles	55,176
Merged deco boxes (free)	4598	Minted meshes (not)	0

13 English Manor

MEDIEVAL EUROPE · HOUSE · manor · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



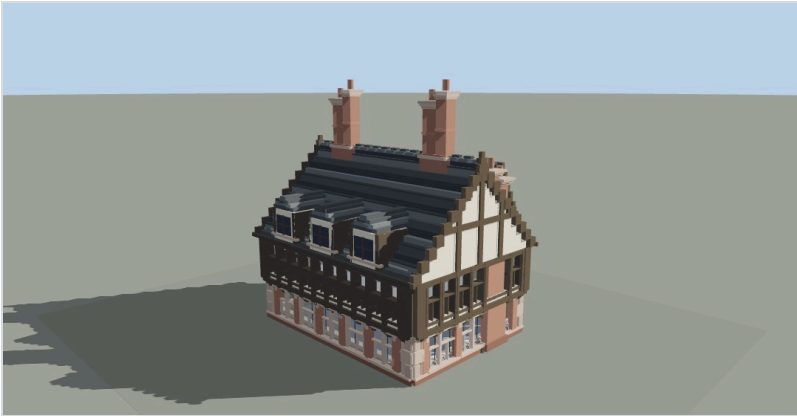
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

English manor: steep gables, half-timbering, tall grouped chimney stacks, leaded casements, a stone porch bay.

AS A CITY: A Tudor village — inn, church, market hall, timbered terrace.



From the pavement — the entrance

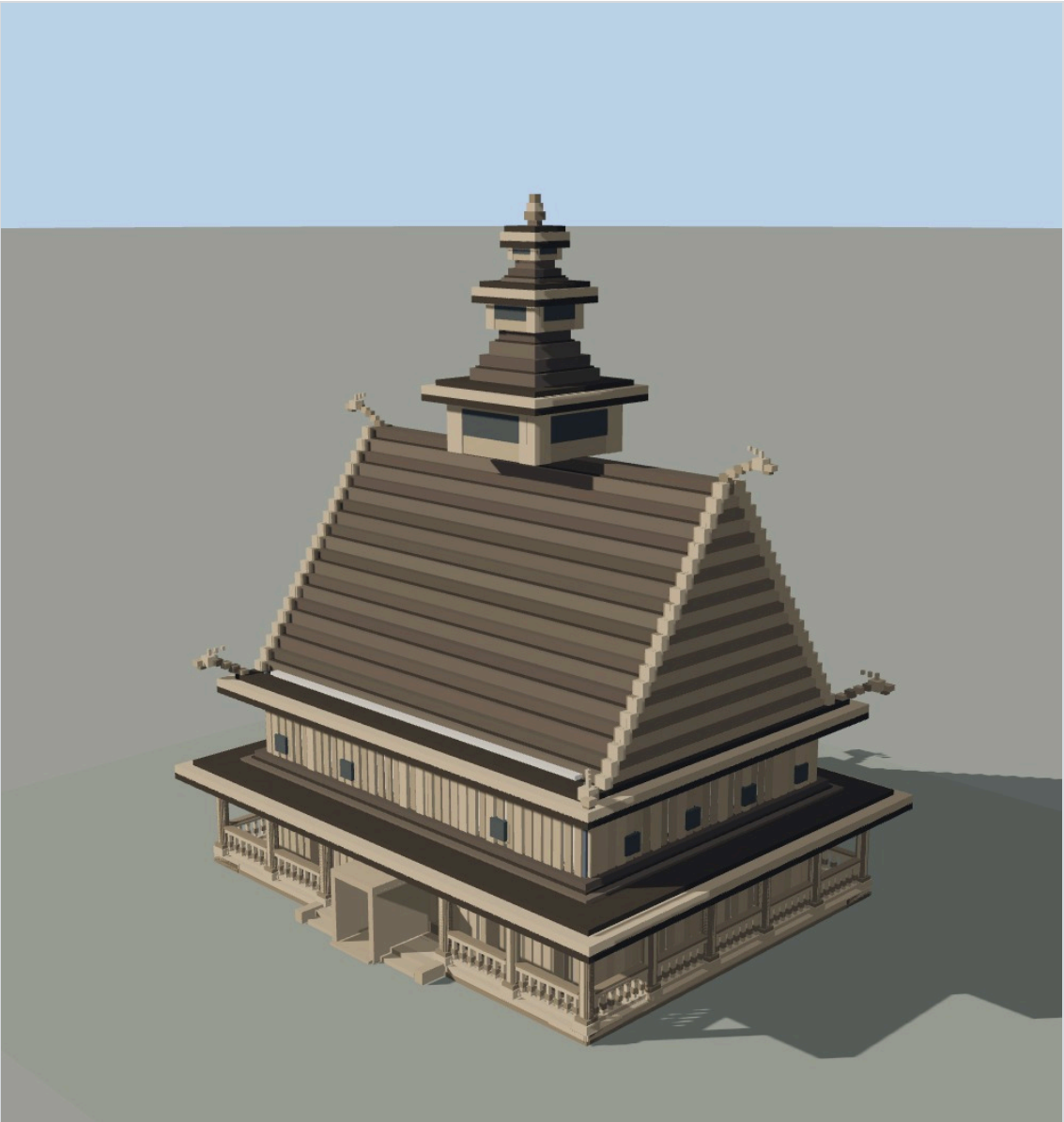


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+11.4 m	Tallest point	17.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	20	Triangles	13,224
Merged deco boxes (free)	1086	Minted meshes (not)	6

14 Stave Church

MEDIEVAL EUROPE · HOUSE · stave · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



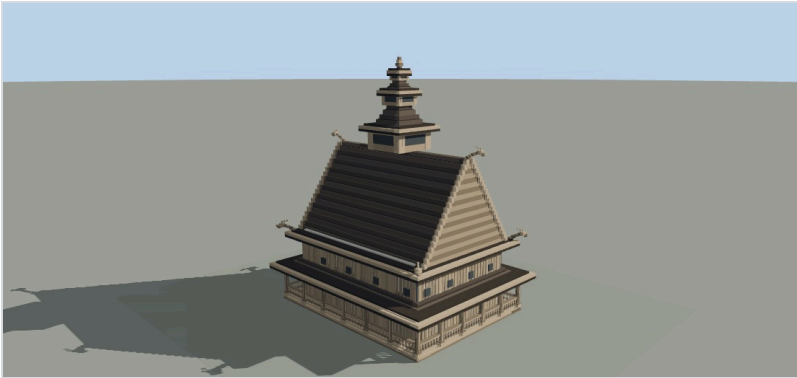
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Borgund. Steeply pitched shingled roofs stacked in diminishing tiers climbing to a point, dragon-head finials at the gables, an external gallery on posts, vertical stave planking.

AS A CITY: A Norse valley: stave church, longhouse farmstead, a stabbur on staddle stones, a boathouse.



From the pavement — the entrance

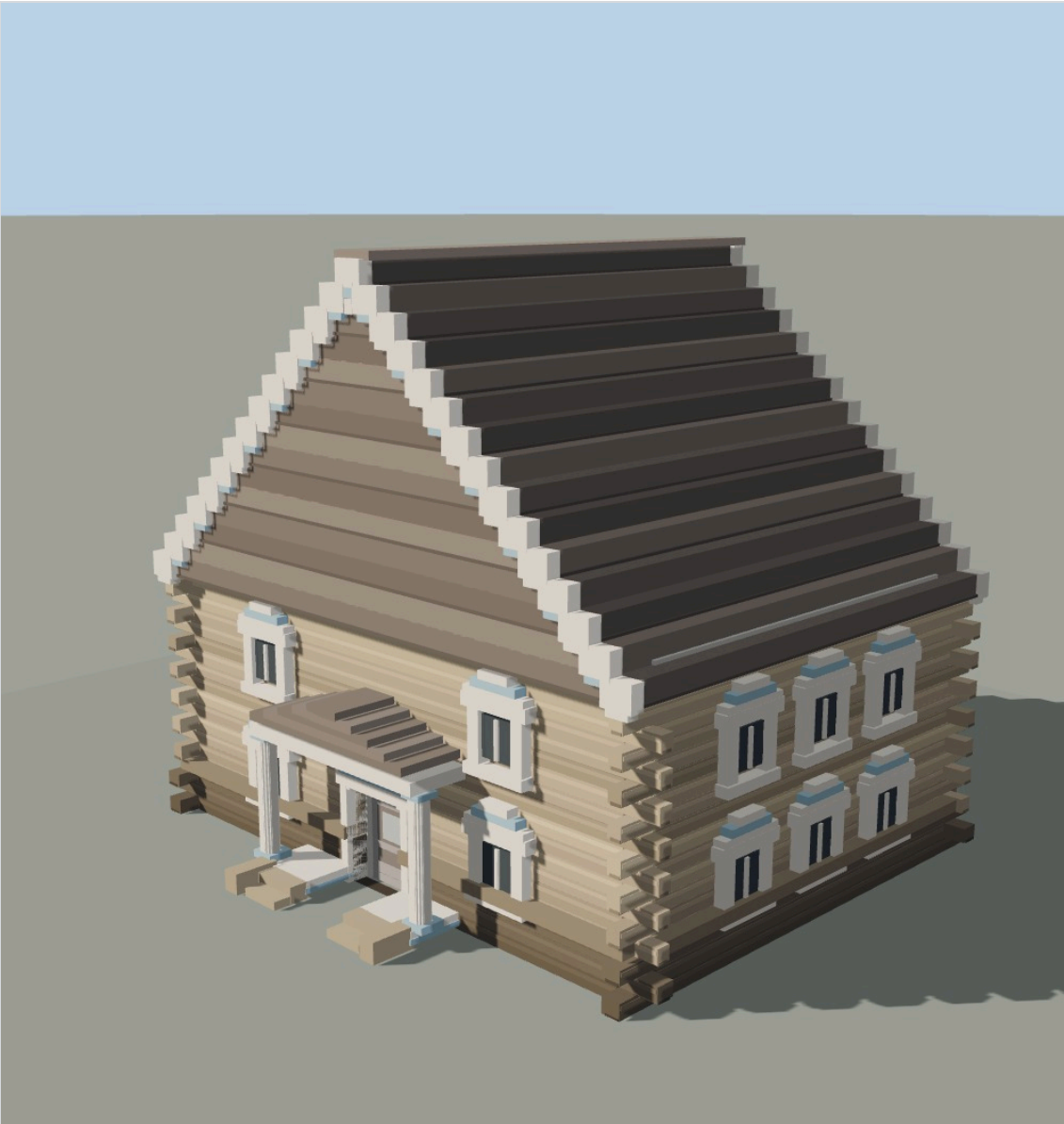


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+16.6 m	Tallest point	23 m
Things breaking the roofline	29	Triangles	13,488
Merged deco boxes (free)	1124	Minted meshes (not)	0

15 Russian Izba

MEDIEVAL EUROPE · HOUSE · izba · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Horizontal log courses with interlocked corners whose ends project past the wall at every course, a raised podklet, a carved bargeboard, nalichniki window surrounds.

AS A CITY: A Russian village — izby along one street, a wooden church, a bathhouse, a well crane.



From the pavement — the entrance

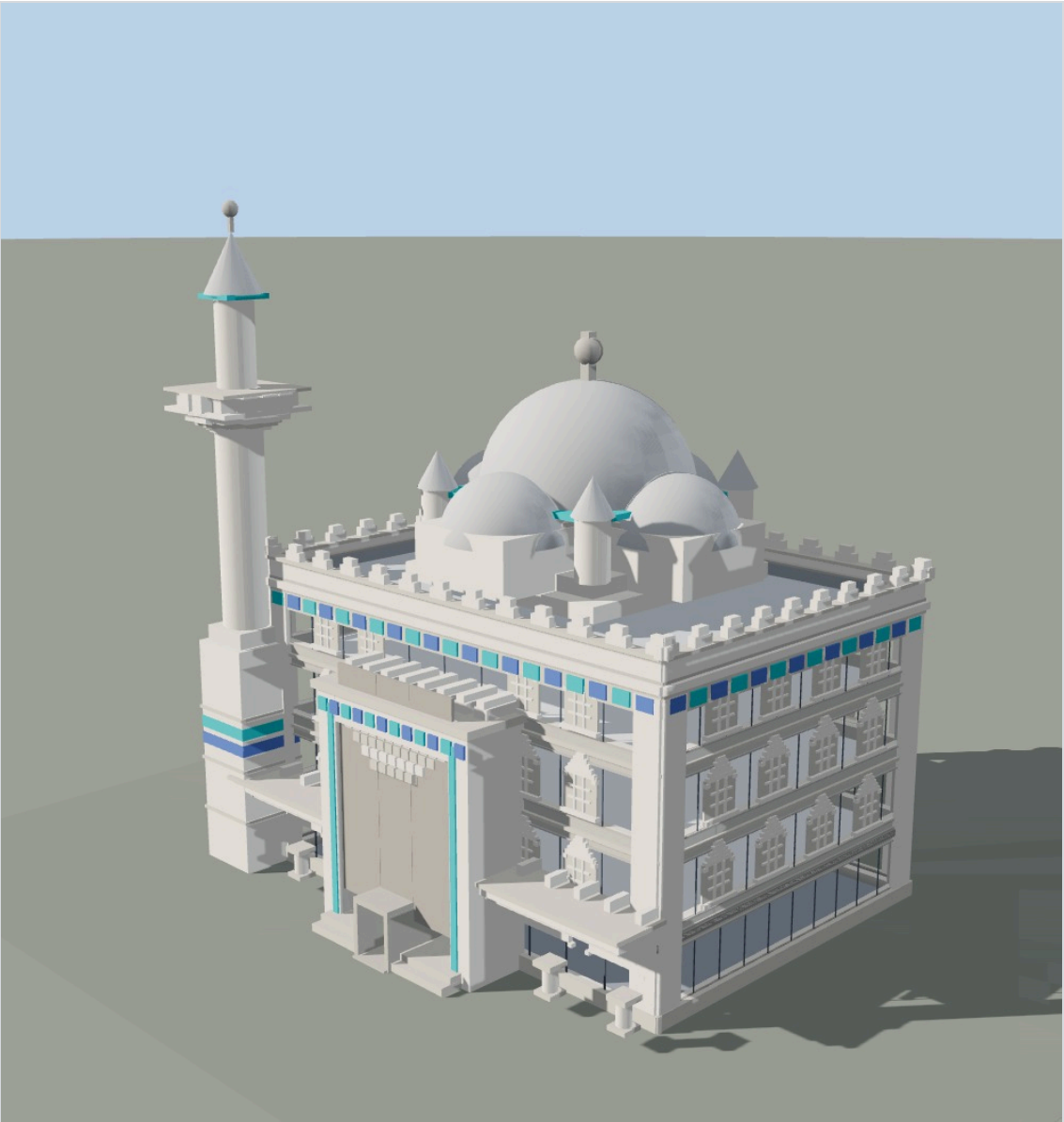


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+8.4 m	Tallest point	14.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	10	Triangles	8,544
Merged deco boxes (free)	712	Minted meshes (not)	0

16 Grand Mosque

ISLAMIC WORLD & SILK ROAD · MID-RISE BLOCK · mosque · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Dome on a buttressed drum, a minaret off one corner, horseshoe arcade, monumental pishtaq portal.

AS A CITY: An Islamic old city: the great mosque, the madrasa, the caravanserai, the covered bazaar. Big cultural payoff.



From the pavement — the entrance

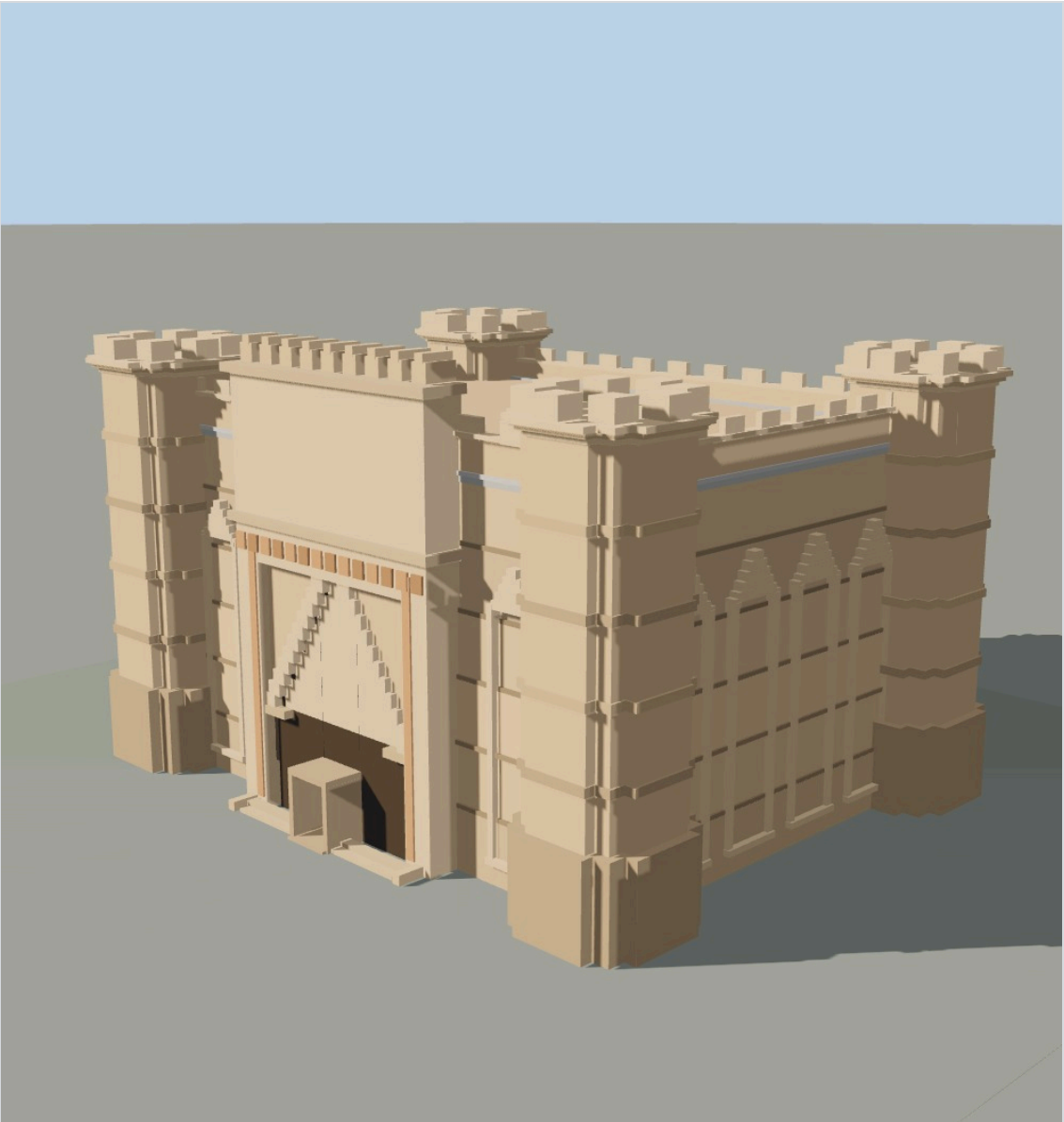


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+16 m	Tallest point	28.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	28	Triangles	22,602
Merged deco boxes (free)	1645	Minted meshes (not)	25

17 Caravanserai

ISLAMIC WORLD & SILK ROAD · MID-RISE BLOCK · caravanserai · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



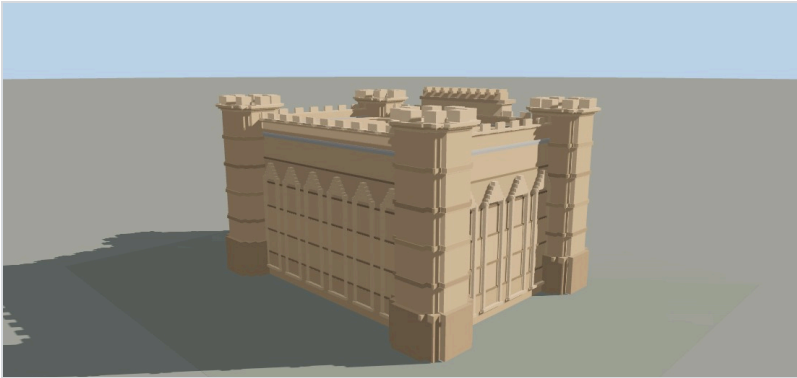
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

A fortified block with corner towers, a crenellated parapet and almost no openings, spending everything on one monumental iwan portal projecting above the parapet.

AS A CITY: A Silk Road halt: caravanserai, covered bazaar, madrasa, a domed cistern.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+3.7 m	Tallest point	16.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	9	Triangles	7,644
Merged deco boxes (free)	637	Minted meshes (not)	0

18 Nagara Temple

SOUTH & SOUTHEAST ASIA · MID-RISE BLOCK · shikhara · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



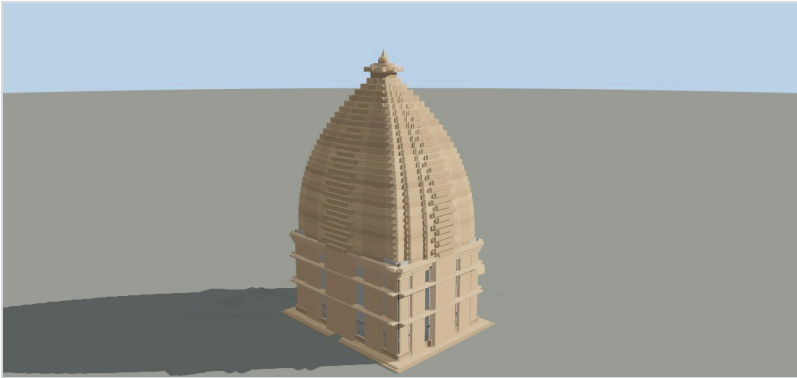
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Khajuraho. A curvilinear tower of stacked receding courses that rises vertically then curves in, an amalaka disc and pot finial at the apex, a mandapa porch under its own stepped roof, a star-pointed plan.

AS A CITY: A Nagara temple town: shikhara, tank with ghats, a pillared hall, subsidiary shrines.



From the pavement — the entrance

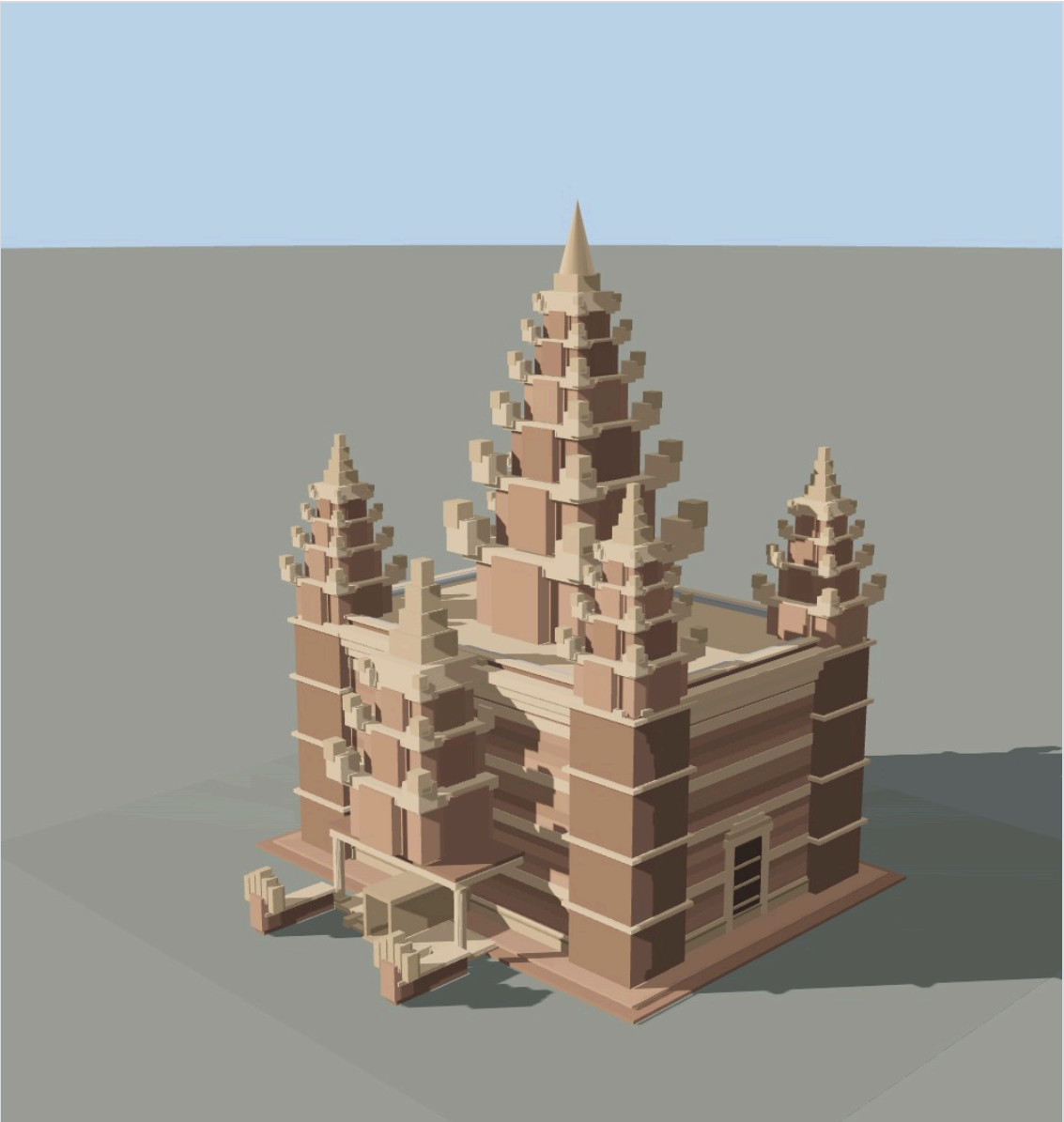


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+27.2 m	Tallest point	40 m
Things breaking the roofline	65	Triangles	6,502
Merged deco boxes (free)	501	Minted meshes (not)	7

19 Khmer Prasat

SOUTH & SOUTHEAST ASIA · MID-RISE BLOCK · prasat · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



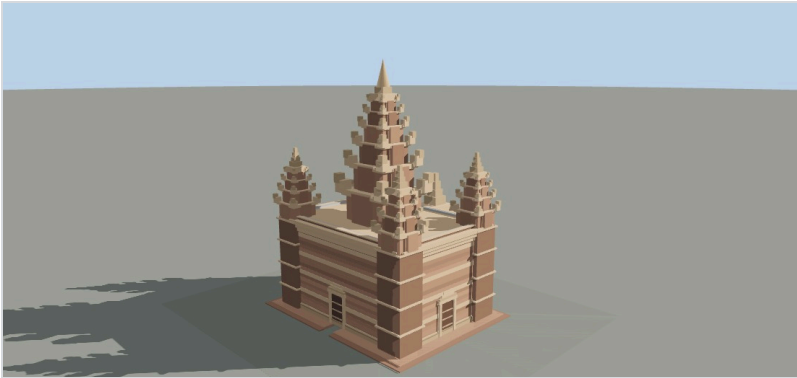
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Angkor. A quincunx — one central tower and four at the corners — each a stack of diminishing storeys with antefix horns at every tier, false doors on three sides, naga balustrades.

AS A CITY: A Khmer temple-city: prasat, gopura gates, a baray reservoir, a laterite causeway.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+21.2 m	Tallest point	34 m
Things breaking the roofline	37	Triangles	7,722
Merged deco boxes (free)	640	Minted meshes (not)	1

20 Stupa & Pyatthat

SOUTH & SOUTHEAST ASIA · MID-RISE BLOCK · stupa · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Bagan. A bell on a stepped terrace under an hti — a spire of diminishing rings — with a pyatthat, the multi-tiered spired roof, over the entrance hall.

AS A CITY: A plain of pagodas: stupa, ordination hall, monastery, a pyatthat gate.



From the pavement — the entrance

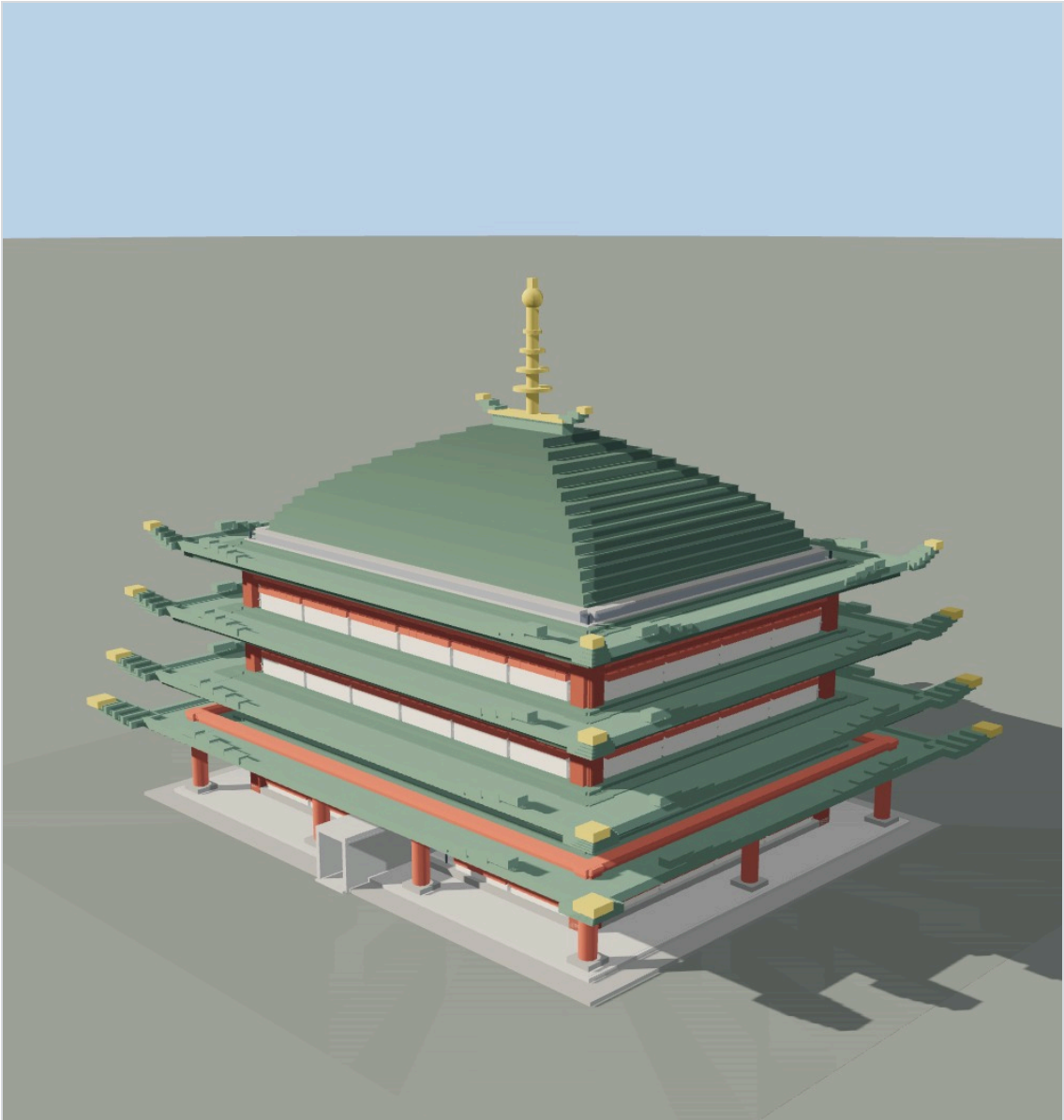


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+27.5 m	Tallest point	40.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	24	Triangles	19,626
Merged deco boxes (free)	1622	Minted meshes (not)	2

21 Tiered Eaves

EAST ASIA · MID-RISE BLOCK · pagoda · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



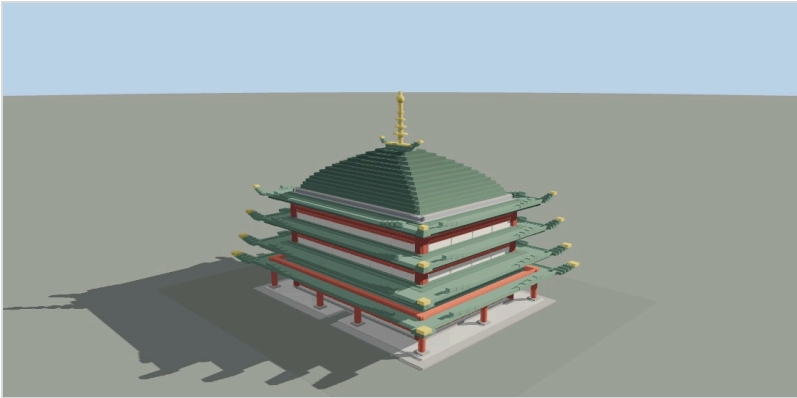
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Timber frame under deep tiered eaves with upturned corners on visible dougong brackets. The lowest eave projects the furthest.

AS A CITY: An East Asian temple quarter: gate, hall, drum tower, pagoda proper.



From the pavement — the entrance

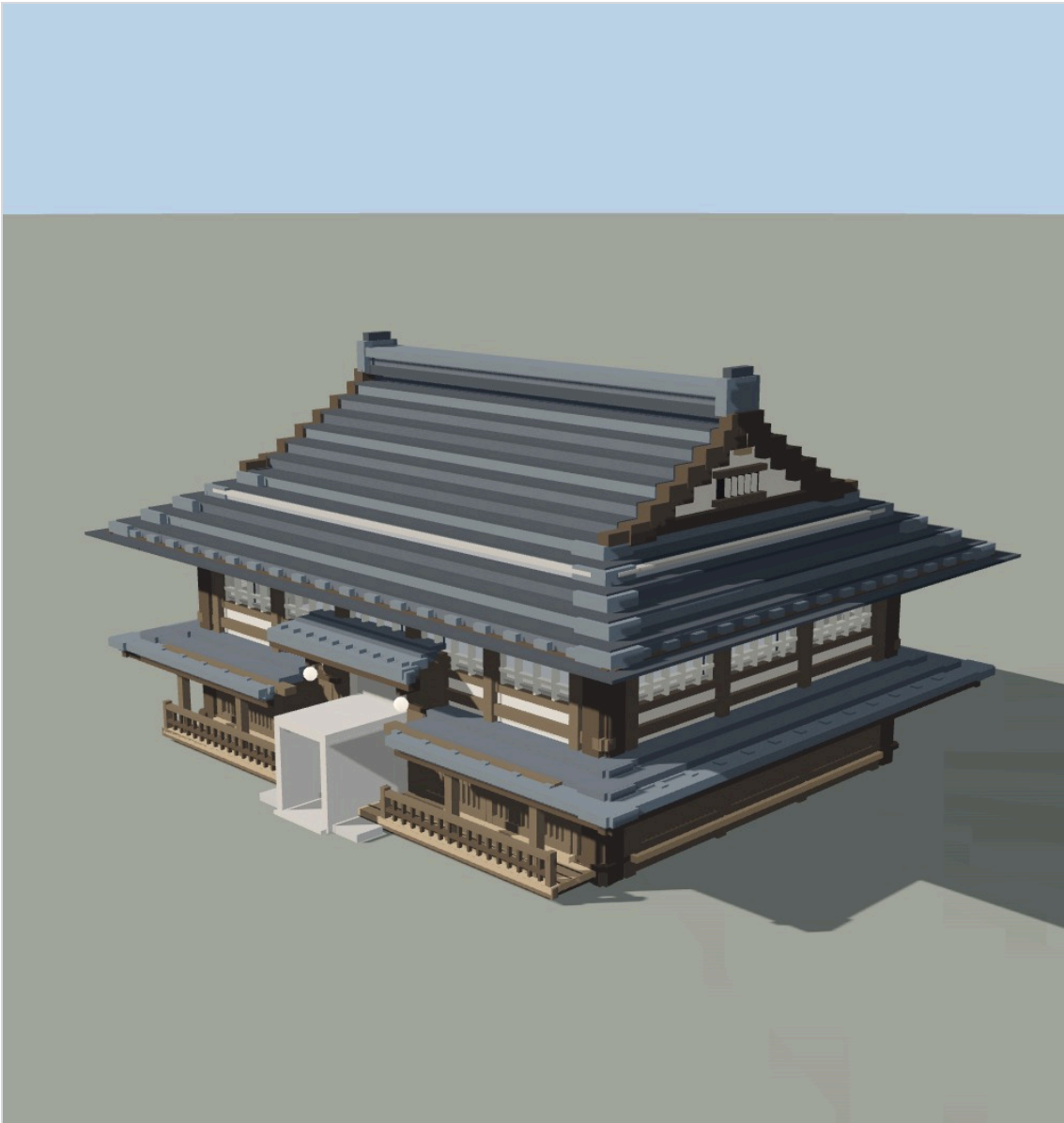


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+12.5 m	Tallest point	25.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	27	Triangles	31,068
Merged deco boxes (free)	2527	Minted meshes (not)	16

22 Japanese Residence

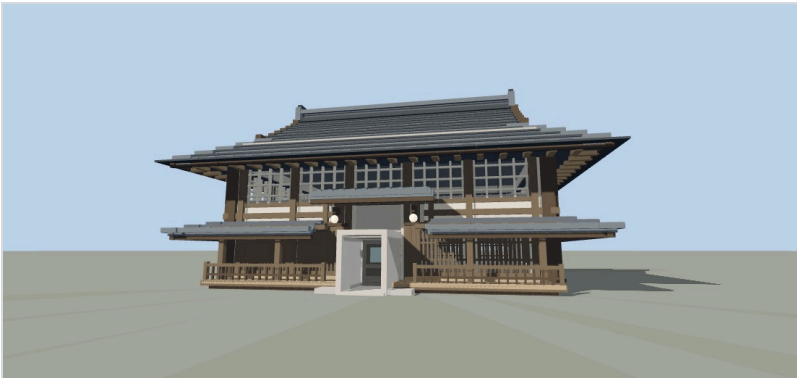
EAST ASIA · HOUSE · machiya · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



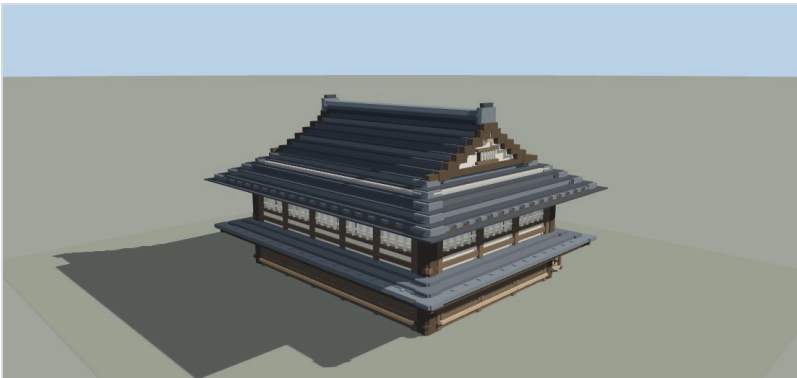
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Japanese townhouse/minka: a low timber frame with pale plaster infill, a veranda deck along the street face, one enormous tiled roof with deep eaves.

AS A CITY: A machiya street — shop-house, teahouse, gate house, storehouse (kura).



From the pavement — the entrance

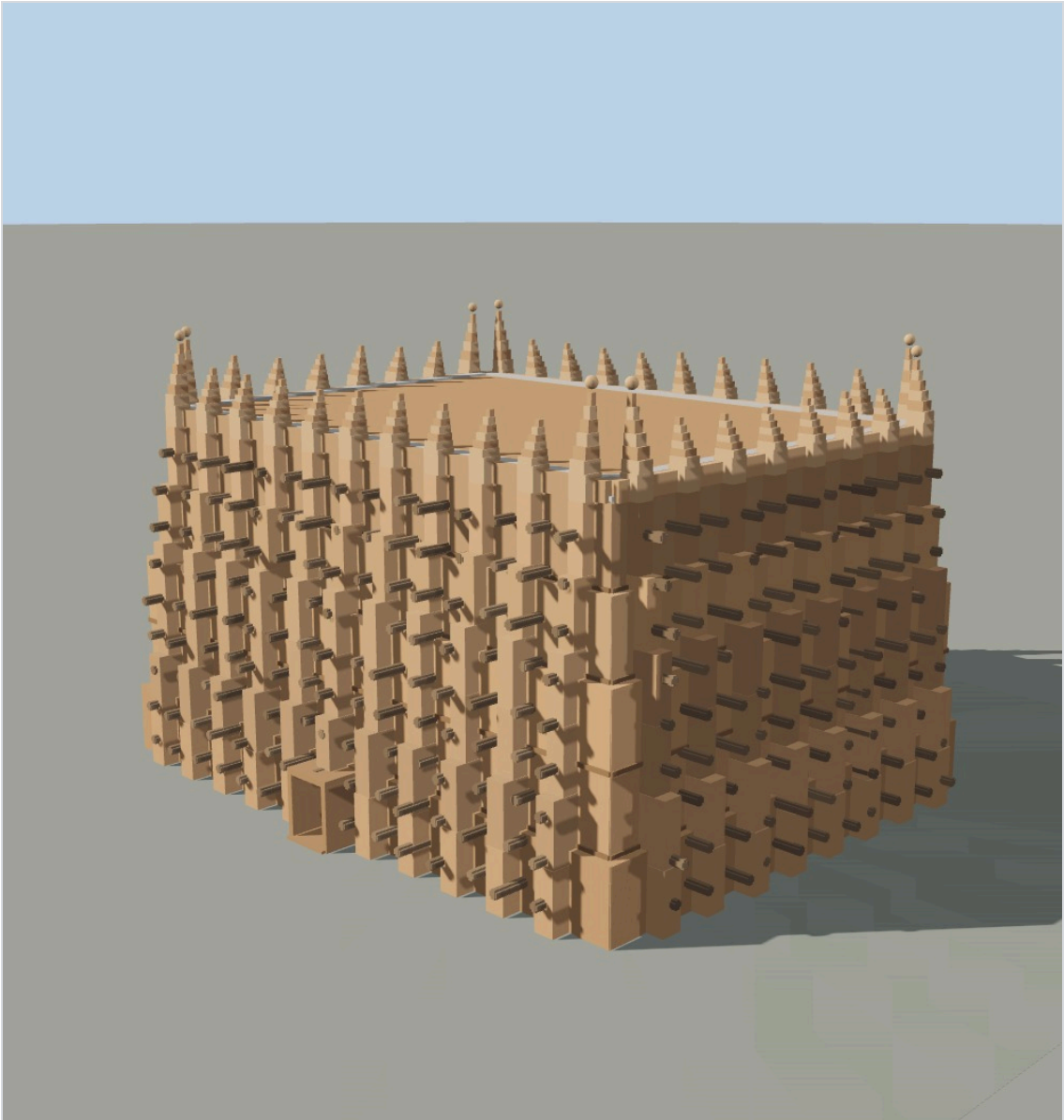


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+4.6 m	Tallest point	11 m
Things breaking the roofline	14	Triangles	16,600
Merged deco boxes (free)	1370	Minted meshes (not)	2

23 Sahelian Mudbrick

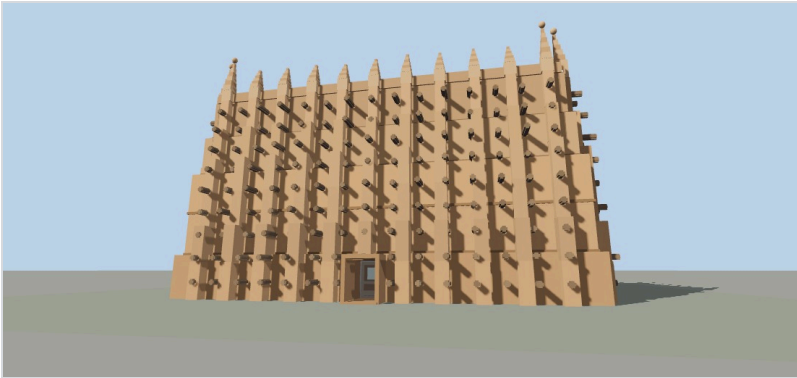
AFRICA · MID-RISE BLOCK · sahelian · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



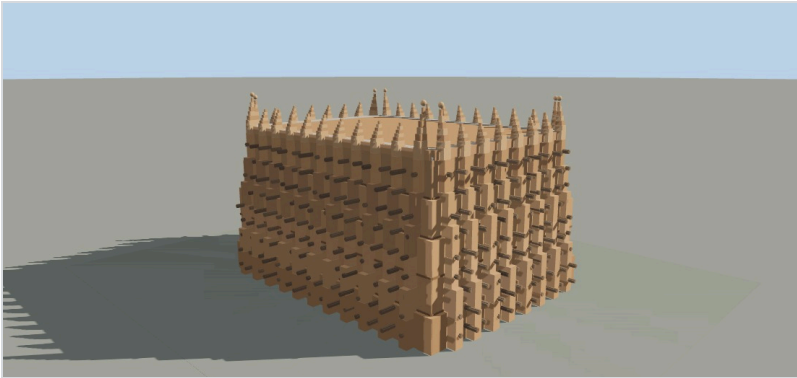
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Djenne. Engaged buttress piers running the full height and ending in cone finials, toron palm beams studding the whole elevation in a grid, battered mud walls, a parapet of pinnacles. No windows.

AS A CITY: A Sahelian city of earth: the great mosque, a merchant quarter, mud granaries, a Friday market square.



From the pavement — the entrance

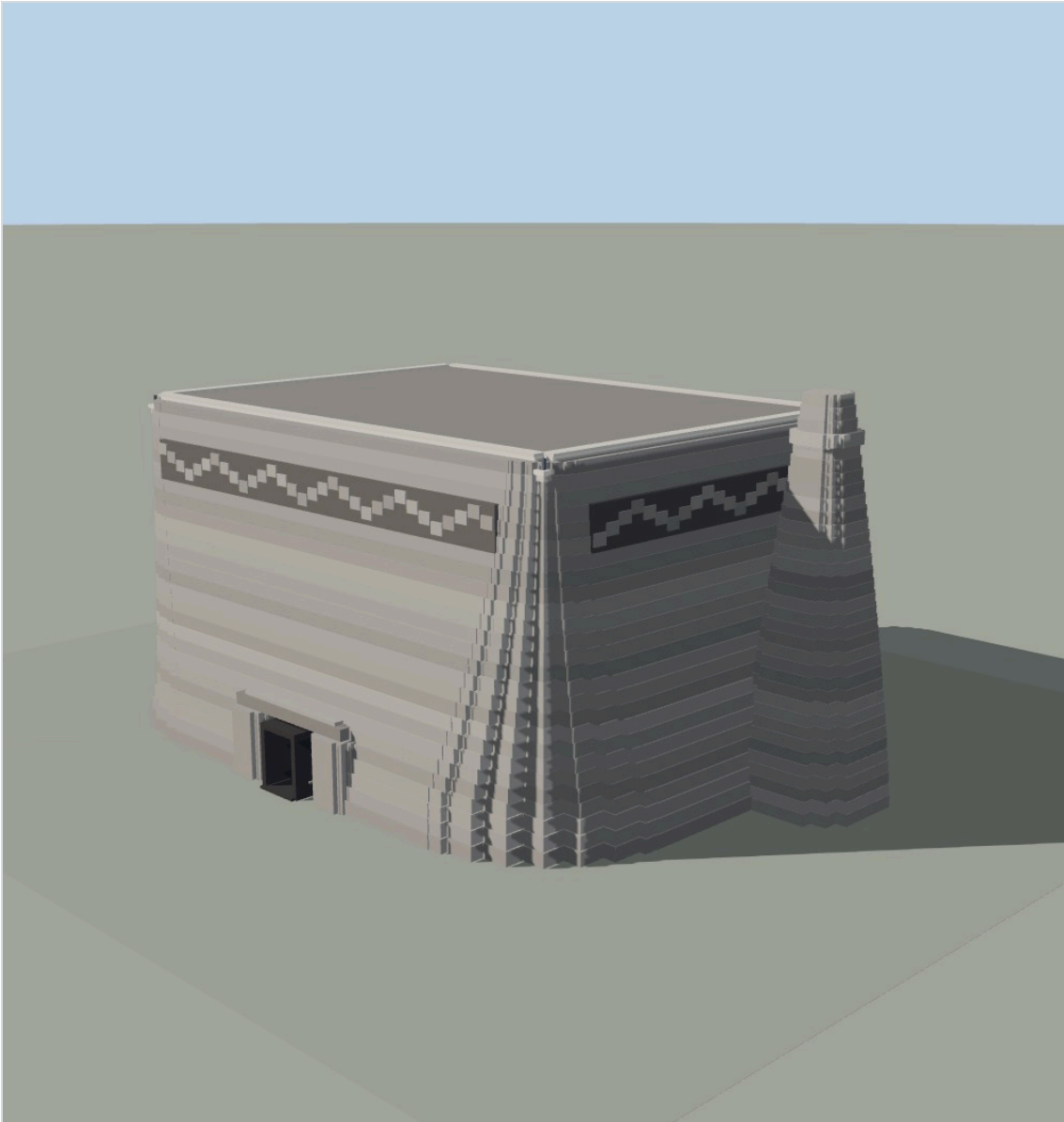


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+3.7 m	Tallest point	16.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	19	Triangles	20,604
Merged deco boxes (free)	1637	Minted meshes (not)	8

24 Great Zimbabwe Dry-Stone

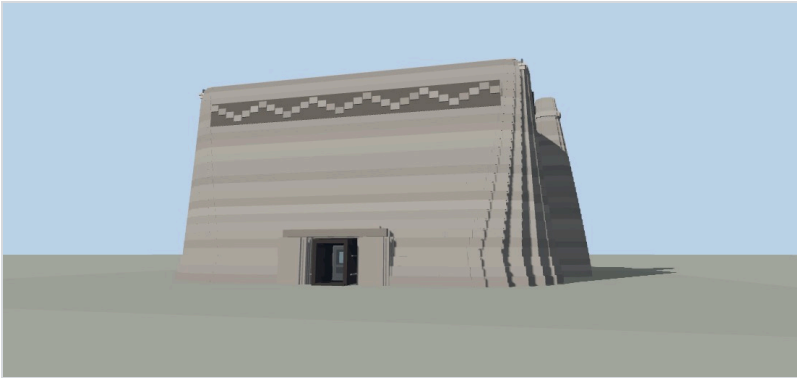
AFRICA · MID-RISE BLOCK · zimbabwe · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



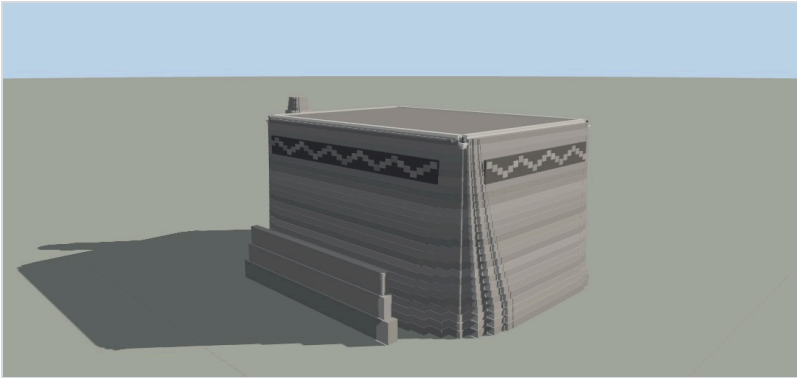
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

The Great Enclosure. Coursed granite laid without mortar, battering and thickening enormously at the base, almost no openings, a chevron course near the top and a solid conical tower.

AS A CITY: A dry-stone capital: the enclosure, the hill complex, narrow parallel passages, a valley of daga huts.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+1.9 m	Tallest point	14.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	9	Triangles	14,292
Merged deco boxes (free)	1191	Minted meshes (not)	0

25 Swahili Coral-Stone

AFRICA · HOUSE · swahili · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



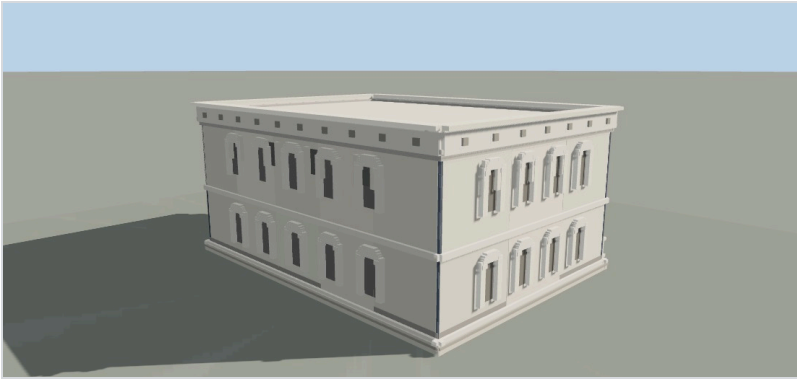
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Lamu. Coral rag under lime plaster, a flat terrace roof behind a low parapet, a deeply carved timber door in a frame far larger than it needs, zidaka niches, a baraza bench at the street.

AS A CITY: A Swahili stone town: merchant houses, a mosque, a customs house, alleys too narrow for carts.



From the pavement — the entrance

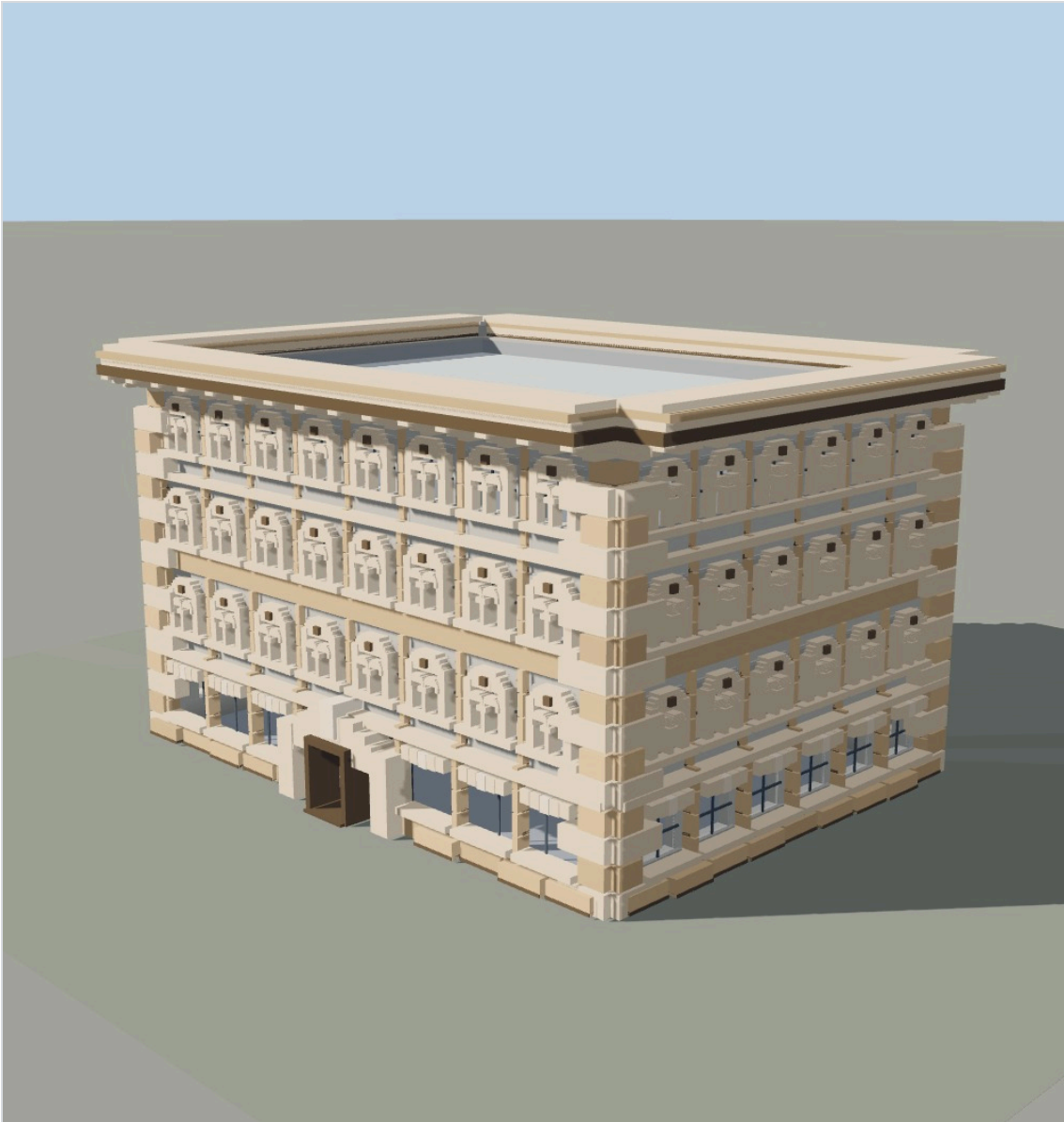


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+0.8 m	Tallest point	7.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	6	Triangles	6,084
Merged deco boxes (free)	507	Minted meshes (not)	0

26 Florentine Palazzo

RENAISSANCE & BAROQUE · MID-RISE BLOCK · palazzo · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



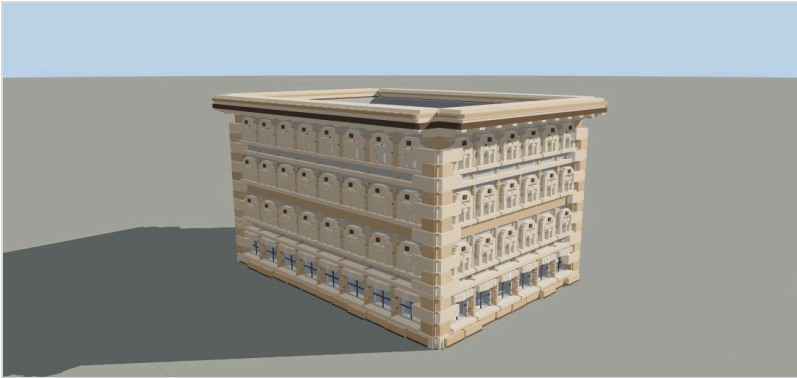
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Strozzi. Three storeys getting smoother as they rise — rock-faced, then channelled, then near-ashlar — bifora windows, corner quoin chains, and an enormous cornice throwing a hard band of shade.

AS A CITY: A Florentine quarter: palazzi, a loggia, a baptistery, a bridge lined with shops.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+1.4 m	Tallest point	14.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	9	Triangles	65,028
Merged deco boxes (free)	5419	Minted meshes (not)	0

27 Baroque Church Front

RENAISSANCE & BAROQUE · MID-RISE BLOCK · baroque · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Il Gesu. A two-storey front stitched by great volute scrolls, giant-order pilasters layered so the centre steps forward, statue niches, a broken segmental pediment. A wall that swells.

AS A CITY: A baroque capital: church fronts, a fountain square, a palace, an obelisk on an axis.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+7 m	Tallest point	19.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	11	Triangles	12,504
Merged deco boxes (free)	1042	Minted meshes (not)	0

28 Palladian Villa

RENAISSANCE & BAROQUE · HOUSE · palladian · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



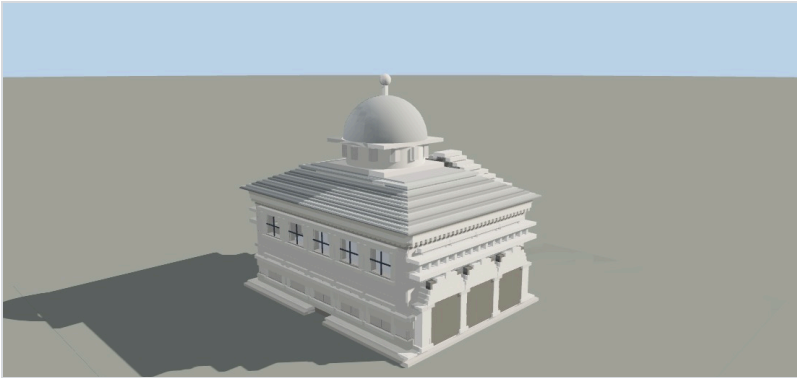
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Villa Rotonda. A piano nobile over a rusticated basement, a full temple-front portico, flanking wings, a serliana window, a shallow dome. Raised and arched where Greek Revival is grounded and gabled.

AS A CITY: A Veneto landscape of villas, barchesse, a walled garden, a canal.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+9.1 m	Tallest point	15.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	20	Triangles	15,584
Merged deco boxes (free)	1233	Minted meshes (not)	7

29 Greek Revival Mansion

COLONIAL & EARLY AMERICAN · HOUSE · greekrev · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

A temple bolted to a house: gable turned to the road, full-height colonnade in front of it, a real pediment with a shadowed tympanum, painted dead white.

AS A CITY: A courthouse-square town of white temple fronts — bank, academy, two churches, the big house on the hill.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+6.1 m	Tallest point	12.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	15	Triangles	14,496
Merged deco boxes (free)	1176	Minted meshes (not)	6

30 Antebellum Plantation House

COLONIAL & EARLY AMERICAN · HOUSE · plantation · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Antebellum: a two-storey gallery running the full width on both floors, columns from ground to roof, hipped roof with dormers.

AS A CITY: A river road of galleried houses, an overseer's cottage, a raised creole townhouse.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+5.1 m	Tallest point	11.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	18	Triangles	32,488
Merged deco boxes (free)	2694	Minted meshes (not)	2

31 Brick Colonial House

COLONIAL & EARLY AMERICAN · HOUSE · brickhouse · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Georgian/Colonial: solid brick laid symmetrically about a centre door, side-gabled roof, a chimney at each end. Its argument is DECORUM.

AS A CITY: A colonial town of manners — meeting house, tavern, the row houses, the governor's house.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+6.6 m	Tallest point	13 m
Things breaking the roofline	16	Triangles	17,056
Merged deco boxes (free)	1408	Minted meshes (not)	2

32 Spanish Colonial Mansion

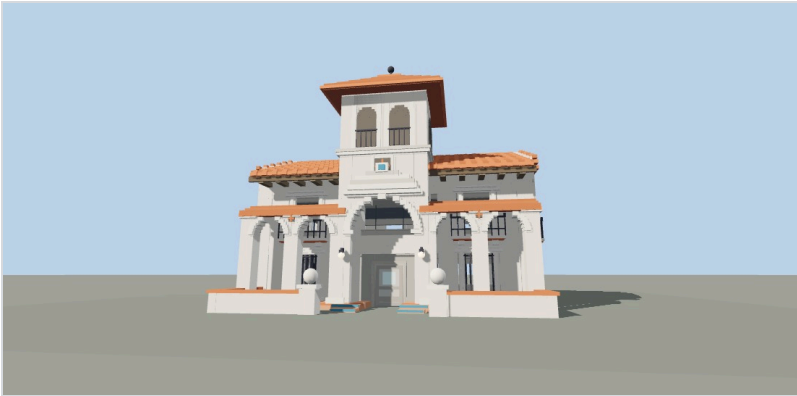
COLONIAL & EARLY AMERICAN · HOUSE · spanish · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Spanish Colonial: white stucco, a low-pitch clay barrel-tile roof, arcaded loggia, wrought iron, a bell-gable.

AS A CITY: A mission town: the mission itself, the hacienda, the plaza arcade, the courtyard house.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+7.6 m	Tallest point	14 m
Things breaking the roofline	21	Triangles	20,932
Merged deco boxes (free)	1701	Minted meshes (not)	5

33 Chicago Loft

INDUSTRIAL 19TH CENTURY · MID-RISE BLOCK · brick · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Chicago loft, c.1905. Load-bearing brick read as STRUCTURE: piers between the bays, segmental arches, a corbelled cornice, cast-iron storefront, fire escape down the flank.

AS A CITY: A warehouse district that became lofts. Siblings: the mill building, the printing house, the brick-and-timber garment block.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+2.2 m	Tallest point	15 m
Things breaking the roofline	8	Triangles	17,424
Merged deco boxes (free)	1452	Minted meshes (not)	0

34 Ashlar Bank

INDUSTRIAL 19TH CENTURY · MID-RISE BLOCK · stone · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



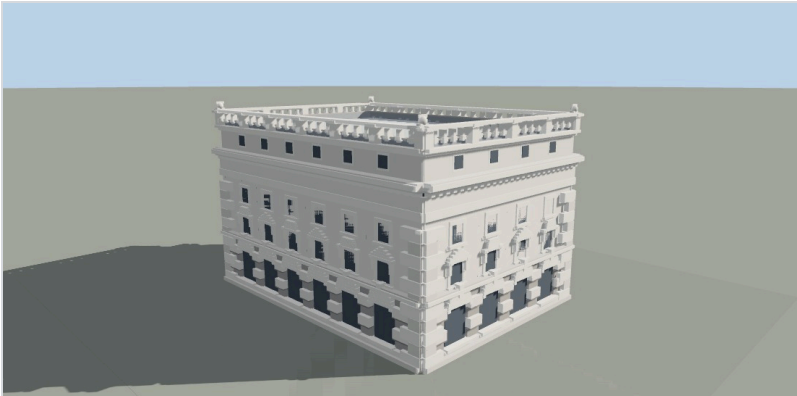
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Ashlar bank in three parts — rusticated base, plain shaft, attic over a heavy cornice — with a giant order solved backwards from the roofline.

AS A CITY: A financial quarter of stone institutions: the exchange, the courthouse, the trust company, the library.



From the pavement — the entrance

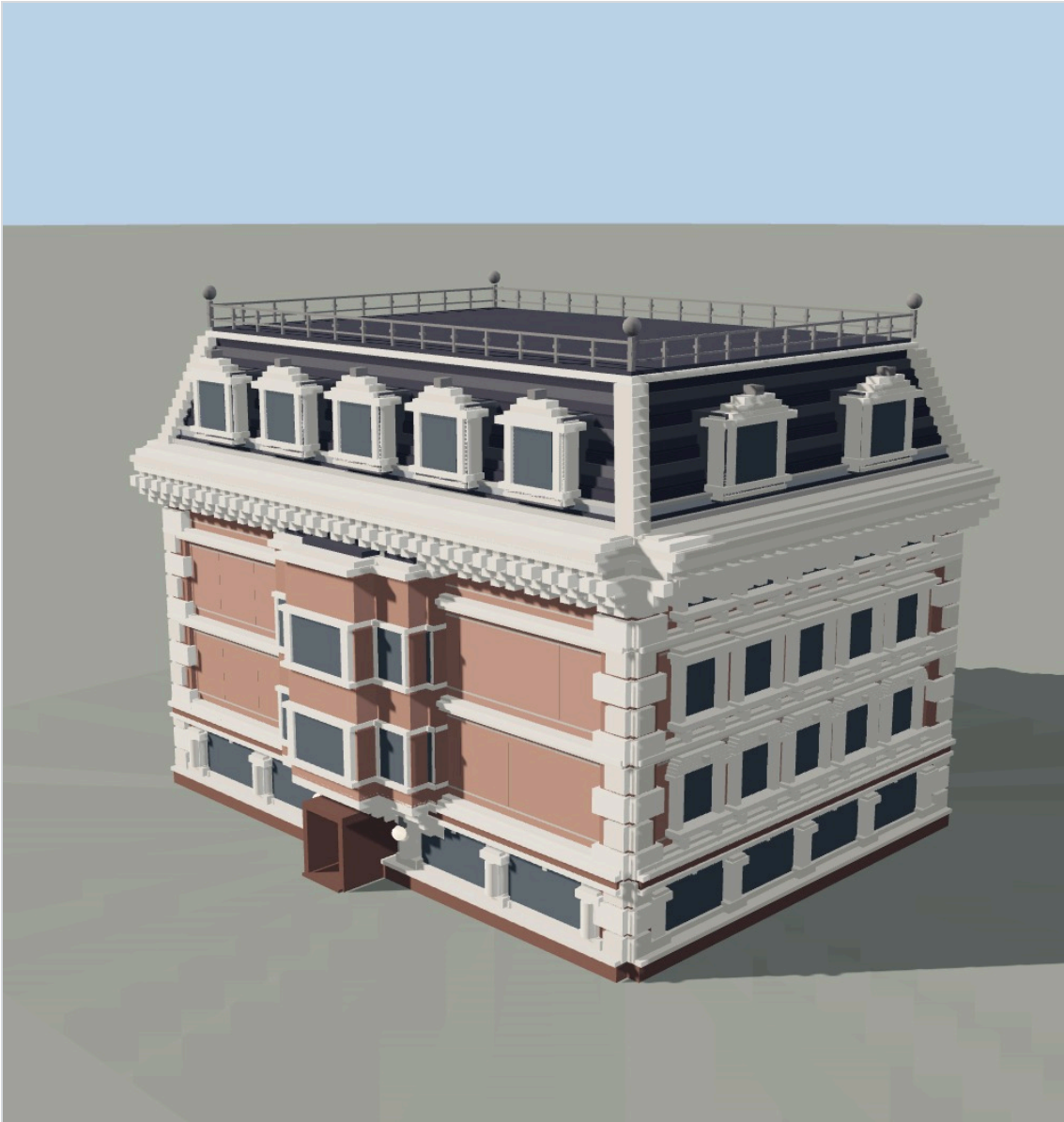


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+1.9 m	Tallest point	14.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	10	Triangles	23,256
Merged deco boxes (free)	1870	Minted meshes (not)	10

35 Second Empire

INDUSTRIAL 19TH CENTURY · MID-RISE BLOCK · victorian · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Second Empire. Mansard roof with dormers punching through, projecting oriel bays, a deep bracketed cornice over a cast-iron storefront.

AS A CITY: A 19th-century downtown: the opera house, the hotel, the department store, the rooming block.



From the pavement — the entrance

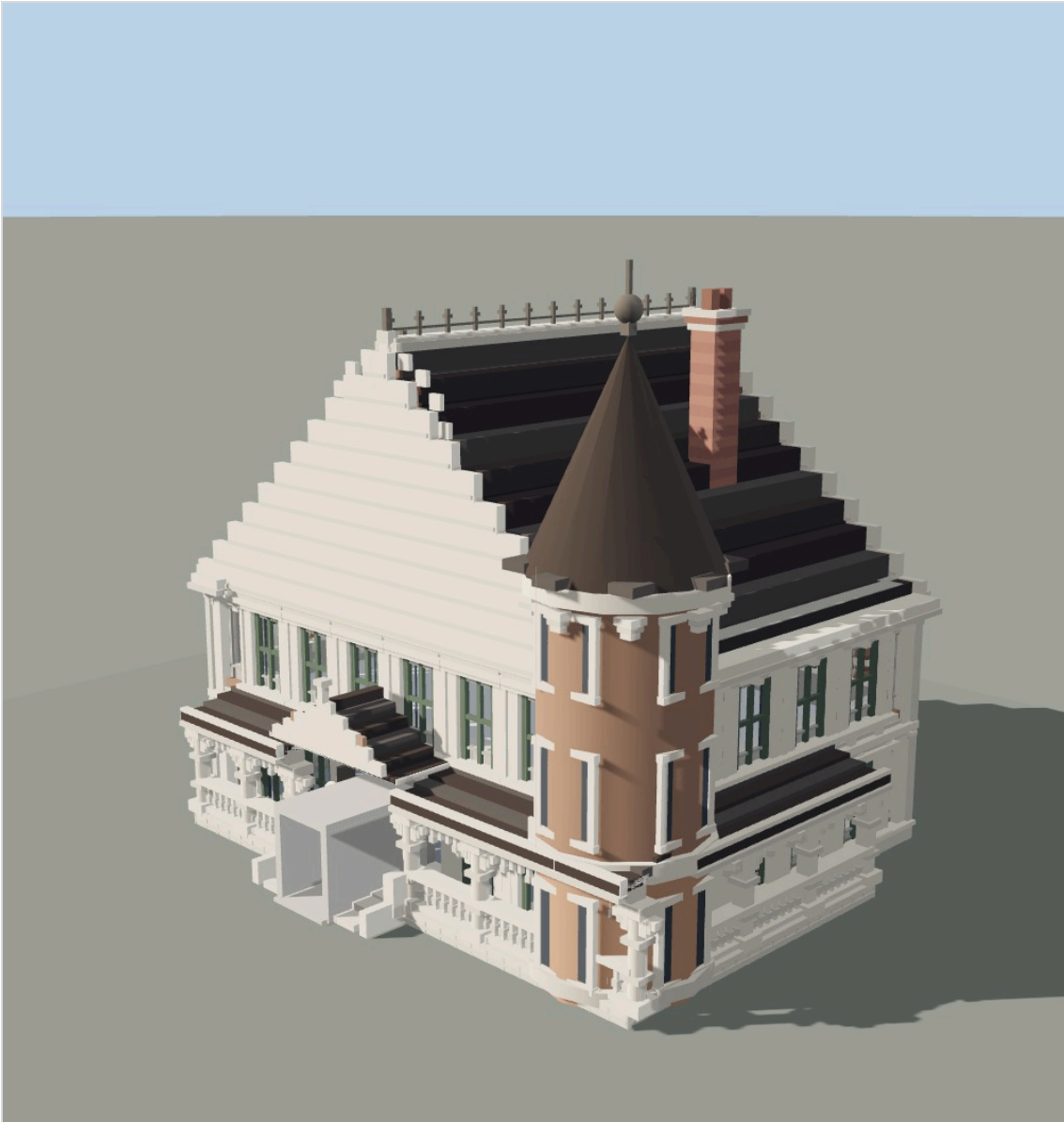


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+5.4 m	Tallest point	18.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	18	Triangles	34,276
Merged deco boxes (free)	2787	Minted meshes (not)	12

36 Queen Anne Painted Lady

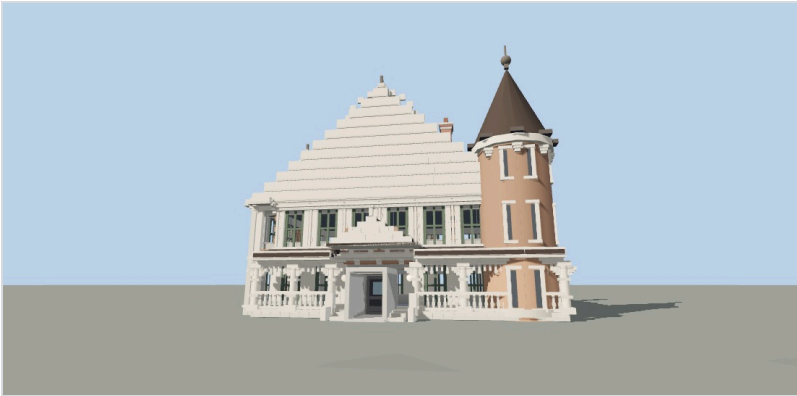
INDUSTRIAL 19TH CENTURY · HOUSE · queenanne · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



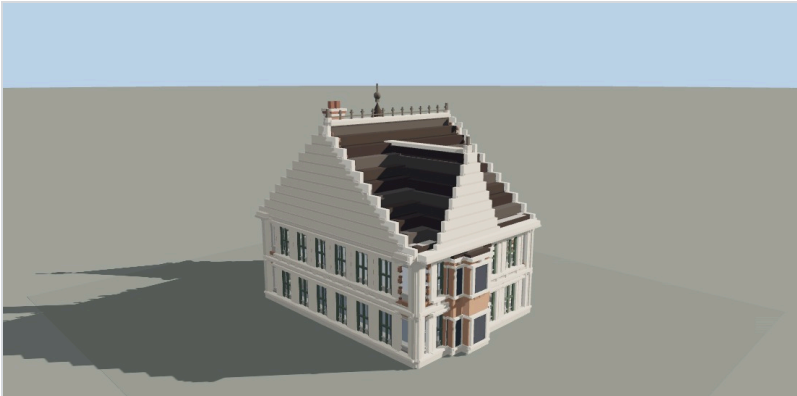
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

The painted lady: asymmetric mass, a corner turret, a wraparound porch, three colours of shingle and spindlework everywhere.

AS A CITY: An 1890s residential hill. Siblings: Stick, Shingle, Eastlake. The most ornament per square metre in the kit.



From the pavement — the entrance

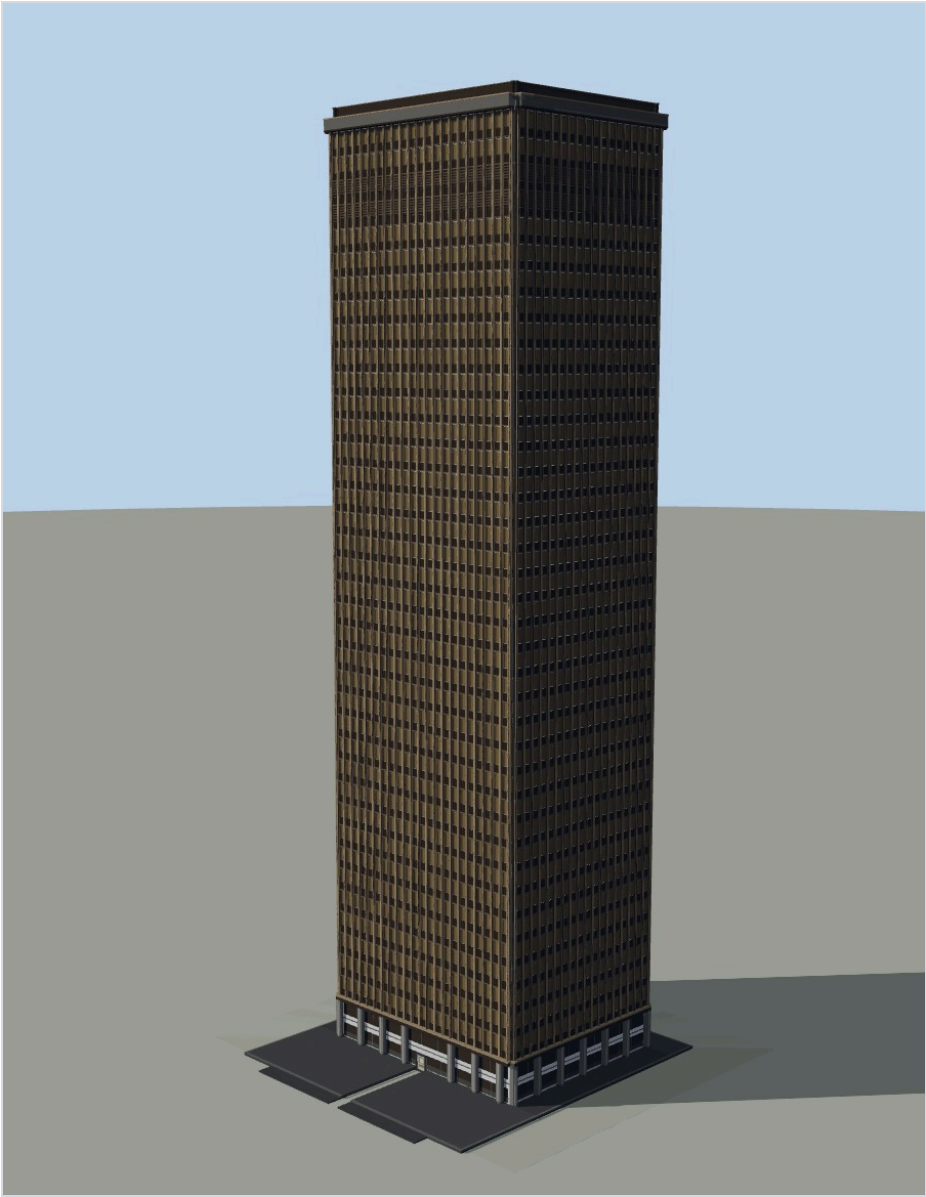


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+9.1 m	Tallest point	15.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	24	Triangles	31,954
Merged deco boxes (free)	2598	Minted meshes (not)	15

37 Seagram Curtain Wall

EARLY 20TH CENTURY · TOWER · intl · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Seagram, 1958. Bronze mullions on an absolutely regular grid, a plaza, a lobby set back behind free-standing columns. No ornament anywhere — it survives on proportion alone.

AS A CITY: A corporate downtown. The three siblings are the variations Mies's imitators made: travertine spandrels, a black-steel version, a white-marble civic slab.



From the pavement — the entrance

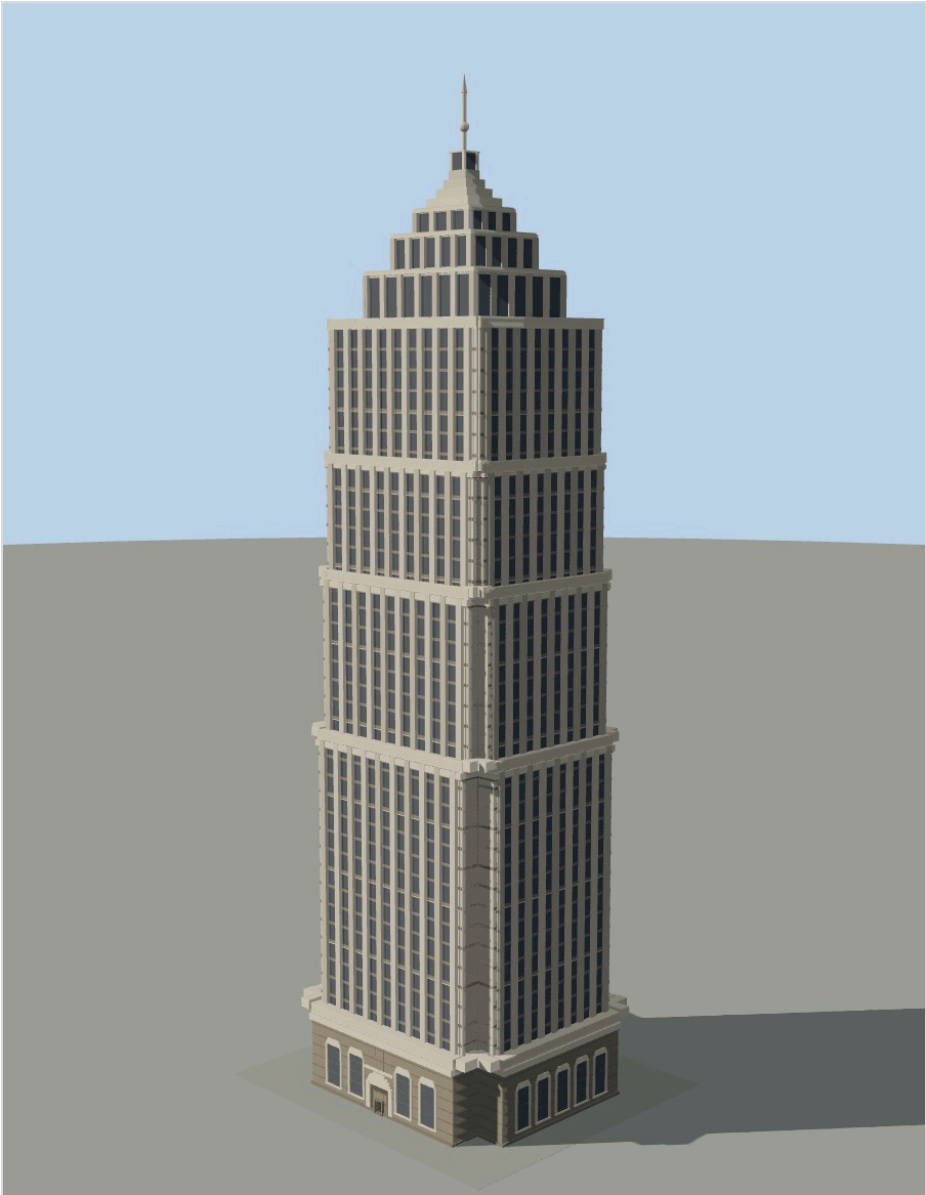


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+3.5 m	Tallest point	131.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	9	Triangles	67,992
Merged deco boxes (free)	5666	Minted meshes (not)	0

38 Zoning Setback Tower

EARLY 20TH CENTURY · TOWER · ziggurat · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



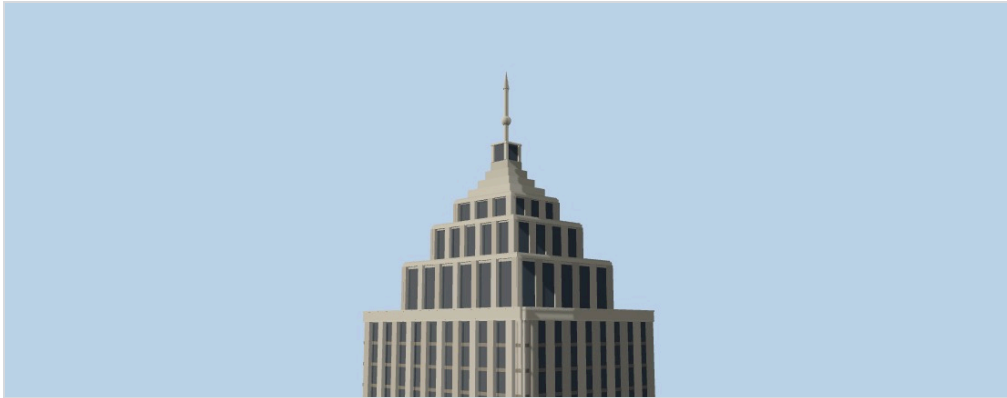
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

The 1916 New York zoning envelope: mandatory setbacks stepping the tower back from the street as it rises, so the shape is a law made visible.

AS A CITY: Pre-war Manhattan. Siblings: the wedding-cake hotel, the setback courthouse, the stepped power-company HQ.



From the pavement — the entrance

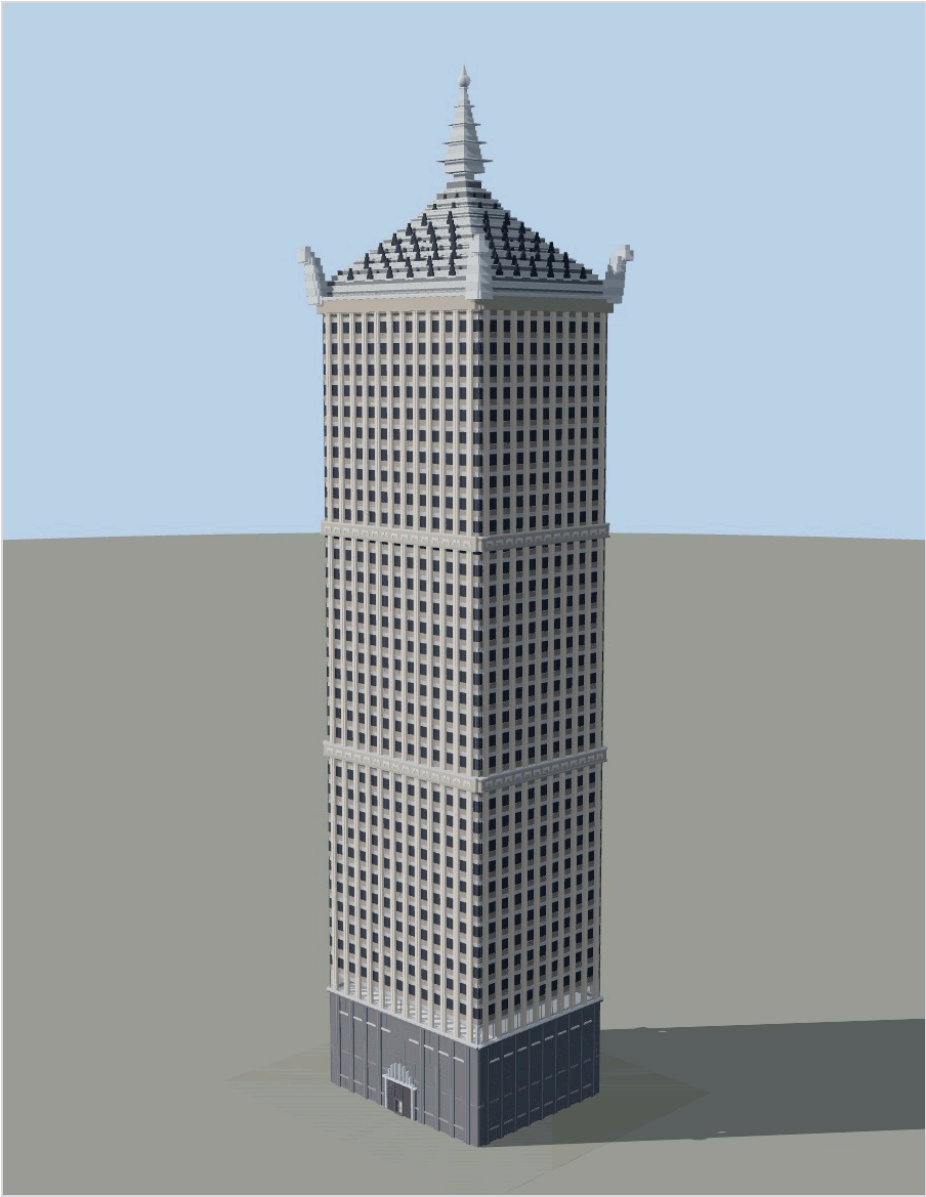


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+40.5 m	Tallest point	168.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	17	Triangles	69,134
Merged deco boxes (free)	5745	Minted meshes (not)	3

39 Radiator Crown

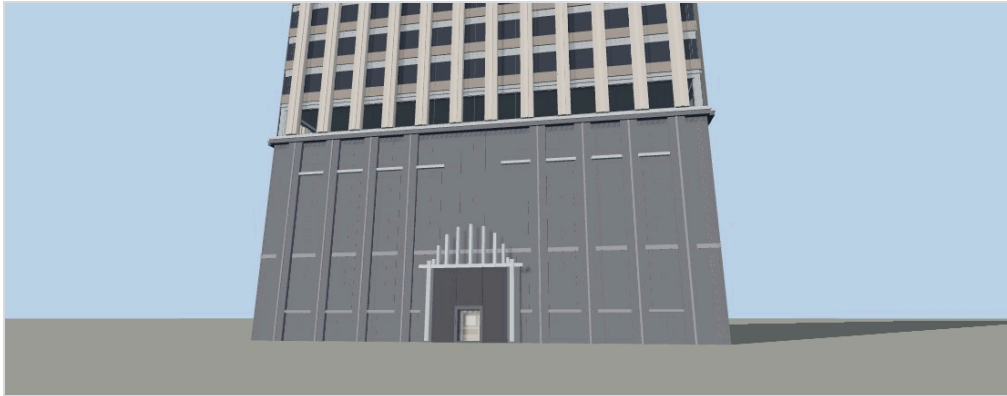
EARLY 20TH CENTURY · TOWER · sunburst · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Chrysler's radiator crown: stacked arcs of decreasing radius, dormer eyes, a spire. The crown is the entire building's argument.

AS A CITY: The crown competition of 1930 — every tower in the district trying to out-terminate the last one. The richest sibling set in the kit.



From the pavement — the entrance

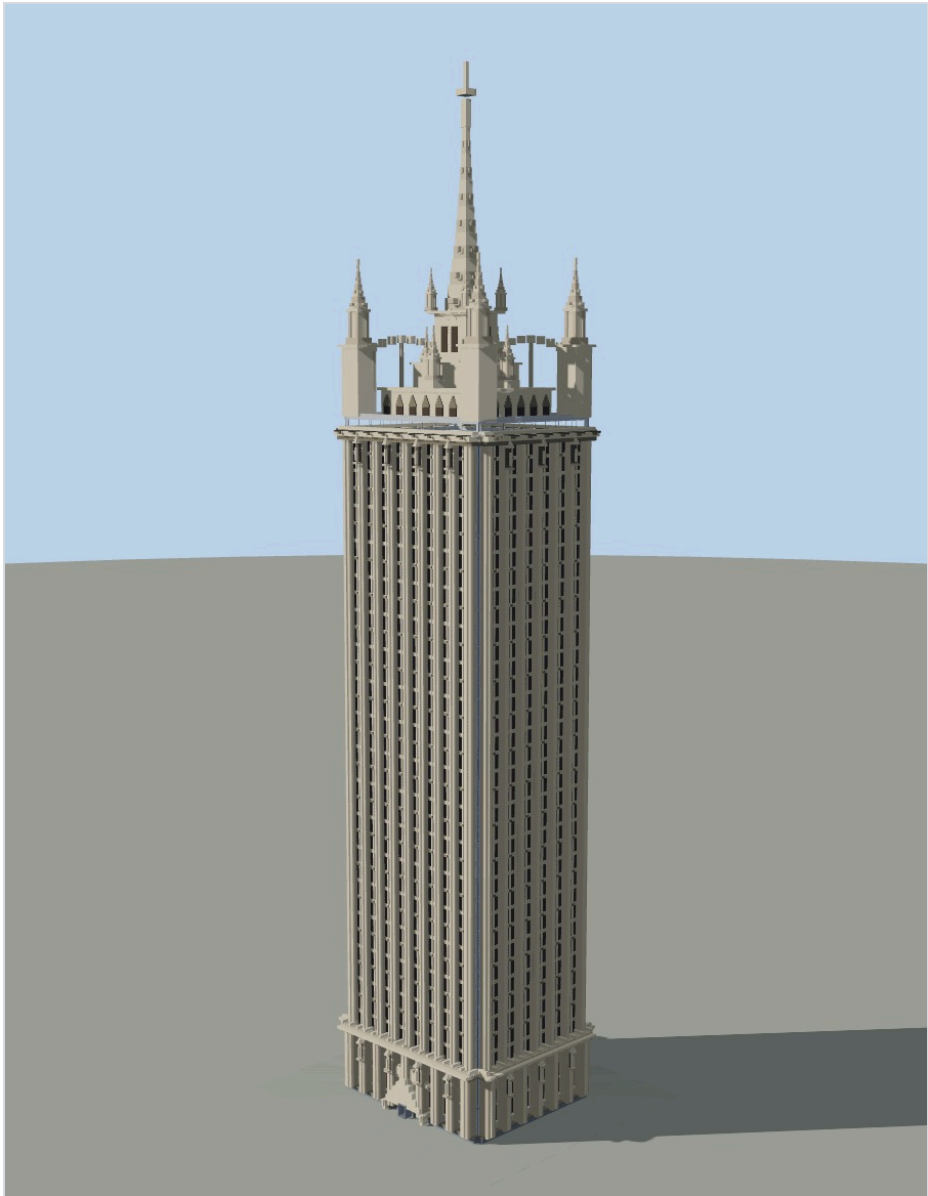


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+35.3 m	Tallest point	163.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	11	Triangles	81,858
Merged deco boxes (free)	6808	Minted meshes (not)	2

40 Cathedral of Commerce

EARLY 20TH CENTURY · TOWER · neogothic · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Woolworth, the Cathedral of Commerce: a Gothic cathedral stretched to 60 storeys, buttresses and pinnacles all the way up.

AS A CITY: The 1913 skyline where every tower borrowed a cathedral. Siblings: Tribune Tower's flying buttresses, a spired campanile, a Gothic crown on a stone shaft.



From the pavement — the entrance



The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+62.3 m	Tallest point	190.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	10	Triangles	100,152
Merged deco boxes (free)	8346	Minted meshes (not)	0

41 Deco Tower

EARLY 20TH CENTURY · MID-RISE BLOCK · artdeco · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



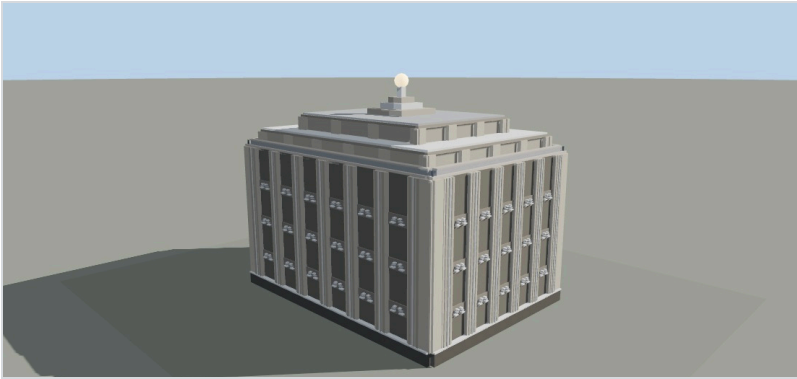
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

1930 setback commercial block. Fluted piers run base to crown with the spandrels pushed back behind them; nothing horizontal is allowed to cross a pier.

AS A CITY: A whole deco main street: theatre, department store, telephone exchange, hotel.



From the pavement — the entrance

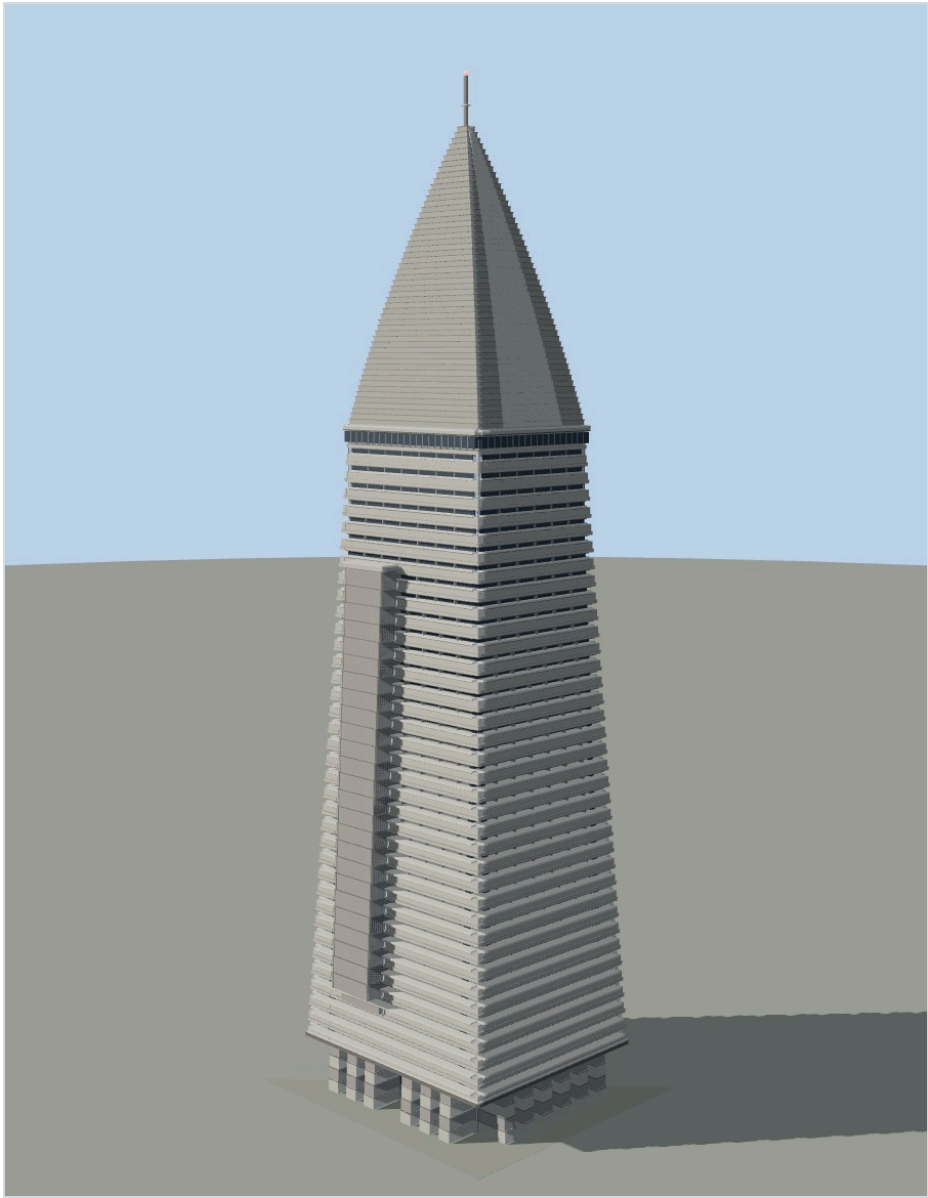


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+6.5 m	Tallest point	19.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	13	Triangles	14,588
Merged deco boxes (free)	1209	Minted meshes (not)	1

42 Tapered Spire

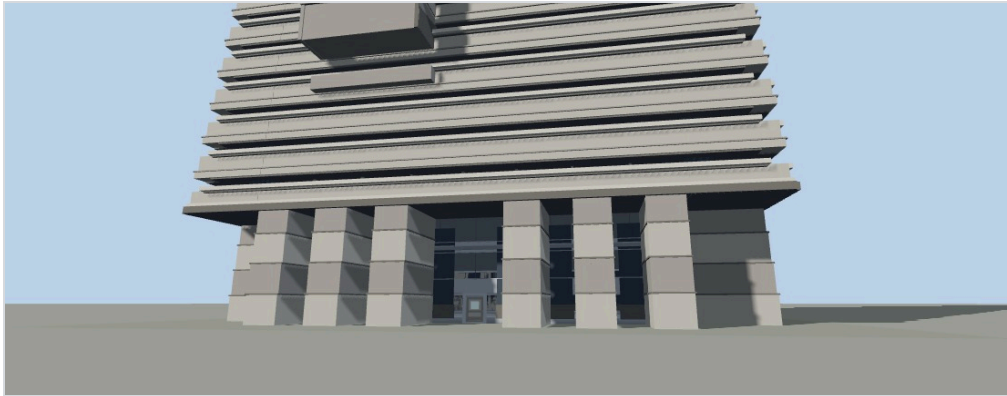
LATE 20TH CENTURY · TOWER · pyramid · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



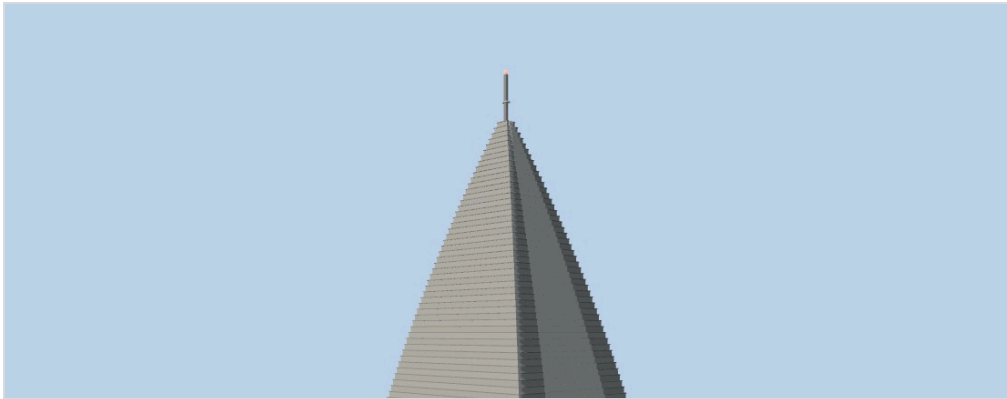
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Transamerica. A tapered spire with the whole elevation converging on a point, wing buttresses at the shoulders.

AS A CITY: A skyline of tapers — obelisk, needle, stepped cone. Rare and expensive to over-use; one per district.



From the pavement — the entrance

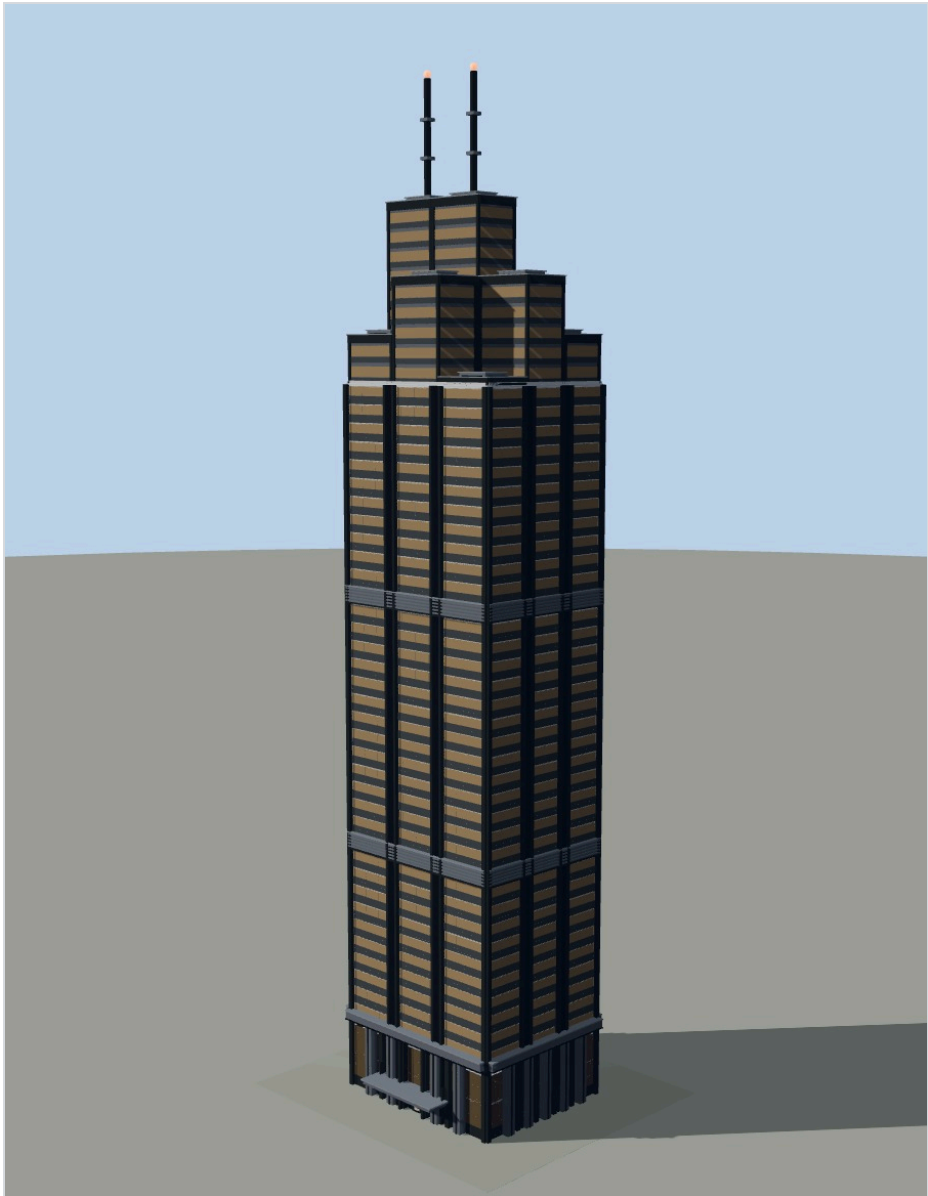


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+64.3 m	Tallest point	192.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	11	Triangles	90,712
Merged deco boxes (free)	7546	Minted meshes (not)	2

43 Bundled Tube

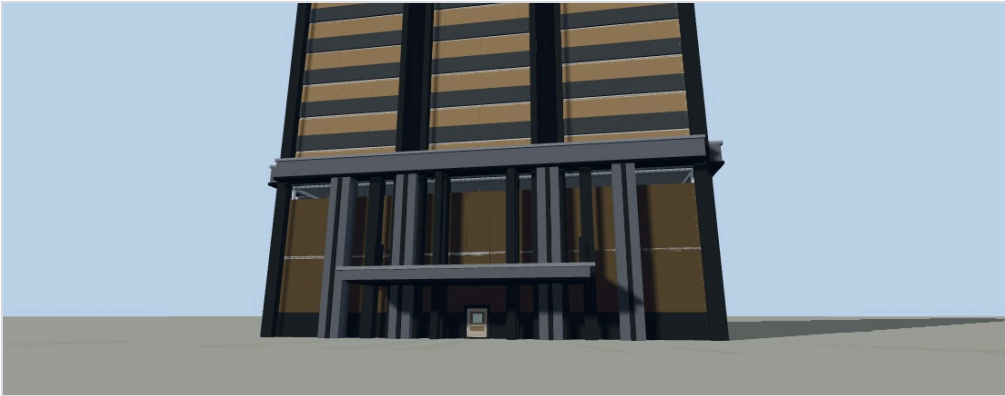
LATE 20TH CENTURY · TOWER · bundled · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



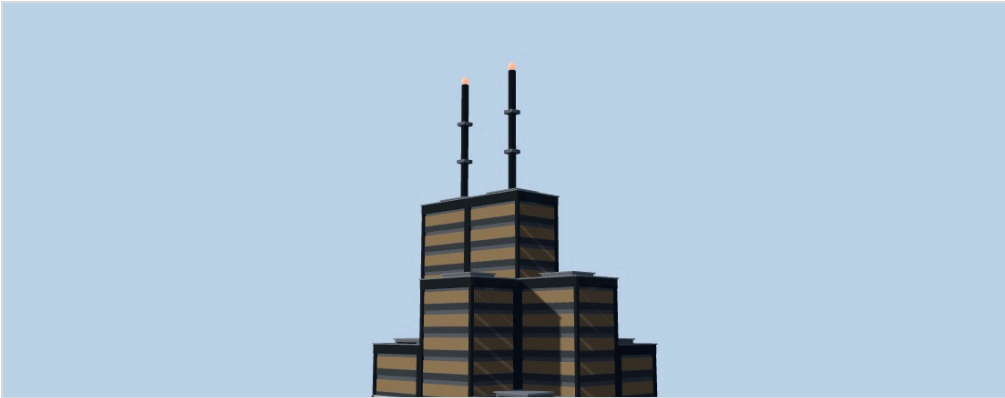
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Sears/Willis. Nine square tubes in a 3x3 bundle that stop at different heights. Almost no surface treatment; pure massing.

AS A CITY: A structural-expression downtown: tube, bundle, diagonal, hat truss. Cold, enormous, recognisable at 20 km.



From the pavement — the entrance

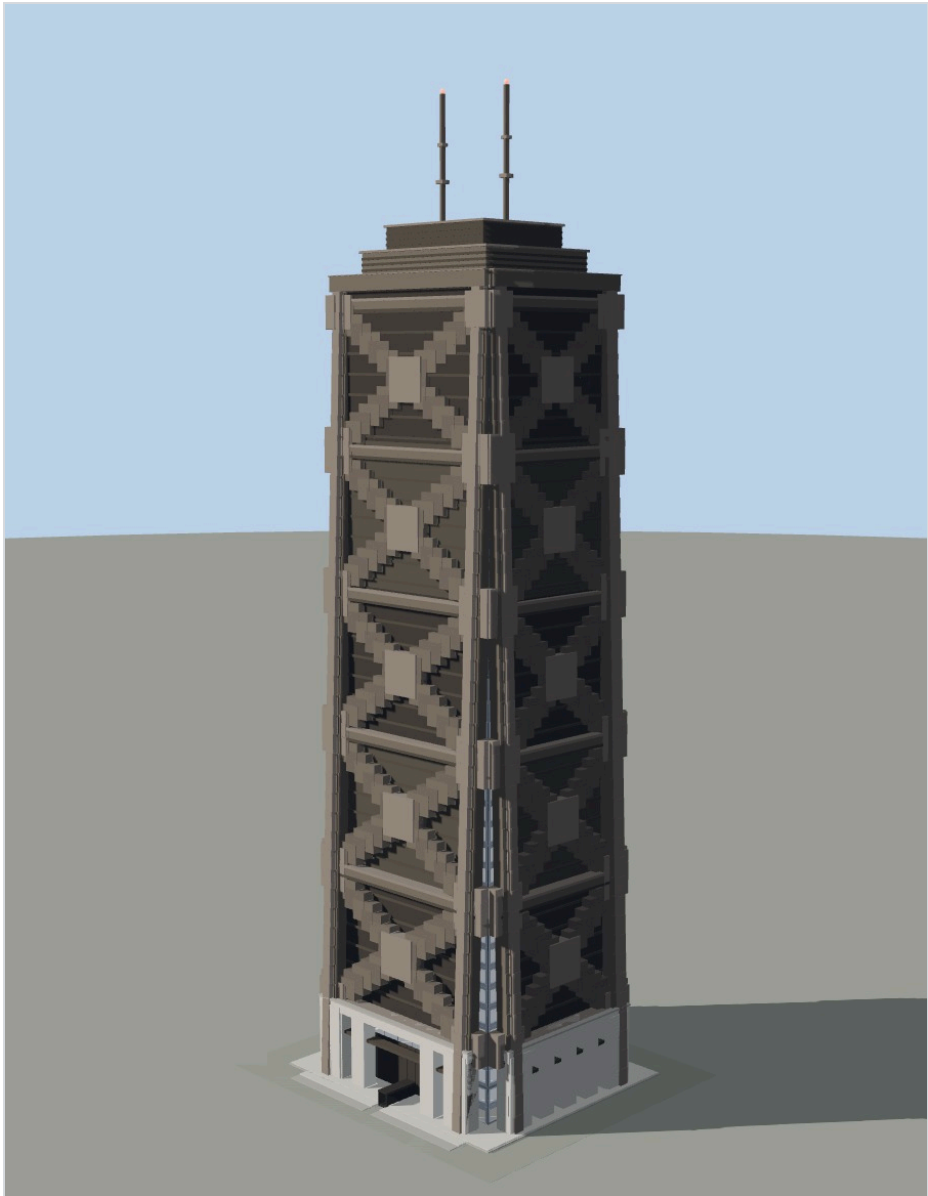


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+54 m	Tallest point	182 m
Things breaking the roofline	16	Triangles	68,756
Merged deco boxes (free)	5711	Minted meshes (not)	4

44 Braced Tube

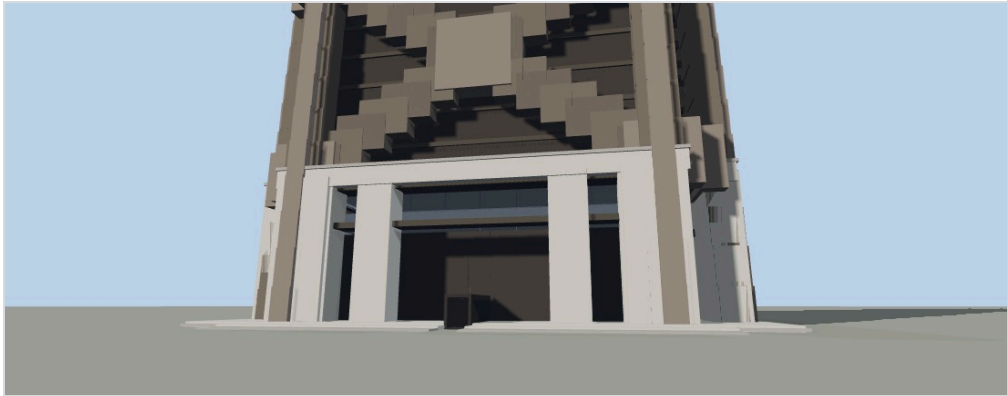
LATE 20TH CENTURY · TOWER · megabrace · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

The braced tube — giant X-bracing crossing many storeys on the outside of the glass, structure as the only ornament.

AS A CITY: Siblings: the diagrid, the outrigger belt truss, the exposed mega-column. An engineer's city.



From the pavement — the entrance

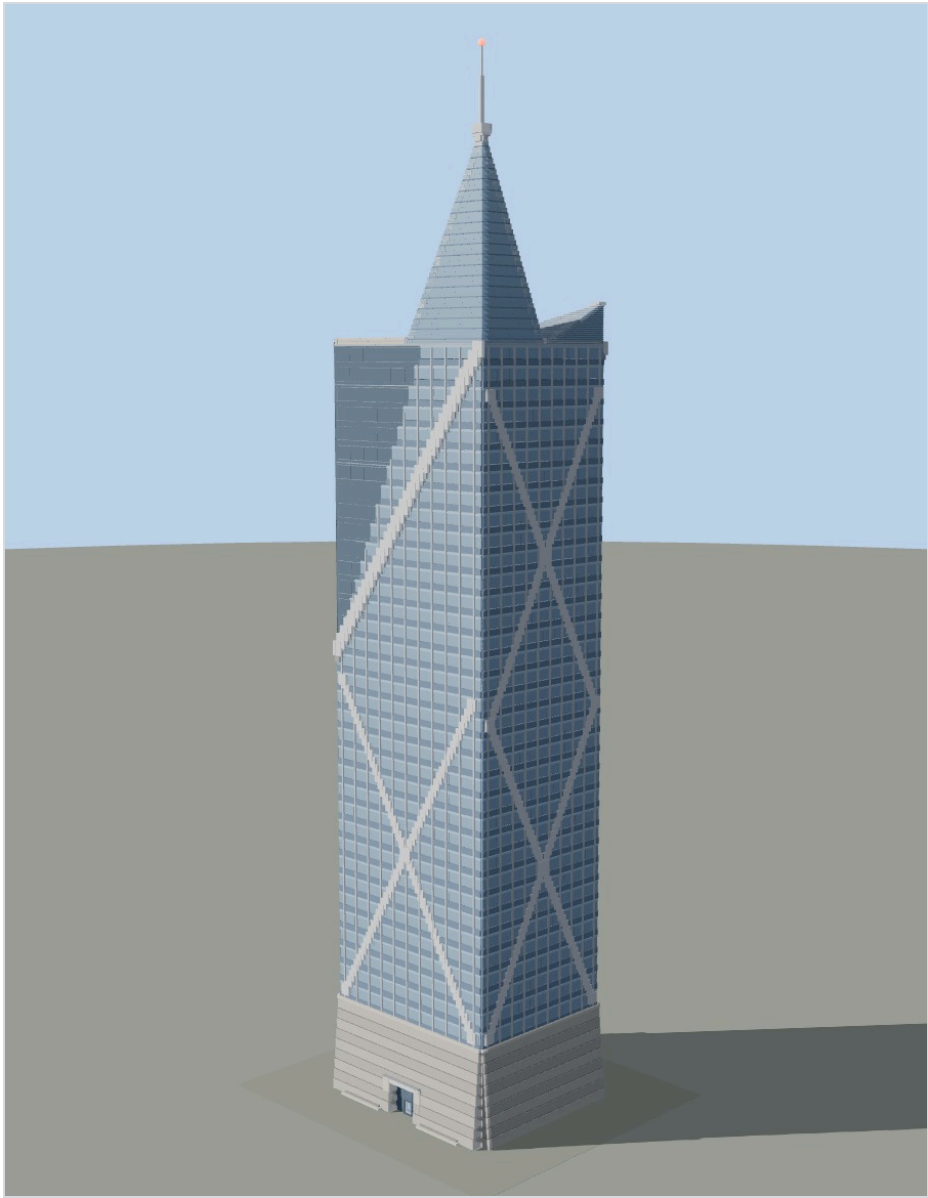


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+31.5 m	Tallest point	159.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	12	Triangles	77,336
Merged deco boxes (free)	6426	Minted meshes (not)	4

45 Faceted Prism

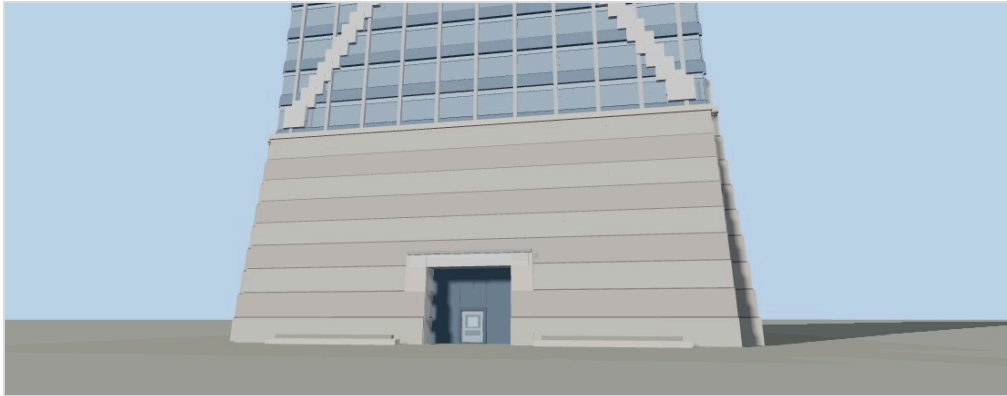
LATE 20TH CENTURY · TOWER · faceted · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



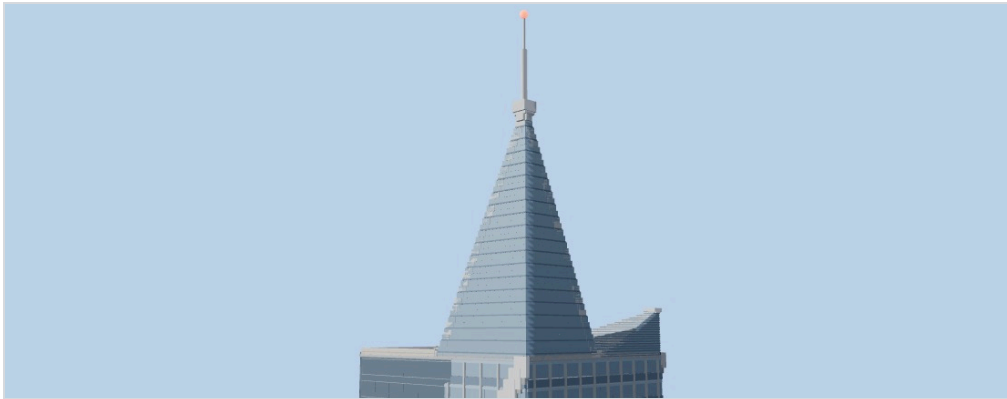
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Bank of China, 1990. The prism is CUT: quadrants rise to four different heights with long diagonals running across dozens of storeys.

AS A CITY: A crystal district. Siblings are the other cuts — the sheared top, the twisted shaft, the folded plate.



From the pavement — the entrance



The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+44.8 m	Tallest point	172.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	47	Triangles	77,260
Merged deco boxes (free)	6427	Minted meshes (not)	3

46 Broken Pediment

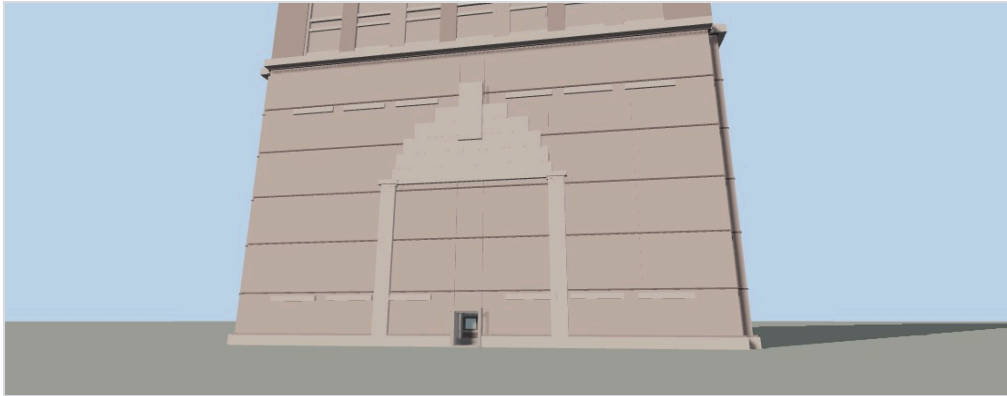
LATE 20TH CENTURY · TOWER · postmodern · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

AT&T, 1984. A classical broken pediment on top of a skyscraper — deliberately absurd, deliberately memorable.

AS A CITY: The 1980s. Siblings: the Chippendale sibling, the pink granite arch, the temple-front bank. A city with a sense of humour.



From the pavement — the entrance

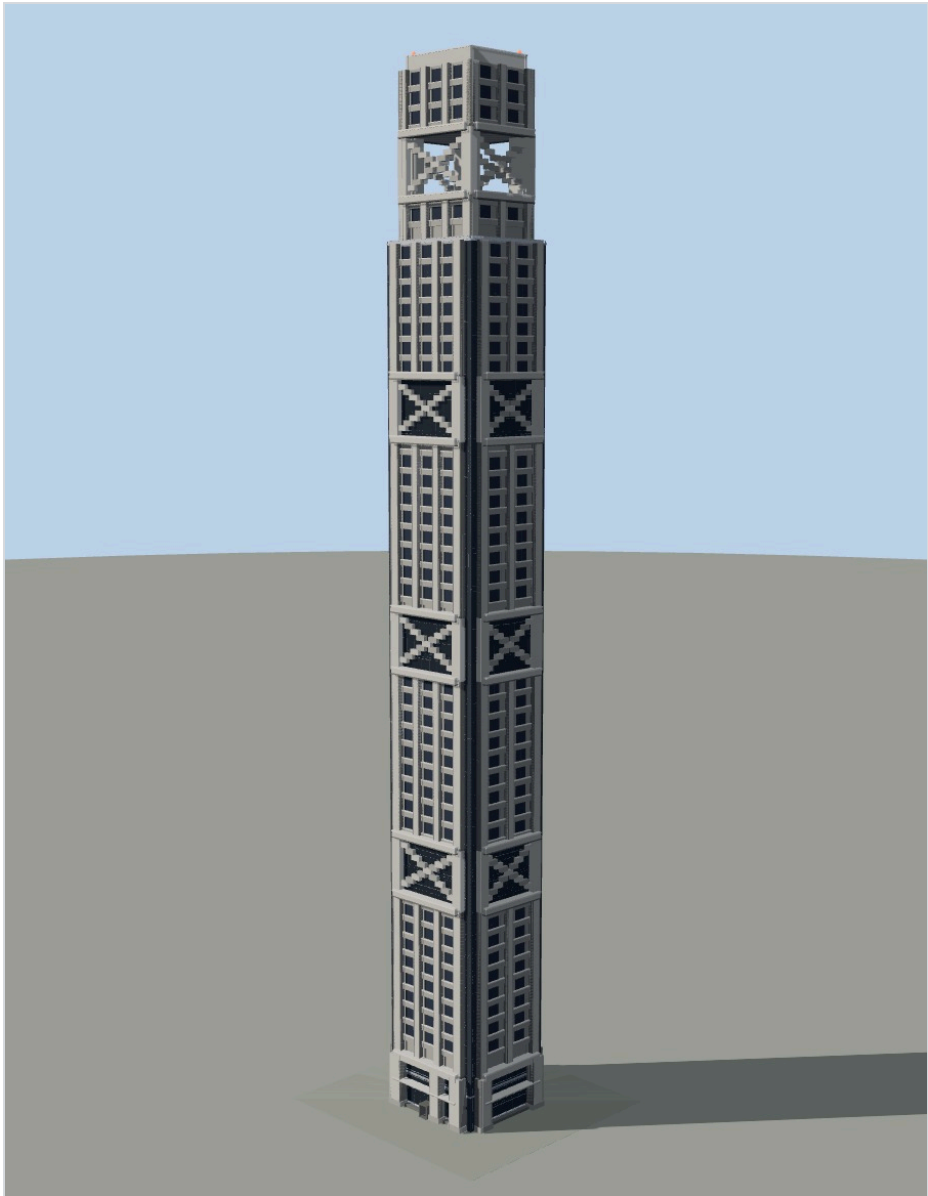


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+14.5 m	Tallest point	142.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	11	Triangles	99,300
Merged deco boxes (free)	8275	Minted meshes (not)	0

47 Supertall Slim

LATE 20TH CENTURY · TOWER · pencil · 20×18 M, 48 STOREYS (SLIM PLAN — THIS GRAMMAR'S OWN)



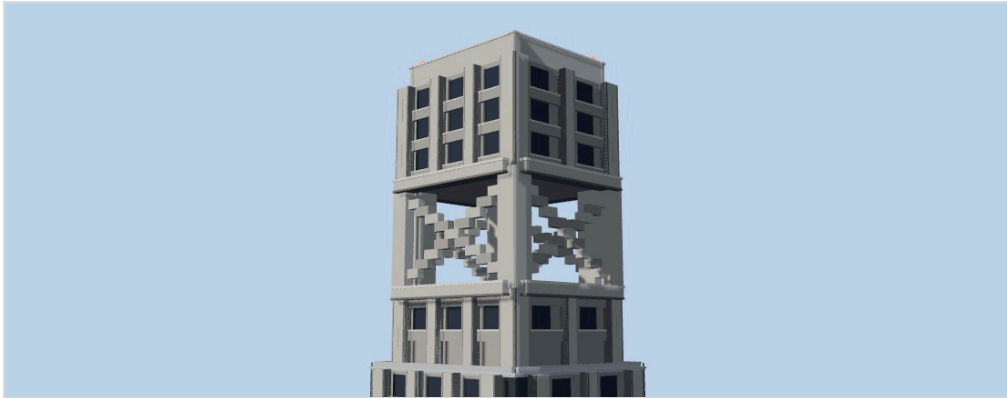
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

The supertall slim: a 1:12 shaft, open mechanical floors punched through it for wind, a razor top.

AS A CITY: Billionaires' Row. Siblings: the setback needle, the concrete-core stack, the paired-tower slot. A city of impossibly thin things.



From the pavement — the entrance

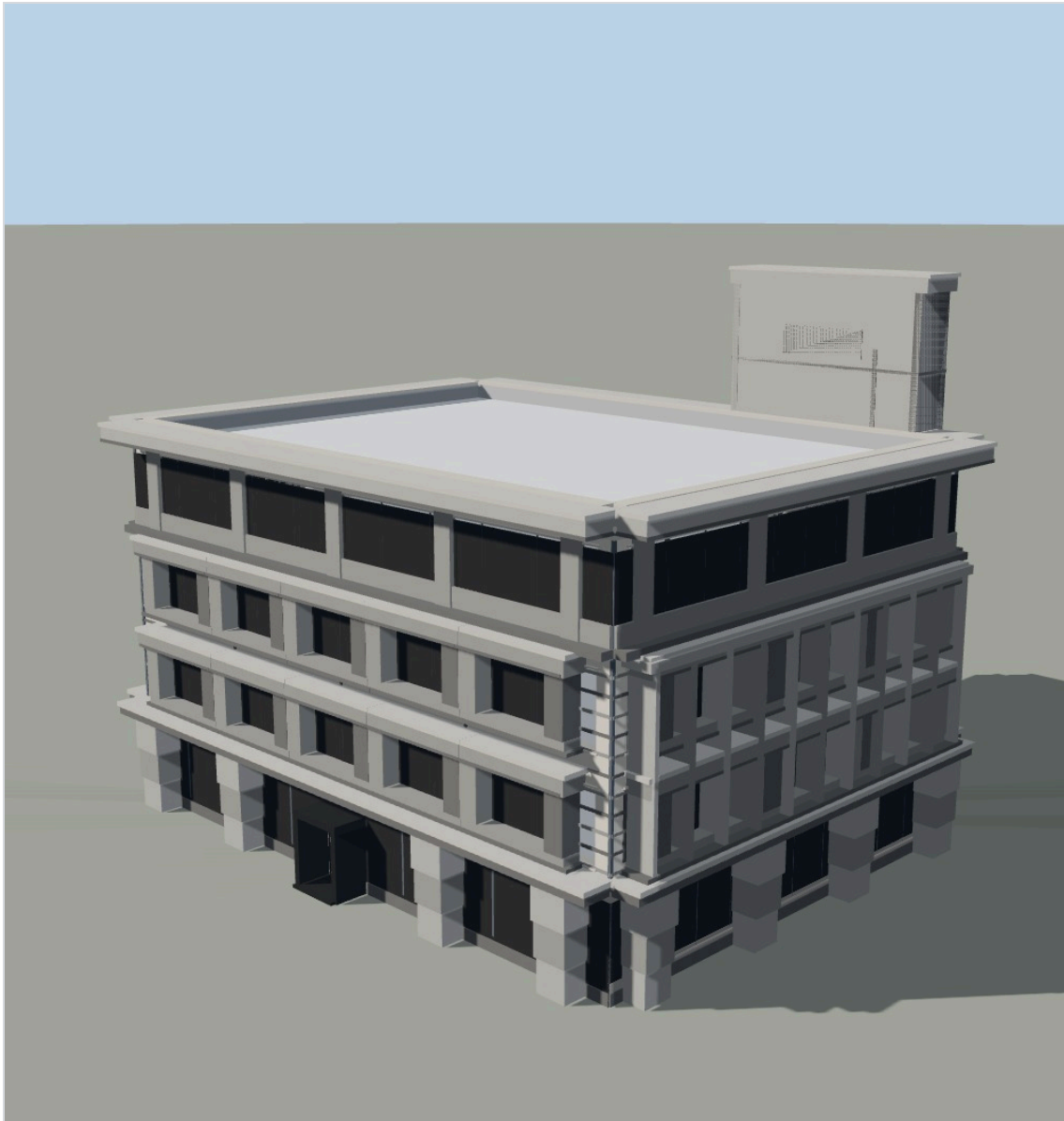


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+31.9 m	Tallest point	185.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	13	Triangles	86,440
Merged deco boxes (free)	7190	Minted meshes (not)	2

48 Beton Brut

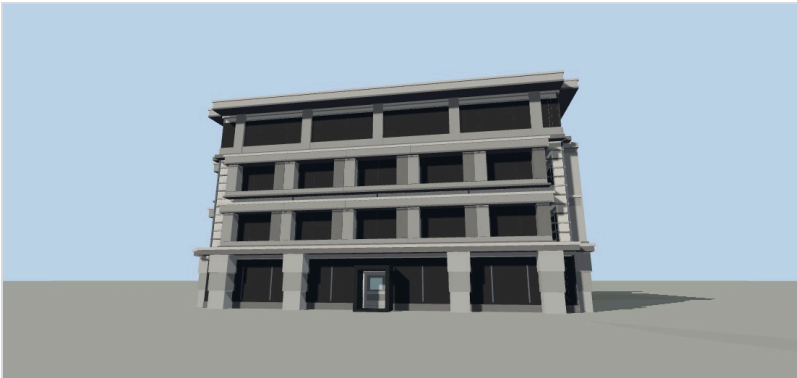
LATE 20TH CENTURY · MID-RISE BLOCK · brutalist · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



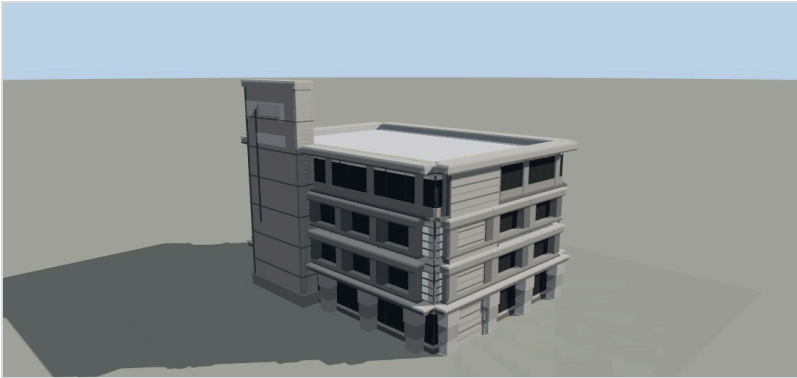
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Beton brut. Every opening a hole punched through a thick wall, hooded so it throws a hard shadow all day; board-formed plank lines; lifted on pilotis.

AS A CITY: A concrete civic campus — city hall, the library, the parking structure, the housing slab. Grim and coherent.



From the pavement — the entrance

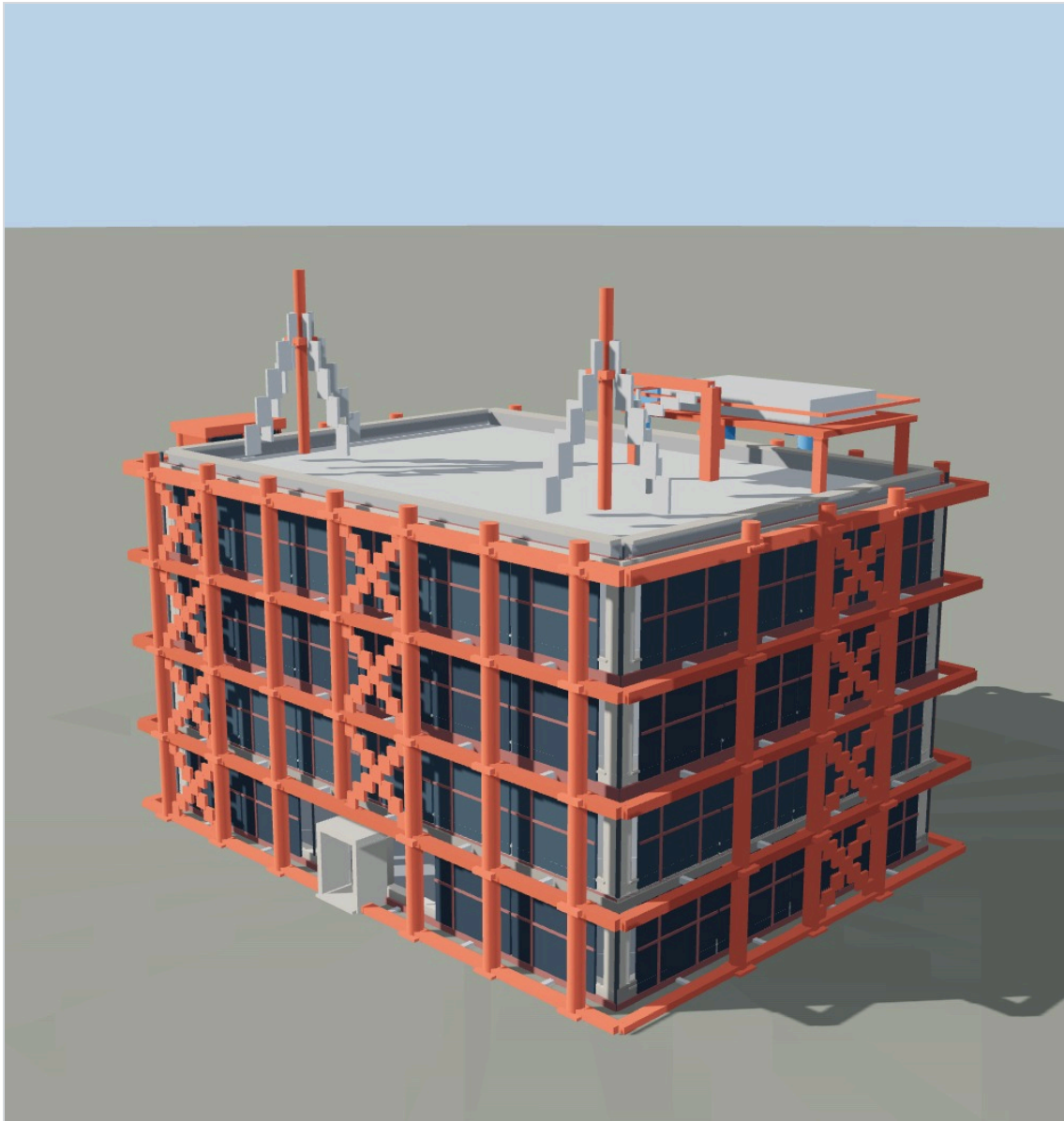


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+5.7 m	Tallest point	18.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	11	Triangles	11,748
Merged deco boxes (free)	979	Minted meshes (not)	0

49 Exostructure

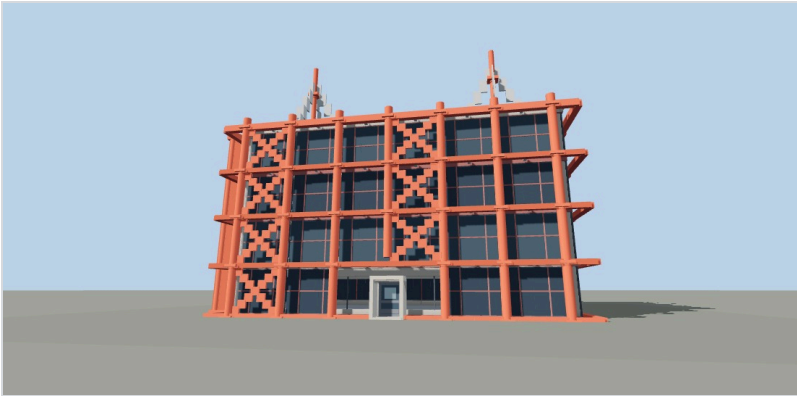
LATE 20TH CENTURY · MID-RISE BLOCK · hightech · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



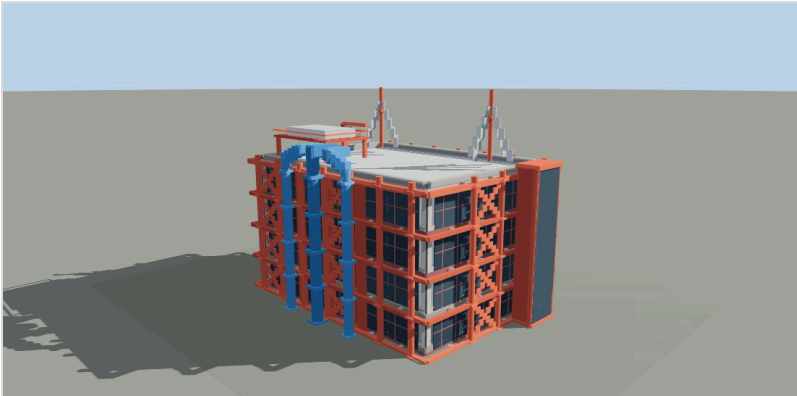
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Inside-out, Lloyd's / Pompidou: the frame stands proud of the glass, the risers and stair are outside, and the roof plant is architecture.

AS A CITY: A services-on-the-outside quarter. Siblings: the exposed-truss shed, the tension-rod atrium, the gantry-served lab.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+7 m	Tallest point	19.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	39	Triangles	19,316
Merged deco boxes (free)	1521	Minted meshes (not)	27

50 Desert Modern House

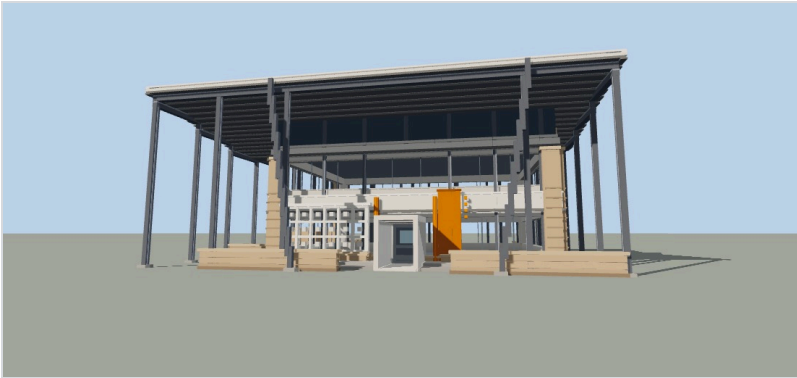
CONTEMPORARY · HOUSE · desertmod · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Palm Springs, 1962. A single thin roof blade with 2-6 m of overhang, steel posts, plate glass, a breeze-block screen. Architecture as the management of sun.

AS A CITY: A mid-century desert suburb: butterfly roof, folded plate, the post-and-beam, the screen-wall bungalow.



From the pavement — the entrance

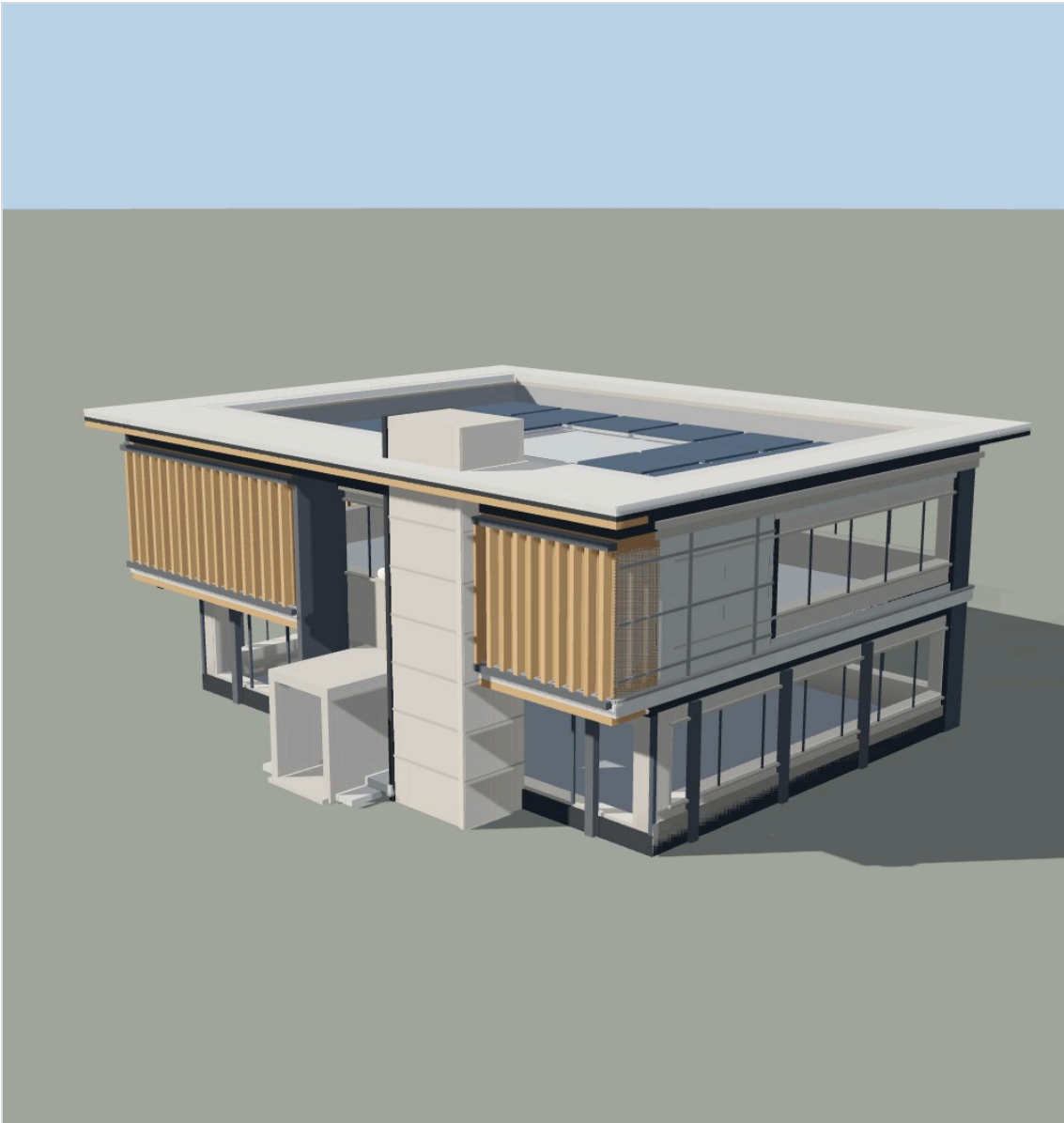


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+3.6 m	Tallest point	10 m
Things breaking the roofline	18	Triangles	11,136
Merged deco boxes (free)	928	Minted meshes (not)	0

51 Modern Tech House

CONTEMPORARY · HOUSE · techhouse · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



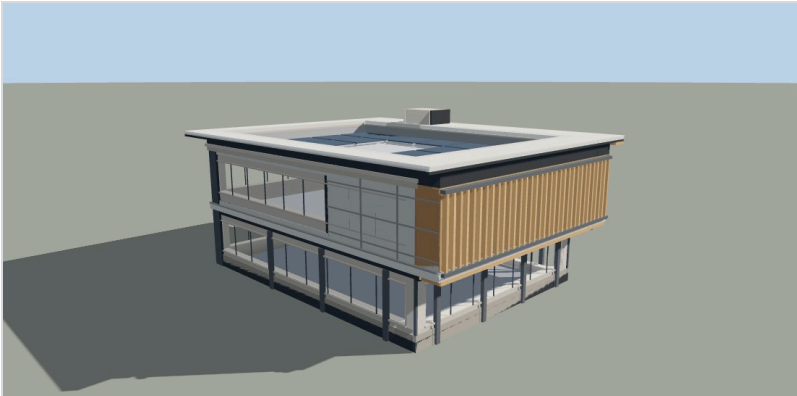
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Contemporary glass house: stacked cantilevered volumes, floor-to-ceiling glazing, a wood-slat screen, a flat roof with a parapet.

AS A CITY: A hillside of modern spec houses. The least characterful pick, and the most likely to read as generic.



From the pavement — the entrance

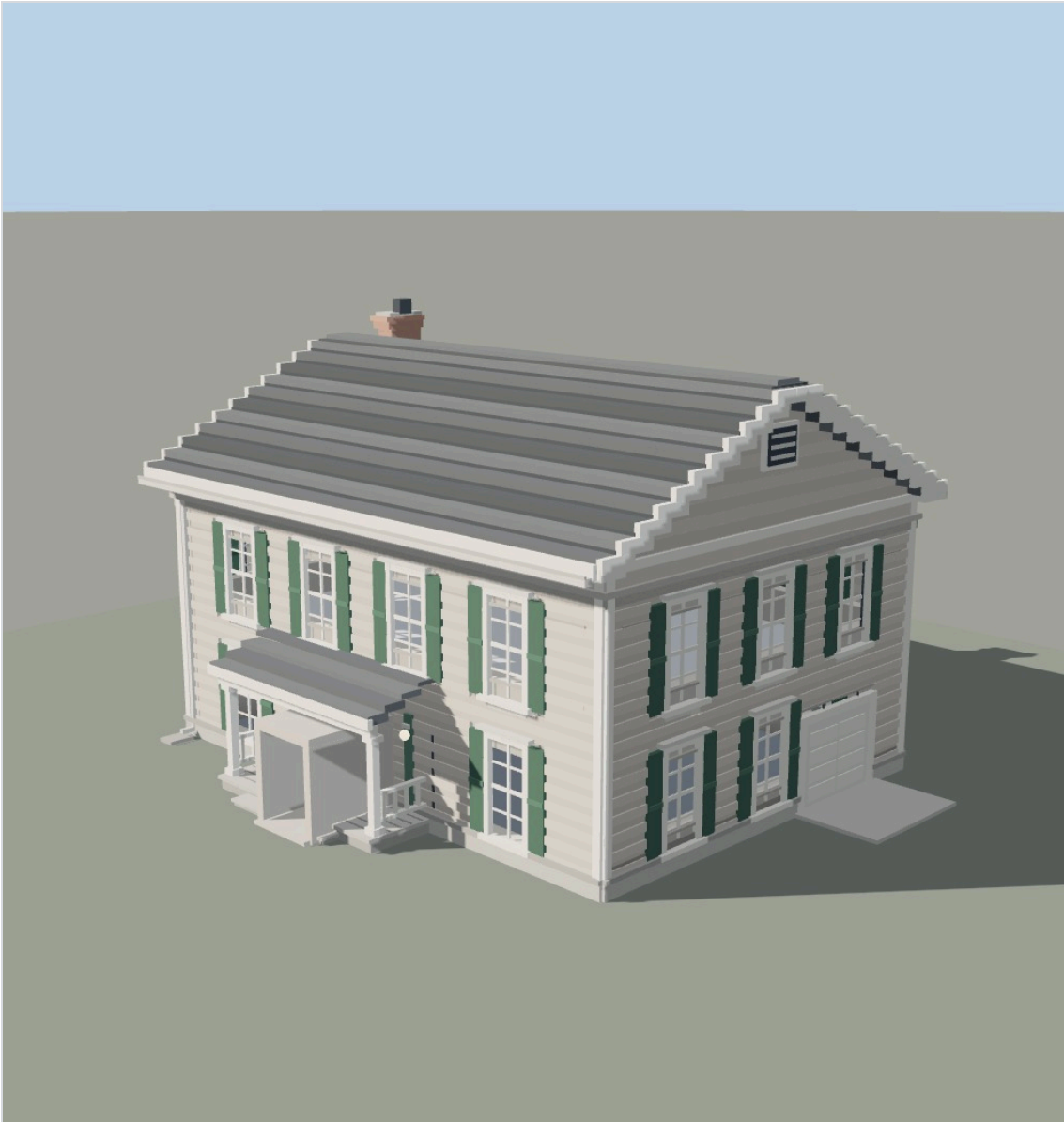


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+1.6 m	Tallest point	8 m
Things breaking the roofline	9	Triangles	6,012
Merged deco boxes (free)	481	Minted meshes (not)	3

52 Plain House

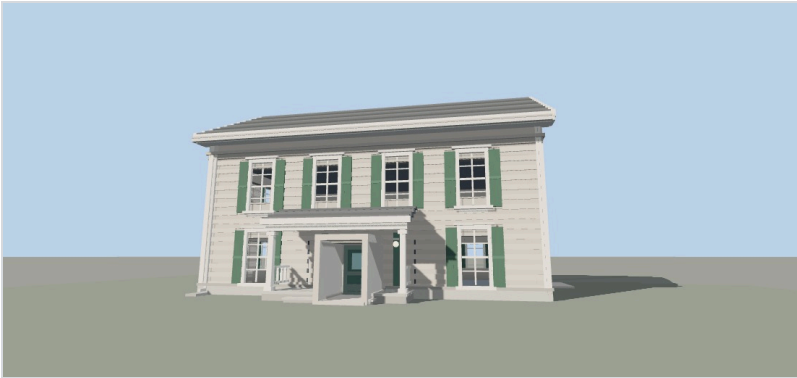
CONTEMPORARY · HOUSE · ranch · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



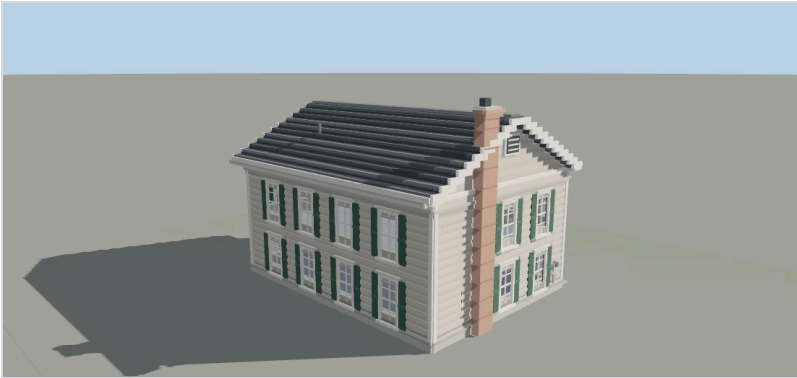
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Plain house. A long low box, shallow gable, picture window, an attached carport. Deliberately the boring one — it is what a street NEEDS between the loud ones.

AS A CITY: Post-war tract suburbia: ranch, split-level, cape, minimal traditional. Background architecture, and a city is mostly background.



From the pavement — the entrance

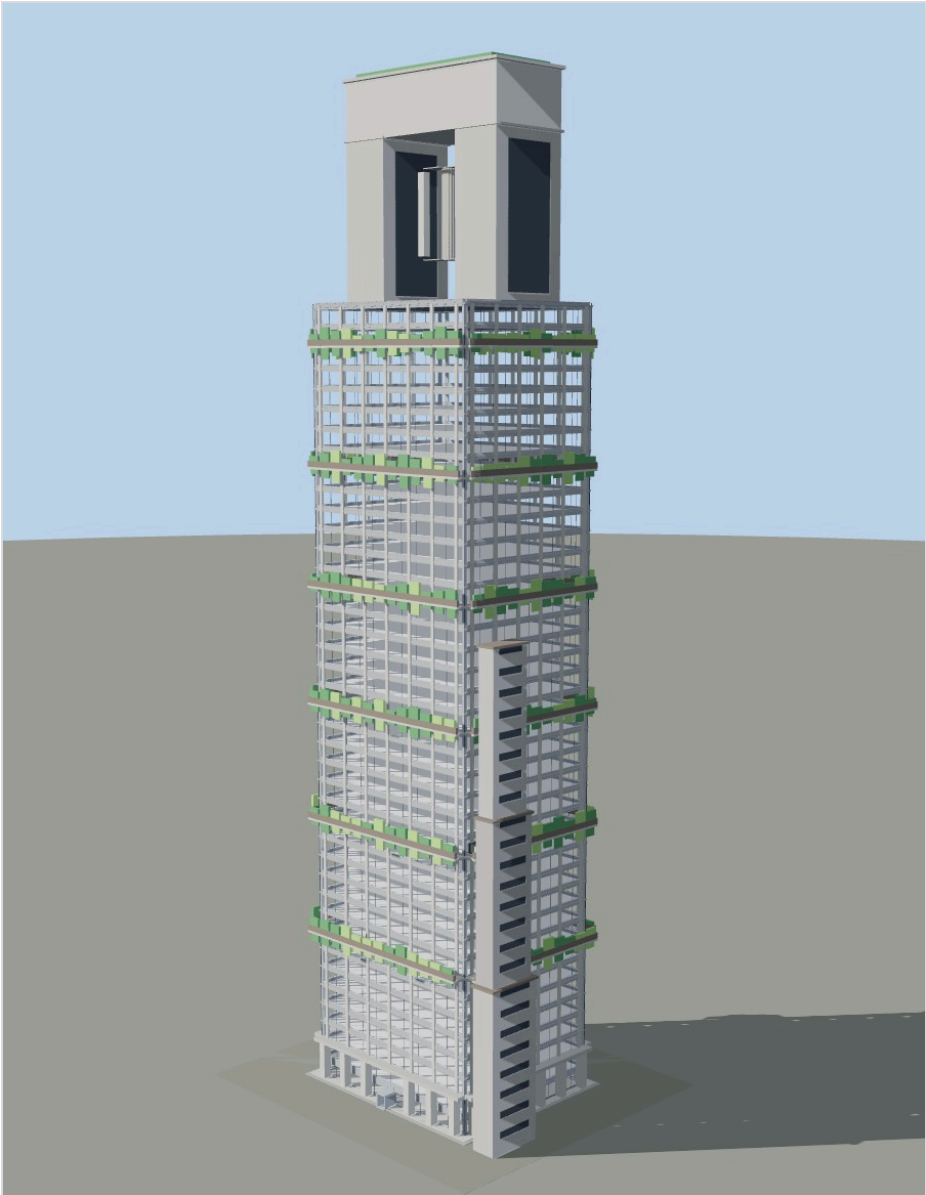


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+4.9 m	Tallest point	11.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	18	Triangles	15,428
Merged deco boxes (free)	1279	Minted meshes (not)	1

53 Arcology Terrace

NEAR FUTURE · TOWER · arcology · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



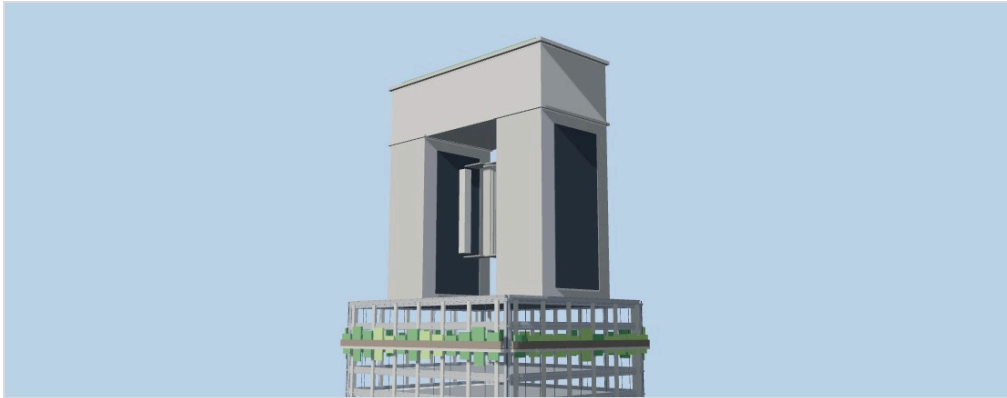
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Planted terraces stepping back on every face, sky-bridges between masses, and a wind-scoop void punched clean through the upper mass — a hole in the building.

AS A CITY: A vertical district: linked arcologies, sky-farms, a ground plane given back to water.



From the pavement — the entrance



The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+36.5 m	Tallest point	164.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	10	Triangles	67,980
Merged deco boxes (free)	5665	Minted meshes (not)	0

54 Printed Shell

NEAR FUTURE · TOWER · printed · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Printed in place. Continuous horizontal bead courses running unbroken around the building, each offset from the last so the wall swells and waists. No straight vertical edge anywhere.

AS A CITY: A printed settlement — lobed towers, extruded low blocks, a landscape with no right angles.



From the pavement — the entrance

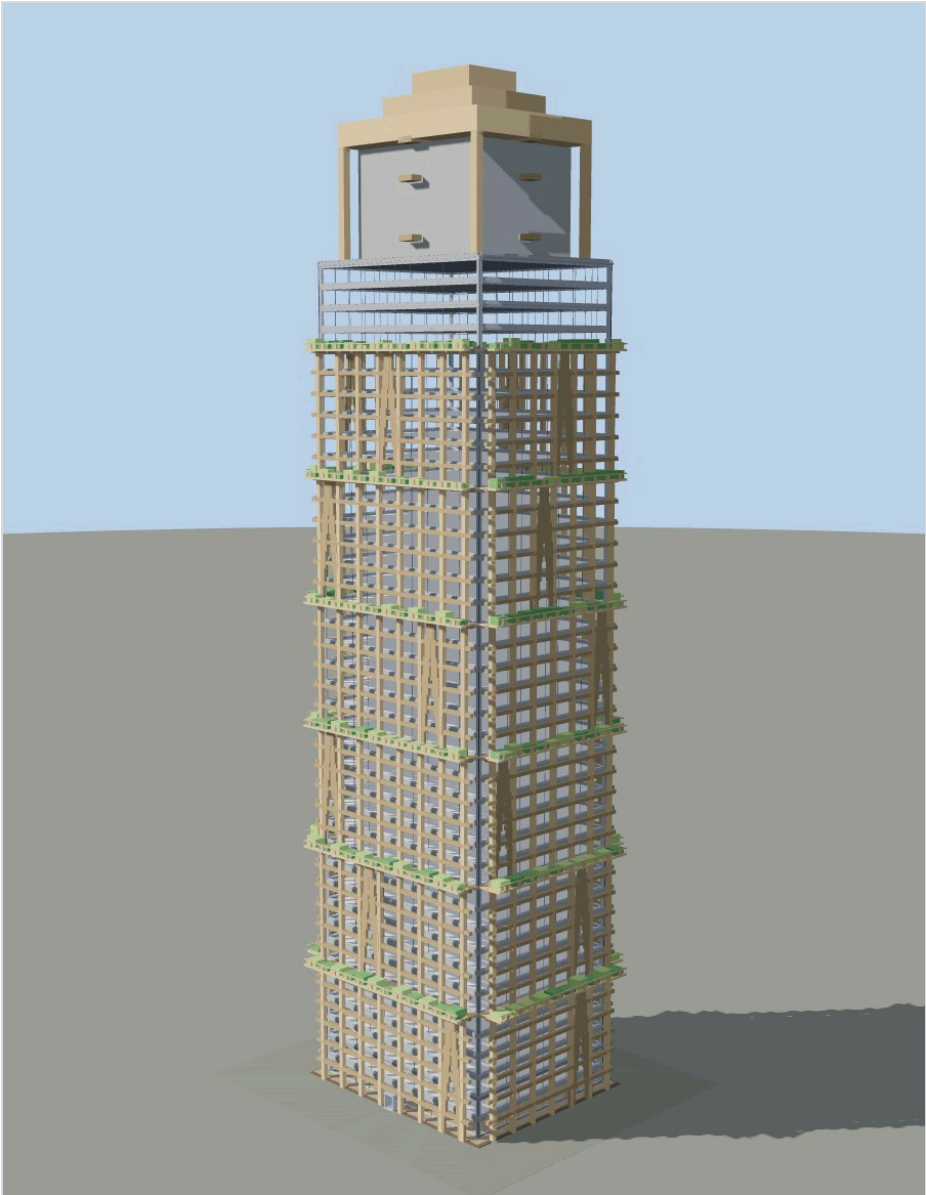


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+17.5 m	Tallest point	145.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	15	Triangles	53,340
Merged deco boxes (free)	4445	Minted meshes (not)	0

55 Mass Timber Tower

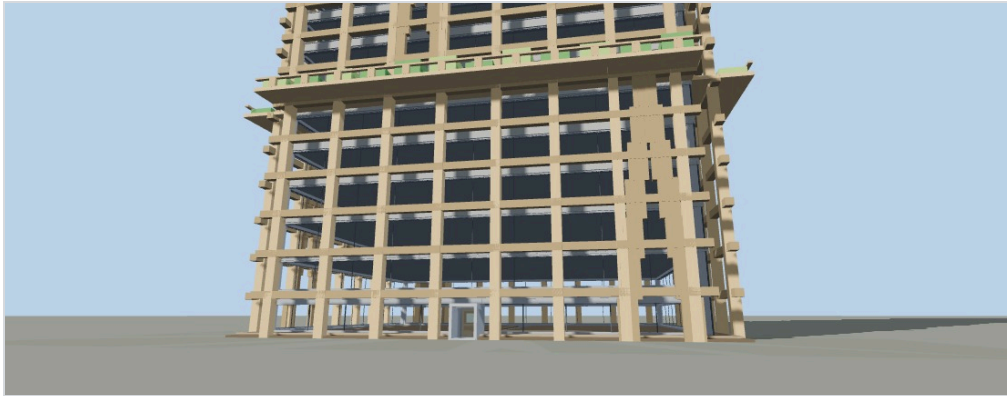
NEAR FUTURE · TOWER · masstimber · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

CLT and glulam. A heavy timber grid standing outside the glass, warm against cool grey, and planted setback terraces where the structure steps in. Warm and orthogonal where high-tech is metal and industrial.

AS A CITY: A timber downtown: CLT towers, a market hall on glulam arches, planted decks.



From the pavement — the entrance



The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+27.8 m	Tallest point	155.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	11	Triangles	74,292
Merged deco boxes (free)	6191	Minted meshes (not)	0